# Linear Algebra

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## Contents

**1 Vector Spaces** **9**
Definition 1.1 (Vector Space) . . . 9
Example 1.1 ($\mathbb{R}^n$) . . . 9
Example 1.2 ($\mathbb{C}^n$) . . . 10
Example 1.3 ($\mathbb{Z}_p^n$) . . . 10
Example 1.4 (Function Space) . . . 10
Example 1.5 (Continuous Functions) . . . 10
Example 1.6 (Polynomials of Finite Degree) . . . 10
Example 1.7 (Sequence Space $\ell^p$) . . . 10
Theorem 1.1 (No Zero Divisors) . . . 10
Definition 1.2 (Linear Map) . . . 11
Definition 1.3 (Isomorphism) . . . 11
1.1 Basis and Dimension . . . 12
Definition 1.4 (Linear Combination) . . . 12
Definition 1.5 (Span) . . . 12
Definition 1.6 (Linear Independence) . . . 12
Definition 1.7 (Basis) . . . 12
Example 1.8 (Standard Basis) . . . 12
Theorem 1.2 (Maximally Independent Set is a Basis) . . . 12
Definition 1.8 (Dimension) . . . 13
Theorem 1.3 (Isomorphism to $\mathbb{F}^n$) . . . 13
Corollary 1.4 (Isomorphism Between $n$-Dimensional Vector Spaces) . . . 13
Example 1.9 ($\mathbb{C}$ as a Real Vector Space) . . . 13
1.2 Subspaces . . . 13
Definition 1.9 (Subspace) . . . 13
Definition 1.10 (Hyperplane) . . . 13
Definition 1.11 (Sum of Subspaces) . . . 13
Definition 1.12 (Direct Sum of Spaces) . . . 14
Example 1.10 (Vector Space as Direct Sum of Basis) . . . 14
Example 1.11 (Complex Vector Spaces as Real Vector Spaces) . . . 14
Theorem 1.5 (Dimension of Direct Sum) . . . 14
Definition 1.13 (Congruence Relations on Vector Spaces) . . . 15
Definition 1.14 (Quotient Vector Space) . . . 15
Theorem 1.6 (Decomposition into Subspace and Quotient Space) . . . 15
1.3 Dual Spaces . . . 15
Definition 1.15 (Dual Space) . . . 15
Definition 1.16 (Dual Basis) . . . 16
Corollary 1.7 (Dimensions of Dual of Finite-Dimensional Vector Spaces) . . . 16
Theorem 1.8 (Canonical Isomorphisms of Double Duals) . . . 16
Example 1.12 (Infinite-dimensional Case) . . . 17
Definition 1.17 (Annihilator) . . . 17
Theorem 1.9 (Annihilator and Dual Quotient Space) . . . 17
Theorem 1.10 (Quadrature Formula) . . . 18
1.4 Exercises . . . 18

**2 Linear Maps** **25**
Example 2.1 (Linear Map from $\mathbb{R}^2$ to $\mathbb{R}^2$) . . . 25
Example 2.2 (Left Matrix Multiplication) . . . 25
Example 2.3 (Differentiation) . . . 25

Example 2.4 (Integration) . . . 26
2.1 Image and Null Space . . . 26
Definition 2.1 (Image) . . . 26
Definition 2.2 (Rank) . . . 26
Definition 2.3 (Nullspace, Kernel) . . . 26
Example 2.5 (Image and Kernel of Quotient Map) . . . 27
Theorem 2.1 . . . 27
Corollary 2.2 (Injectivity via the Kernel) . . . 27
Theorem 2.3 (Rank Nullity Theorem) . . . 27
2.2 Invertibility . . . 28
Theorem 2.4 (Left/Right-Invertibility) . . . 28
Definition 2.4 (Inverse) . . . 29
Corollary 2.5 (Invertible Linear Maps Are Isomorphisms) . . . 29
2.3 Factorization of Linear Maps . . . 29
Definition 2.5 (Invariant Subspace Under Linear Map) . . . 29
Definition 2.6 (Restriction) . . . 29
Theorem 2.6 (Universal Property of Factorization) . . . 29
Definition 2.7 (Induced Mapping of Quotients) . . . 30
Theorem 2.7 (First Isomorphism Theorem) . . . 30
Theorem 2.8 (Second Isomorphism Theorem) . . . 30
Corollary 2.9 (Rank-Nullity for a Direct Sum) . . . 31
Theorem 2.10 (Third Isomorphism Theorem) . . . 31
2.4 Algebra of Linear Maps . . . 32
Theorem 2.11 (Vector Space of Linear Maps) . . . 32
Lemma 2.12 (Composition of Linear Maps is Linear) . . . 32
Theorem 2.13 (Algebra of Linear Maps) . . . 33
Definition 2.8 (Operator Norm) . . . 33
Lemma 2.14 (Operator Norm Bound) . . . 33
Lemma 2.15 (Uniform Continuity of Linear Maps) . . . 33
Lemma 2.16 (Cauchy Schwarz (Sort Of)) . . . 34
Theorem 2.17 (Subset of Invertible Maps are Open) . . . 34
Theorem 2.18 (Inversion is Continuous Operator) . . . 35
2.5 Transpose . . . 36
Definition 2.9 (Transpose) . . . 36
Theorem 2.19 (Annihilator of Image is the Kernel of the Transpose) . . . 36
2.6 Stable Subspaces and Induced Maps . . . 37
Definition 2.10 (Stable Subspaces) . . . 37
Definition 2.11 (Induced Linear Map on a Direct Sum) . . . 37
2.7 General Linear Groups . . . 37
Definition 2.12 (General Linear Group) . . . 37
Definition 2.13 (Special Linear Group) . . . 37
2.8 Exercises . . . 37

**3 Inner Product Spaces 38**
Definition 3.1 (Inner Product) . . . 38
Theorem 3.1 (Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality) . . . 38
Example 3.1 (Dot Product) . . . 39
Example 3.2 (Integral Product) . . . 39
Theorem 3.2 (Basis-Free Isomorphism Induced by Inner Product) . . . 39
3.1 Induced Norms . . . 40
Lemma 3.3 (Inner Product Induces Norm) . . . 40
Theorem 3.4 (Parallelogram Identity) . . . 40
Example 3.3 (L1 Norm) . . . 40
Theorem 3.5 (Variational Definition of Norm) . . . 41
3.2 Orthogonality . . . 41
Definition 3.2 (Orthogonal Vectors) . . . 41
Definition 3.3 (Orthogonal Subspaces) . . . 41
Definition 3.4 (Orthogonal Complement) . . . 41
Definition 3.5 (Orthogonal, Orthonormal Basis) . . . 42
3.3 Projections . . . 42
Definition 3.6 (Projection) . . . 42
Lemma 3.6 (Orthogonal Decomposition Theorem) . . . 42
Definition 3.7 (Orthogonal Projection) . . . 43
Lemma 3.7 (Orthogonal Projections are Linear) . . . 43
Lemma 3.8 (Orthogonal Projection Formula onto 1-Dimension in $\mathbb{R}^n$) . . . 43
Theorem 3.9 (Orthogonal Projection Formula in $\mathbb{R}^n$) . . . 44

Theorem 3.10 (Gram-Schmidt) . . . 44
3.4 Isometries . . . 45
Definition 3.8 (Isometry) . . . 45
Example 3.4 (Rotations and Reflections Are Isometries) . . . 45
Definition 3.9 (Orthogonal Group) . . . 45
Definition 3.10 (Special Orthogonal Group) . . . 45
Definition 3.11 (Unitary Group) . . . 45
Example 3.5 ($U(1)$ as the Unit Circle) . . . 45
Definition 3.12 (Special Unitary Group) . . . 45
3.5 Adjoint Operators . . . 46
Definition 3.13 (Adjoint Operator) . . . 46
Theorem 3.11 (Least Squares Solution of an Overdetermined System) . . . 47
Theorem 3.12 (Properties of the Adjoint) . . . 47
Definition 3.14 (Self-Adjoint Map) . . . 48
Theorem 3.13 (Restrictions of Self-Adjoint Maps) . . . 48
Theorem 3.14 (Orthogonal Projections are Self-Adjoint) . . . 48
Definition 3.15 (Anti-Self-Adjoint) . . . 48

**4 Matrices** **49**
Definition 4.1 (Column Vector) . . . 49
Definition 4.2 (Matrix) . . . 49
Definition 4.3 (Row Vector) . . . 50
Definition 4.4 (Column Space) . . . 51
Definition 4.5 (Null Space) . . . 52
4.1 Algebra of Matrices . . . 52
Theorem 4.1 (Vector Space of Matrices) . . . 52
Definition 4.6 (Matrix Multiplication) . . . 52
Lemma 4.2 (Matrix Multiplication as Realization of Composition) . . . 52
Theorem 4.3 (Algebra of Matrices) . . . 52
Example 4.1 (Trigonometric Identities from Rotations) . . . 53
Definition 4.7 (Frobenius Norm) . . . 53
Theorem 4.4 (Frobenius Norm vs Operator Norm) . . . 53
4.2 Row Reduction . . . 53
Definition 4.8 (Diagonal Matrix) . . . 53
Definition 4.9 (Triangular Matrices) . . . 54
Definition 4.10 (Pivot) . . . 54
Definition 4.11 (Row Echelon Form) . . . 54
Definition 4.12 (Reduced Row Echelon Form) . . . 54
Definition 4.13 (Elementary Row Transformation) . . . 54
Example 4.2 (Elementary Row Transformations) . . . 55
Lemma 4.5 (Elementary Row Transformations as Matrix Multiplication) . . . 55
Lemma 4.6 (Inverse of Elementary Row Transformations) . . . 56
Theorem 4.7 (Gauss Jordan Elimination) . . . 56
Definition 4.14 (Rank) . . . 57
Theorem 4.8 (Rank as Dimension of Image) . . . 57
Definition 4.15 (Nonsingular Matrix) . . . 57
Theorem 4.9 (Invertibility) . . . 57
4.3 The (Hermitian) Transpose . . . 58
Definition 4.16 (Transpose of a Matrix) . . . 58
Theorem 4.10 (Properties of the Matrix Transpose) . . . 58
Definition 4.17 (Symmetric Matrices) . . . 58
Definition 4.18 (Row Space) . . . 58
Definition 4.19 (Left Nullspace) . . . 58
Theorem 4.11 (Four Fundamental Subspaces of a Matrix) . . . 59
Theorem 4.12 (Column and Row Spaces are Isomorphic) . . . 59
Corollary 4.13 (Row Rank Equals Column Rank) . . . 59
4.4 Block Matrices . . . 59
Theorem 4.14 (Matrix of an Induced Map on a Direct Sum) . . . 59
Theorem 4.15 (Arithmetic of $2 \times 2$ Block Matrices) . . . 60
Theorem 4.16 (Determinant Identity via a Block Construction) . . . 60
Corollary 4.17 (Determinant of a Block Triangular Matrix) . . . 60
Theorem 4.18 (Schur Complement Determinant Formulas) . . . 61
Definition 4.20 (Block Diagonal Matrix) . . . 61
Theorem 4.19 (Determinant and Trace of a Block Diagonal Matrix) . . . 61
4.5 Determinants and Trace . . . 61
Definition 4.21 (Determinant) . . . 61

Theorem 4.20 (Vanishing Determinant and Linear Dependence) . . . 62
Theorem 4.21 (Multiplicativity of the Determinant) . . . 62
Theorem 4.22 (Invertibility via the Determinant) . . . 62
Corollary 4.23 (Determinant of an Inverse) . . . 63
Theorem 4.24 (Similar Matrices Have Equal Determinants) . . . 63
Corollary 4.25 (Determinant of a Transpose) . . . 63
Theorem 4.26 (Effect of Row Operations on the Determinant) . . . 63
Theorem 4.27 (Determinant via the First Column) . . . 63
Corollary 4.28 (Determinant of a Triangular Matrix) . . . 64
Theorem 4.29 (Determinant of a $2 \times 2$ Matrix) . . . 65
Definition 4.22 (Minor of a Matrix) . . . 65
Theorem 4.30 (Laplace Expansion) . . . 65
Theorem 4.31 (Cramer's Rule) . . . 65
Theorem 4.32 (Inverse via the Adjugate) . . . 65
Definition 4.23 (Trace of a Square Matrix) . . . 66
Theorem 4.33 (Linearity of the Trace) . . . 66
Theorem 4.34 (Cyclic Property of the Trace) . . . 66
Corollary 4.35 (Invariance of the Trace under Change of Basis) . . . 66
Theorem 4.36 (Odd-Order Skew-Symmetric Matrices Are Singular) . . . 67
Theorem 4.37 (Pfaffian) . . . 67
Theorem 4.38 (As Eigenvalues) . . . 67
Definition 4.24 (Vandermonde Matrix) . . . 67
Theorem 4.39 (Determinant of a Vandermonde Matrix) . . . 68
Example 4.3 (2019 Putnam A1) . . . 68
Example 4.4 (Computing a $4 \times 4$ Determinant) . . . 69
4.6 Change of Basis . . . 69
Definition 4.25 (Change of Basis Matrix) . . . 70
Example 4.5 (Computation of a Change-of-Basis Matrix) . . . 70
Definition 4.26 (Similar Matrices) . . . 71
Lemma 4.40 (Similarity is an Equivalence Relation) . . . 71
4.7 LUP Decomposition . . . 71
Theorem 4.41 (Triangularity Is Preserved under Multiplication) . . . 71
Theorem 4.42 (LU Decompositions) . . . 71
Definition 4.27 (Permutation Matrix) . . . 72
Example 4.6 (The $2 \times 2$ Permutation Matrices) . . . 73
Theorem 4.43 ($PLU$ Decomposition) . . . 73
Corollary 4.44 ($LUP$ Decomposition) . . . 74
4.8 QR Decomposition . . . 75
Definition 4.28 (QR Decomposition) . . . 75
4.9 Cholesky Decomposition . . . 76
Definition 4.29 (Cholesky Decomposition) . . . 76
4.10 Matrix Groups . . . 77
Definition 4.30 (Orthogonal Matrix) . . . 77
Theorem 4.45 (Rows of an Orthogonal Matrix Are Orthonormal) . . . 77
Definition 4.31 (Special Orthogonal Matrix) . . . 77
Theorem 4.46 (Transpose of an Orthogonal Matrix Is Its Inverse) . . . 77
4.11 Exercises . . . 77

**5 Tensors** **78**
Definition 5.1 (Bilinear Map) . . . 78
Definition 5.2 (Free Vector Space) . . . 78
5.1 Tensor Product Spaces . . . 78
Definition 5.3 (Tensor Product Space) . . . 78
Theorem 5.1 (Universal Property of Tensor Products) . . . 79
Lemma 5.2 (Commutativity of Tensor Products on Spaces) . . . 80
Corollary 5.3 (2-Tensors as Bilinear Functionals and Maps) . . . 81
Theorem 5.4 (Basis of Tensor Product Space) . . . 82
Definition 5.4 (Outer Product) . . . 82
Definition 5.5 (Kronecker Product) . . . 82
Example 5.1 ($4 \times 3$ Dimensional Tensor Product Space) . . . 82
Corollary 5.5 (Dimension of Tensor Product Space) . . . 83
Lemma 5.6 (Associativity of Tensor Products on Spaces) . . . 83
Definition 5.6 (Higher Order Tensor Product Spaces) . . . 84
Example 5.2 (Low-Rank Tensor Product Spaces) . . . 84
Theorem 5.7 (Basis of $n$-Way Tensor Product Space) . . . 84
Corollary 5.8 (Dimension of $n$-Way Tensor Product Space) . . . 84

Example 5.3 (3-Tensor as a Multidimensional Array) . . . 85
Definition 5.7 (Tensor Rank) . . . 85
5.2 Tensor Products of Linear Operators . . . 85
Definition 5.8 (Tensor Product of Linear Operators) . . . 85
Example 5.4 (Tensor Product of Two $2 \times 2$ Matrices) . . . 86
Theorem 5.9 (Matrix Realization of Tensor Product Operators) . . . 86
Lemma 5.10 (Properties of Tensor Products of Linear Operators) . . . 87
Theorem 5.11 (Endomorphisms of a Tensor Product) . . . 87
5.3 Contractions . . . 87
Definition 5.9 (Covariant, Contravariant Tensors) . . . 87
Definition 5.10 (Einstein Summation Notation) . . . 88
Example 5.5 (More Complicated Tensors in Einstein Summation Notation) . . . 88
Example 5.6 (Contraction of Rank (1, 1) Tensor) . . . 89
Example 5.7 (Contraction of Rank (2, 1) Tensor) . . . 90
Definition 5.11 (Contraction) . . . 91
Example 5.8 (Evaluation of Rank (1, 2) Tensor) . . . 91
Example 5.9 (Inner Product) . . . 91
Example 5.10 (Linear Maps) . . . 92
Theorem 5.12 (Rank of Linear Maps) . . . 92
Corollary 5.13 (Outer Products Have Tensor Rank One) . . . 92
Example 5.11 (Composition of Linear Maps) . . . 92
Definition 5.12 (Trace) . . . 92
Corollary 5.14 (Trace and Determinant of Tensor Product Operators) . . . 93
Theorem 5.15 (Schmidt Decomposition) . . . 93
Example 5.12 (Tensor Decompositions as Networks) . . . 93
5.4 Symmetric and Alternating Tensors . . . 94
Definition 5.13 (Permutation of Tensor Factors) . . . 94
Definition 5.14 (Symmetric, Alternating Tensors) . . . 94
Definition 5.15 (Symmetric Power) . . . 94
Example 5.13 (Construction of $\text{Sym}^2(V)$) . . . 96
Definition 5.16 (Alternating Power) . . . 97
Example 5.14 (Inner Product) . . . 98
Example 5.15 ($\text{Sym}^2(V)$ is Symmetric Matrices) . . . 98
Example 5.16 ($\text{Alt}^2(V)$ is Antisymmetric Matrices) . . . 99
Example 5.17 (Third Exterior Power) . . . 99
Example 5.18 (Cross Product) . . . 99
Example 5.19 (Triple Scalar Product) . . . 100
Definition 5.17 (Determinant) . . . 100
Theorem 5.16 (Symmetric-Antisymmetric Decomposition) . . . 100
5.5 Tensor Algebras . . . 101
Definition 5.18 (Tensor Algebra) . . . 101
Definition 5.19 (Symmetric Algebra) . . . 102
Definition 5.20 (Exterior Algebra) . . . 102

**6 Spectral Theory 103**
Definition 6.1 (Eigenvalue) . . . 103
Definition 6.2 (Characteristic Polynomial) . . . 103
Lemma 6.1 (Invariance of Characteristic Polynomial) . . . 103
Theorem 6.2 (Roots of Characteristic Polynomial is the Specturm) . . . 104
Example 6.1 (Distinct Eigenvalues) . . . 104
Example 6.2 (Same Eigenvalues) . . . 104
6.1 Eigendecomposition . . . 105
Lemma 6.3 (Eigenvectors are Linearly Independent) . . . 105
Example 6.3 (Multiplicity 2 Eigenvalue but 1 Eigenvector) . . . 105
Definition 6.3 (Generalized, Genuine Eigenvector) . . . 106
Lemma 6.4 (Generalized Eigenvector Chain) . . . 106
Definition 6.4 (Eigenspace, Generalized Eigenspace, Jordan Space) . . . 106
Definition 6.5 (Eigenbasis) . . . 107
Definition 6.6 (Algebraic Multiplicity) . . . 107
Definition 6.7 (Geometric Multiplicity) . . . 107
Theorem 6.5 (Eigendecomposition of Vector Space) . . . 107
Theorem 6.6 (Invariance of Eigenspaces Under Linear Map) . . . 108
Corollary 6.7 (Eigendecomposition of Linear Maps) . . . 108
6.2 Real and Complex Jordan Canonical Forms . . . 108
Definition 6.8 (Complex Jordan Block for Complex Eigenvalue) . . . 109
Definition 6.9 (Jordan Canonical Form over $\mathbb{C}$) . . . 109
Example 6.4 (JNF of a Nontrivial $3 \times 3$ Matrix) . . . 110

Example 6.5 (JNF with Two Nontrivial Jordan Chains) . . . 111
Example 6.6 (Real Matrix with 4 Complex Eigenvalues) . . . 113
Example 6.7 (Fibonacci Sequence) . . . 114
Definition 6.10 (Real Jordan Block for a Complex Eigenvalue) . . . 115
Example 6.8 (Rotation in $\mathbb{R}^2$) . . . 116
Definition 6.11 (Real Jordan Block for a Real Eigenvalue) . . . 116
Definition 6.12 (Jordan Normal Form over $\mathbb{R}$) . . . 116
Example 6.9 (Real Jordan Normal Form of a $3 \times 3$ Matrix) . . . 117
Example 6.10 (2 Rotations in $\mathbb{R}^4$) . . . 119
Theorem 6.8 (Similarity Conditions) . . . 119
Theorem 6.9 (Diagonalizability Conditions for Multiplicities) . . . 119
Corollary 6.10 (Transposes are Similar) . . . 120
6.3 Spectral Mapping Theorem . . . 120
Theorem 6.11 (Spectral Mapping Theorem) . . . 120
Theorem 6.12 (Cayley Hamilton) . . . 121
6.4 Eigenvalue Bounds (Gershgorin) . . . 121
Theorem 6.13 (Gershgorin Circle Theorem) . . . 121
6.5 Schur Decomposition . . . 122
Theorem 6.14 (Schur Decomposition) . . . 122
6.6 Self-Adjoint Operators . . . 122
Theorem 6.15 (Spectral Theorem of Self-Adjoint Maps) . . . 122
Corollary 6.16 (Diagonalizability of Hermitian Matrix) . . . 122
Definition 6.13 (Spectral Resolution) . . . 122
Theorem 6.17 (Functional Calculus via the Spectral Resolution) . . . 123
Theorem 6.18 (Spectral Resolution of Commuting Self-Adjoint Operators) . . . 123
Theorem 6.19 (Spectral Resolution of Anti-Self-Adjoint Operators) . . . 123
Definition 6.14 (Normal Maps) . . . 123
Theorem 6.20 . . . 124
6.7 Positive Definite Maps . . . 124
Definition 6.15 (Spectral Radius) . . . 124
Definition 6.16 (Positive (Semi)definite) . . . 124
Example 6.11 (Positive Definite Maps) . . . 124
Example 6.12 (Positive Definite Matrices) . . . 124
Theorem 6.21 (Subspace of Positive Definite Maps) . . . 125
Theorem 6.22 (Congruence Preserves Positivity) . . . 125
Theorem 6.23 (Unique Positive Square Root) . . . 125
Definition 6.17 (Loewner Order on Positive Definite Mappings) . . . 125
Theorem 6.24 (Order Reversal under Inversion) . . . 125
Theorem 6.25 (Inner Products on $\mathbb{R}^n$ as Positive Definite Matrices) . . . 125
6.8 Singular Value Decomposition . . . 125
Theorem 6.26 (Singular Value Decomposition) . . . 125
Theorem 6.27 (Operator Norm as the Largest Singular Value) . . . 127
Theorem 6.28 (Properties of Singular Values) . . . 127
Theorem 6.29 (Eckart-Young Low-Rank Approximation) . . . 127
Definition 6.18 (Pseudo-Inverse) . . . 127
Definition 6.19 (Frobenius Norm) . . . 128
6.9 Polar Decomposition . . . 129
Theorem 6.30 (Polar Decomposition) . . . 129
6.10 Exercises . . . 129

**7 Normed Vector Spaces** **131**
Definition 7.1 (Norm) . . . 131
Example 7.1 (Absolute Value) . . . 131
Example 7.2 (Euclidean Norm, $L_2$-Norm) . . . 131
Example 7.3 (Taxicab Norm, Manhattan Norm) . . . 131
Example 7.4 (Infinity Norm, $L_\infty$-Norm) . . . 131
Example 7.5 (p-norm, $L_p$-Norm) . . . 131
Theorem 7.1 (Norm Induces Metric) . . . 132
7.1 Dual Spaces . . . 132
7.2 Norms of Linear Mappings . . . 132
Definition 7.2 (Operator Norm) . . . 132
Theorem 7.2 (Submultiplicativity of the Operator Norm) . . . 133
Theorem 7.3 (Properties of Matrix Norm) . . . 133
Theorem 7.4 (Spectral Radius Bounds the Operator Norm) . . . 133
Theorem 7.5 (Invertibility Is an Open Condition) . . . 133

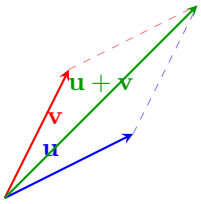
**8 Solving Systems of Linear Equations** **135**
Definition 8.1 (Linear System of Equations) . . . 135
Definition 8.2 (Coefficient Matrix) . . . 135
Definition 8.3 (Solved System) . . . 136
Theorem 8.1 (Elementary Operations Preserve the Solution Set) . . . 136
Definition 8.4 (Classification of Linear Systems by Solution Count) . . . 136
Theorem 8.2 (Criterion for an Inconsistent System) . . . 137
Corollary 8.3 (Overdetermined Systems with Independent Rows) . . . 137
Theorem 8.4 (Criterion for a Unique Solution) . . . 137
Theorem 8.5 (Free Variables and Multiple Solutions) . . . 138
Theorem 8.6 (Form of the General Solution) . . . 138
Example 8.1 (Solving a System by Row Reduction) . . . 138
Theorem 8.7 (Matrix Form of a Linear System) . . . 138
8.1 Numerical Methods . . . 139
Definition 8.5 (Relative Change in $x$ against Relative Change in $b$) . . . 139
Definition 8.6 (Error at the $n$th Stage) . . . 139
8.1.1 Method of Steepest Descent . . . 140
Theorem 8.8 (Linear Systems as a Variational Problem) . . . 140
Theorem 8.9 (Convergence of Steepest Descent) . . . 141
8.1.2 Method of Chebyshev Polynomials . . . 141
Definition 8.7 ($n$th Chebyshev Polynomial) . . . 142
Theorem 8.10 (Chebyshev Minimax Property) . . . 142

A multiple-year course in linear algebra at the advanced undergraduate and graduate level. The notes for this section can be a bit too abstract for someone learning linear algebra for the first time, so I suggest learning about groups, rings, and fields first.

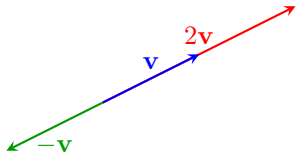
# 1 Vector Spaces

We begin with an axiomatic treatment of a vector space, which is one of the primary objects of study in linear algebra. Recall what a field is from algebra.

Before we start, note that when students learn about vectors for the first time, they are presented with two interpretations of vectors. First, we think of a vector as an arrow pointing in space, encoding both a *magnitude* and a *direction*. This is more of the physicists interpretation and is useful in visualizing these vectors in low dimensions (notably, 2 and 3).




(a) Addition is visualized using the "parallelogram rule."




(b) Scalar multiplication is simply an stretch of the vector.

The other interpretation is to simply see it as a tuple of numbers, which is useful when dealing with arbitrary dimensions. This interpretation is more suited to the intuition of a computer scientist, who can interpret vectors as arrays with element-wise operations.

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ a_2 \\ \vdots \\ a_n \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ \vdots \\ b_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 + b_1 \\ a_2 + b_2 \\ \vdots \\ a_n + b_n \end{pmatrix}$$

(a) Addition is done component-wise.

$$c \cdot \begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ a_2 \\ \vdots \\ a_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} ca_1 \\ ca_2 \\ \vdots \\ ca_n \end{pmatrix}$$

(b) Scalar multiplication is done component-wise.

Figure 2

By introducing a coordinate basis (also called a frame), we can unify the two interpretations above by decomposing each arrow into its component vectors, with magnitudes equal to the elements of the corresponding tuple. There are other ways that vectors are introduced.[1] Mathematicians try to unify the two[2] by generalizing both of these interpretations into the following definition.

**Definition 1.1 (Vector Space)**

A **vector space** $V$ **over a field** $\mathbb{F}$ is a set endowed with two operations—addition $+ : V \times V \to V$ and scalar multiplication $\cdot : \mathbb{F} \times V \to V$. It satisfies the following properties.

1. *Group Structure.* $(V, +)$ is an abelian group.
2. *Scalar Distributivity.* For $\lambda, \mu \in \mathbb{F}$ and $v, u \in V$, $(\lambda + \mu)v = \lambda v + \mu v$
3. *Vector Distributivity.* For $\lambda \in \mathbb{F}$ and $v, u \in V$, $\lambda(v + u) = \lambda v + \lambda u$
4. *Associativity of Scalar Multiplication.* For $\lambda, \mu \in \mathbb{F}$ and $v \in V$, $(\lambda\mu)v = \lambda(\mu v) = \mu(\lambda v)$

A **vector** is an element of a vector space.

We define some more vector spaces that are often used.

[1] Aspinwall mentioned that there are 4 or 5 ways? Another being in terms of derivations?
[2] similar to what 3Blue1Brown says in his Linear Algebra Youtube series.

**Example 1.1 ($\mathbb{R}^n$)**

The set of all $n$-tuples of real numbers $\mathbb{R}^n = \{(a_1, \dots, a_n) : a_i \in \mathbb{R}\}$ forms a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$ with component-wise addition and scalar multiplication. This is the foundational setting for analytic geometry, physics (mechanics, electromagnetism), engineering, computer graphics, machine learning, and economics.

**Example 1.2 ($\mathbb{C}^n$)**

The set of all $n$-tuples of complex numbers $\mathbb{C}^n = \{(a_1, \dots, a_n) : a_i \in \mathbb{C}\}$ forms a vector space over $\mathbb{C}$ (and also over $\mathbb{R}$, with dimension $2n$). Essential in quantum mechanics, signal processing (Fourier analysis), electrical engineering, and solving differential equations.

**Example 1.3 ($\mathbb{Z}_p^n$)**

The set of all $n$-tuples of elements in the finite field $\mathbb{Z}_p = \{0, 1, \dots, p-1\}$ (with $p$ prime) forms a vector space over $\mathbb{Z}_p$ with component-wise operations. Central to cryptography (elliptic curve cryptography, Reed-Solomon codes), coding theory, and computer science.

**Example 1.4 (Function Space)**

Let $X$ be any set. The set of all functions $f : X \to \mathbb{F}$ from $X$ to a field $\mathbb{F}$ forms a vector space over $\mathbb{F}$ with pointwise addition $(f + g)(x) = f(x) + g(x)$ and scalar multiplication $(c \cdot f)(x) = c \cdot f(x)$. The foundational object of functional analysis; appears in probability theory (random variables), signal processing, and differential equations.

**Example 1.5 (Continuous Functions)**

The set $C(I)$ of all continuous real-valued functions on an interval $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ forms a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$ with pointwise operations. Fundamental in real analysis, differential equations, Fourier series, and physics (modeling continuous phenomena).

**Example 1.6 (Polynomials of Finite Degree)**

The set of all polynomials of degree strictly less than $n$ with coefficients in $\mathbb{F}$ defines a vector space over $\mathbb{F}$. Widely used in numerical analysis (interpolation), approximation theory, and signal processing.

**Example 1.7 (Sequence Space $\ell^p$)**

The set of all sequences $(a_1, a_2, \dots)$ of elements in $\mathbb{F}$ such that $\sum_{i=1}^{\infty} |a_i|^p < \infty$ forms a vector space over $\mathbb{F}$ for $1 \leq p < \infty$. Core example in functional analysis; arises in statistics (finite variance sequences), signal processing, and probability theory.

The examples above should convince you that linear algebra is fundamental in almost every quantitative field, to the point where it should be considered universal knowledge.

**Theorem 1.1 (No Zero Divisors)**

There are no zero divisors of vector space $V$. That is,

$$\lambda v = 0 \implies \lambda = 0 \text{ or } v = 0 \tag{1}$$

*Proof.* $\lambda v = 0 \implies \lambda v + \lambda v = 0 + \lambda v \implies 2\lambda v = \lambda v \implies (2\lambda - \lambda)v = 0$. But $\lambda \neq 0$, so $v$ must equal 0. This leads to a contradiction.

Now we move onto the other primary object of study: the linear map.

**Definition 1.2 (Linear Map)**

Given vector spaces $V, W$ over the same field $\mathbb{F}$, a function $T : V \longrightarrow W$ is called a **linear map** if it satisfies the following linearity properties:

$$T(v_1 + v_2) = T(v_1) + T(v_2), \quad T(cv) = cT(v) \tag{2}$$

for all $v_1, v_2 \in V, c \in \mathbb{F}$.

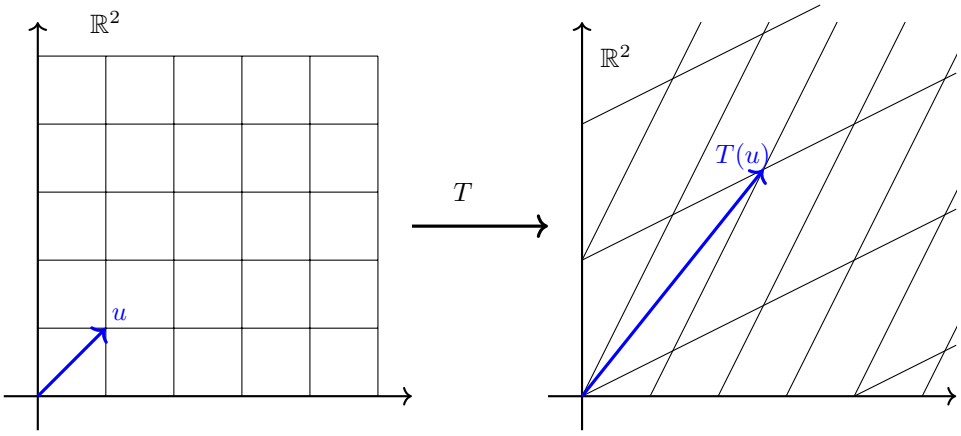



Figure 3: A great way to visualize this is that linear maps transform *lines to lines*. That is, we can think of the grid moving in a uniform way so that all squares become parallelograms. 3Blue1Brown has a really nice animation in his Linear Algebra Youtube Series.

**Definition 1.3 (Isomorphism)**

If a linear map $T : V \to W$ is called a **(vector space) isomorphism** if $T$ is bijective. In this case, $T^{-1}$ is also a linear map. Then, we say $V$ is **isomorphic** to $W$, denoted $V \simeq W$.

*Proof.* It suffices to show that bijection $\iff$ the inverse is linear.

Following the terminology in algebra, we sometimes call a linear map $T : V \to V$ an *endomorphism* and an isomorphism $T : V \to V$ an *automorphism*.

## 1.1 Basis and Dimension

While there are a lot of things we can do with the axioms themselves, it is often convenient to add in a bit of structure to our vector space. First, note that we can write out vectors as sums of other vectors.

**Definition 1.4 (Linear Combination)**

Given vector space $V$, a **linear combination** of a finite[a] number of vectors $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n \in V$ is a vector of the form

$$v = c_1 v_1 + c_2 v_2 + \ldots + c_n v_n \tag{3}$$

where $c_1, \dots, c_n \in \mathbb{F}$.

[a] We restrict ourselves to the finite case since we do not know how to evaluate series yet.

**Definition 1.5 (Span)**

The **span** of a collection of vectors $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n \in V$ is defined in the following equivalent ways:

1. *Smallest Subspace.* It is the intersection of all subspaces $W \subset V$ that each contains all $v_1, \dots, v_n$.[a]
2. *Set of Linear Combinations.* It is the subspace of vectors defined

$$\text{span}\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\} \coloneqq \{c_1 v_1 + c_2 v_2 + \ldots + c_n v_n \mid c_1, \dots, c_n \in \mathbb{F}\} \tag{4}$$

[a] This is the more general definition and extends to the infinite-dimensional case.

*Proof.*

It clearly follows that $v_1, \dots, v_n$ span the whole space $V$ if every vector in $V$ can be expressed as a linear combination of the $v_i$'s.

**Definition 1.6 (Linear Independence)**

Vectors $v_1, \dots, v_n$ are

1. **linearly independent** if

$$c_1 v_1 + c_2 v_2 + c_3 v_3 + \ldots + c_n v_n = 0 \implies c_1, \dots, c_n = 0 \tag{5}$$

2. **linearly dependent** if it is not linearly independent, i.e. there exists some $1 \leq i \leq n$ such that $v_i$ is in the span of vectors $v_1, \dots, v_{i-1}, v_{i+1}, \dots, v_n$.

**Definition 1.7 (Basis)**

A set of linearly independent vectors $v_1, \dots, v_n$ that span vector space $V$ is called a **basis** of $V$. These vectors $v_i$ are called **basis vectors**. Note that this basis is not unique; it is actually highly un-unique.

**Example 1.8 (Standard Basis)**

The basis $e_i$ of $\mathbb{F}^n$ are the vectors with every element equal to 0 except for the $i$th element, which is equal to 1.

**Theorem 1.2 (Maximally Independent Set is a Basis)**

Let $V$ be a vector space and $S$ be a subset of $V$ (not necessarily a subspace). Then, any maximal linearly independent subset $\{e_1, e_2, \dots, e_k\}$ of a set $S$ is a basis of $\operatorname{span} S$.

**Definition 1.8 (Dimension)**

The number of vectors in any basis of vector space $V$ is called the **dimension** of $V$, denoted $\dim V$.

*Proof.* We must show that this is well defined by proving that every possible basis of a vector space $V$ has the same number of vectors.

**Theorem 1.3 (Isomorphism to $\mathbb{F}^n$)**

Every $n$-dimensional vector space $V$ over $\mathbb{F}$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{F}^n$, the set of $n$-tuples of elements in $\mathbb{F}$.

**Corollary 1.4 (Isomorphism Between $n$-Dimensional Vector Spaces)**

Finite-dimensional vector spaces of the same field are isomorphic if and only if their dimensions are the same.

**Example 1.9 ($\mathbb{C}$ as a Real Vector Space)**

The field of complex numbers $\mathbb{C}$, regarded as a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$, has dimension 2.

## 1.2 Subspaces

**Definition 1.9 (Subspace)**

Given vector space $V$, A subset $W \subset V$ is a **subspace** if sums and scalar multiples of elements of $W$ belong to $W$.

Note that $\{0\}, V$ are subspaces of $V$. Regarding notation, when we write $W \subset V$ from now on, this is in the subspace sense, and not the set-theoretic subset.

**Definition 1.10 (Hyperplane)**

A $(n-1)$-dimensional subspace of an $n$-dimensional space is called a **hyperplane**.

**Definition 1.11 (Sum of Subspaces)**

The **sum of subspaces** $U_1, U_2, \dots, U_n \subset V$ is defined

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} U_i \coloneqq \Big\{ \sum_{i=1}^{n} u_i \mid u_i \in U_i \Big\} \tag{6}$$

That is, it is the set of all vectors that can be expressed as the sum of vectors in each of its respective space.

**Definition 1.12 (Direct Sum of Spaces)**

Given subspaces $U_1, \dots, U_n \subset V$, if $V_i$'s are pairwise disjoint—except at the origin—then we call their sum the **direct sum**.

$$\bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} V_i \equiv \Big\{ \sum_{i=1}^{n} v_i \mid v_i \in V_i \Big\} \tag{7}$$

It is a vector space where each vector can be expressed uniquely as the sum of vectors in each respective subspace.

*Proof.*

The crucial difference between the sum and the direct sum is that the direct sum requires the subspaces to be disjoint except for at the origin, which allows the expression of each vector in $V_1 \oplus \dots \oplus V_n$ to be unique. It is also worth noting that the Cartesian product of vector spaces is merely just the set of tuples of vectors that are in each respective space and is *not* a vector space (since addition and multiplication is not defined on that new set). If we define the operations component-wise, then

$$\prod_{i=1}^{n} V_i = \sum_{i=1}^{n} V_i \tag{8}$$

**Example 1.10 (Vector Space as Direct Sum of Basis)**

Note that we can also define the direct sum of spaces $U$ and $V$ by their basis. That is, given that the basis for $U$ is $\{e_i\}_{i=1}^n$ and the basis for $V$ is $\{f_j\}_{j=1}^n$, the basis for $U \oplus V$ is

$$\{(e_1, 0), (e_2, 0), \dots, (e_n, 0), (0, f_1), \dots, (0, f_m)\} \tag{9}$$

**Example 1.11 (Complex Vector Spaces as Real Vector Spaces)**

Vector spaces over one field can be interpreted as a vector space over another field. This is most common when interpreting complex vector spaces as real ones. For example, given a complex vector space $Z$ with basis $\{z_1, z_2, \dots, z_n\}$, every vector can be expressed as

$$z = \sum_{j=1}^{n} c_j z_j, \ c_j \in \mathbb{C} \tag{10}$$

We can set $c_j = a_j + b_j i$ uniquely, with $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$, and rewrite

$$z = \sum_{j=1}^{n} a_j z_j + b_j (i z_j) \tag{11}$$

$\implies \{z_j\} \cup \{iz_j\}$ forms a basis of $Z$ as a *real vector space*.

**Theorem 1.5 (Dimension of Direct Sum)**

The dimension of the direct sum of vector spaces is

$$\dim \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} V_i = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \dim V_i \tag{12}$$

*Proof.* This follows from the basis construction of the direct sum of $V_i$'s.

**Definition 1.13 (Congruence Relations on Vector Spaces)**

Given vector space $V$ and subspace $W \subset V$ we say that two vectors $v_1, v_2 \in V$ are **congruent modulo** $W$, denoted $v_1 \equiv v_2 \pmod{W}$, if $v_2 - v_1 \in W$. This is a congruence relation.

*Proof.* It remains to prove that $\equiv$ is a congruence relation. The congruence classes $\{y\}$ is the set of all vectors that are congruent modulo $W$ to $y$.

**Definition 1.14 (Quotient Vector Space)**

The **quotient (vector) space** $V$ modulo $W$, denoted $V/W$, is the set of all congruence classes modulo $W$. We can define addition and scalar multiplication on this set as such

$$[x] + [y] = [x + y] \tag{13}$$

**Theorem 1.6 (Decomposition into Subspace and Quotient Space)**

Given vector space $V$, $W$ a subspace of $V$. Then,

$$V \simeq W \oplus \frac{V}{W} \tag{14}$$

*Proof.*

## 1.3 Dual Spaces

Now we talk about dual spaces, which are nice since their construction and existence doesn't require us to have any structure on the vector space.

**Definition 1.15 (Dual Space)**

Given a vector space $V$ over $\mathbb{F}$, the **dual vector space** $V^\dagger$ is defined as the vector space of linear maps $\ell : V \to \mathbb{F}$. Given $\ell_1, \ell_2 \in V^\dagger$, $v \in V$, and $c \in \mathbb{F}$, we define

1. *Addition.* $(\ell_1 + \ell_2)(v) = \ell_1(v) + \ell_2(v)$.
2. *Scalar Multiplication.* $(c\ell_1)(v) = c\ell_1(v)$.

*Proof.* We must prove that this is indeed a vector space.

As the name suggests, we call the vectors of the dual space as *dual vectors*. Often, mathematicians will call

them *functionals*, since usually the base space $V$ is a vector space of functions, and functionals are mappings that act on functions. Analysis of this in the infinite-dimensional case requires much more machinery, so we will focus on the finite-dimensional case.

**Definition 1.16 (Dual Basis)**

Given a basis $\{e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n\}$ of $V$, the **dual basis** $\{f_1, f_2, \dots, f_n\}$ of $V^\dagger$ has vectors satisfying

$$f_j(e_i) = \delta_{ij} = \begin{cases} 0 & i \neq j \\ 1 & i = j \end{cases} \tag{15}$$

where $\delta_{ij}$ is called the **Kronecker delta function**.

*Proof.* We must show that $f_1, \dots, f_n$ is a basis of $V^\dagger$.

**Corollary 1.7 (Dimensions of Dual of Finite-Dimensional Vector Spaces)**

Let $V$ be a finite-dimensional vector space and $V^*$ its dual. Then,

$$\dim V = \dim V^\dagger \tag{16}$$

*Proof.*

While we initially view elements of $V$ as "things" and elements of $V^\dagger$ as linear functions, this thought is actually erroneous. Given $l \in V^\dagger$, we see that

$$l : V \longrightarrow \mathbb{F} \tag{17}$$

But since both $V$ and $V^\dagger$ are vector spaces, we can also see that given $x \in V$, $x$ is also a linear function

$$x : V^\dagger \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}, \text{ where } x(l) \equiv l(x) \tag{18}$$

But this means that $x$ is an element of $V^{\dagger\dagger}$ the dual of $V$! This statement is elaborated with the following theorem.

**Theorem 1.8 (Canonical Isomorphisms of Double Duals)**

Let $V$ be a vector space.

1. The map
$$J : V \to V^{\dagger\dagger}, \qquad J(v)(\ell) \coloneqq \ell(v) \tag{19}$$
is an injective linear map.
2. If $V$ is finite-dimensional, then $J$ is a natural isomorphism.[a]

[a] What we mean by natural is that we do not need to select a basis in either vector space to define the isomorphism.

*Proof.* We break this down in 3 steps.

1. *Linearity.* For all $v, w \in V$,
$$J(v+w)(\ell) \coloneqq \ell(v+w) = \ell(v) + \ell(w) = J(v)(\ell) + J(w)(\ell) \tag{20}$$
$$J(cv)(\ell) \coloneqq \ell(cv) = c\ell(v) = cJ(v)(\ell) \tag{21}$$
2. *Injectivity.* For all $\ell \in V^\dagger$,
$$J(v)(\ell) = 0 \implies \ell(v) = 0 \tag{22}$$

If $v \neq 0$, we can always find $\ell$ such that $\ell(v) = 1$. This must imply that $v = 0$, and so $\ker(J) = \{0\}$. So, $J$ is injective.
3. Using the fact that $\dim(V) = \dim(V^\dagger) = \dim(V^{\dagger\dagger})$, we can see that the linear injective map between 2 spaces of the same dimension must be surjective, and therefore an isomorphism.

**Example 1.12 (Infinite-dimensional Case)**

Note that the finite-dimensional case is important. Consider the space of finitely supported sequences, we will show that

$$V = \mathbb{F}^{(\mathbb{N})} \coloneqq \{(x_1, x_2, \ldots) \colon x_n = 0 \text{ for all but finitely many } n\} V^\dagger \simeq \mathbb{F}^{\mathbb{N}} \tag{23}$$

$$V^{\dagger\dagger} = \text{linear functionals on all sequences} \tag{24}$$

It has basis $\{e_1, e_2, \ldots\}$ but its dual is much larger, i.e. the space of all sequences.[a]

(25)

Indeed, every sequence $a = (a_1, a_2, \ldots)$ defines $\ell_a(x) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n x_n$ and the sum is always finite since $x$ has finite support. Now consider the canonical map

$$J : V \to V^{\dagger\dagger}, \quad J(v)(\ell_a) = \ell_a(v) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n v_n \tag{26}$$

But since $v$ has finite support, every functional in the image of $J$ depends on only *finitely many coordinates* of $a$. But there exists functionals in $V^{\dagger\dagger}$ that does not have this form(?)

[a] We do have to prove this.

On the contrary, there is no way to define an isomorphism between $V$ and $V^\dagger$ without further structure on $V$. In conclusion, this theorem tells us that it is important to be aware of this *duality* between elements $x \in V$ and $l \in V^\dagger$, and thus we should interpret $x \in V$ as a linear function of $V^\dagger$ and $l \in V^\dagger$ as a linear function of $V$.

**Definition 1.17 (Annihilator)**

Let $W$ be a subspace of $V$. Then the set of functions in $V^\dagger$ that vanish on $W$, that is, satisfy

$$l(w) = 0 \text{ for all } w \in W \tag{27}$$

is called the **annihilator** of $W$, denoted $W^0$. If $W = V$, then it is easy to see that $W^0$ is trivial.

**Theorem 1.9 (Annihilator and Dual Quotient Space)**

Let $V$ be a vector space and $W \subset V$. Then,
1. $W^0 \simeq (V/W)^\dagger$
2. $\dim W^0 + \dim W = \dim V$
3. $W^{00} = W$.

*Proof.* Listed.

1. The isomorphism is defined as such. Given $l \in W^0$, we define $L \in (V/W)^\dagger$ as

$$L\{x\} \equiv l(x) \tag{28}$$

**Theorem 1.10 (Quadrature Formula)**

Let $l$ be an interval on $\mathbb{R}$ containing $t_1, t_2, \dots, t_n$ $n$ distinct points. Then, given any polynomial $p$ with degree $< n$, there exist $n$ real numbers $c_1, c_2, \dots, c_n$ such that

$$\int_l p(t)dt = c_1 p(t_1) + c_2 p(t_2) + \ldots + c_n p(t_n) \tag{29}$$

called the *quadrature formula* suffices. That is, the integral of any polynomial over $l$ can be expressed as a linear combination of the polynomials evaluated at $n$ distinct points in $l$.

*Proof.* The space of all polynomials with degree $< n$ is an $n$-dimensional vector space, denote it $V$. We define the basis of the dual space $V^\dagger$ as

$$\phi_i(p) \equiv p(t_i),\ i = 1, 2, \dots, n \tag{30}$$

with addition and scalar multiplication defined

$$(\phi + \gamma)(p) \equiv \phi(p) + \gamma(p)$$
$$(c\phi)(p) \equiv c\phi(p)$$

We can see that the $\phi$'s are indeed linear since, given $p, q \in \mathbb{R}[t]$

$$\phi_i(p+q) = (p+q)(t_i) = p(t_i) + q(t_i) = \phi_i(p) + \phi_i(q)$$
$$\phi_i(cp) = (cp)(t_i) = cp(t_i) = c\phi_i(p)$$

We claim that all the $phi_i$'s are linearly independent. Assume that

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} c_i \phi_i(p) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} c_i p(t_i) = 0 \tag{31}$$

Since the $\phi$'s must be linearly independent for every polynomial $p$, set it equal to

$$q_k(t) \equiv \prod_{j \neq k} (t - t_j),\ k = 1, 2, \dots, n \tag{32}$$

$p = q_k$ must imply that all $\phi_i(p) = 0$ for all $i \neq k$, which implies that $c_k = 0$ in the linear combination. Repeating this for $k = 1, 2, \dots, n$ results in all $c_i = 0$, implying that the $\phi_i$'s form a basis of $V^\dagger$. Clearly, the function of definite integration over $l$ is a linear mapping from $V \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}$, meaning that it is in $V^\dagger$. Therefore, it can be expressed as a linear combination of $\phi_i$'s.

## 1.4 Exercises

**Exercise 1.1 (Lax 1.1)**

Show that the zero of vector addition is unique.

**Exercise 1.2 (Lax 1.2)**

Show that the vector with all components zero serves as the zero element of classical vector addition.

**Exercise 1.3 (Lax 1.3)**

Show that (i) and (iv) are isomorphic.

**Exercise 1.4 (Lax 1.4)**

Show that if $S$ has $n$ elements, (i) and (iii) are isomorphic.

**Exercise 1.5 (Lax 1.5)**

Show that when $K = \mathbb{R}$, (iv) is isomorphic with (iii) when $S$ consists of $n$ distinct points of $\mathbb{R}$.

**Exercise 1.6 (Lax 1.6)**

Denote by $X$ the linear space of all polynomials $p(t)$ of degree $< n$, and denote by $Y$ the set of polynomials that are zero at $t_1, \dots, t_j$, $j < n$. (i) Show that $Y$ is a subspace of $X$. (ii) Determine dim $Y$. (iii) Determine dim $X/Y$.

**Exercise 1.7 (Lax 1.7)**

Prove (i)-(iii) above. Show furthermore that if $x_1 \equiv x_2$, then $kx_1 \equiv kx_2$ for every scalar $k$.

**Exercise 1.8 (Lax 1.9)**

Show that the set of all linear combinations of $x_1, \dots, x_j$ is a subspace of $X$, and that it is the smallest subspace of $X$ containing $x_1, \dots, x_j$. This is called the subspace spanned by $x_1, \dots, x_j$.

**Exercise 1.9 (Lax 1.10)**

Show that if the vectors $x_1, \dots, x_j$ are linearly independent, then none of the $x_i$ is the zero vector.

**Exercise 1.10 (Lax 1.15)**

Show that the above definition of addition and multiplication by scalars is independent of the choice of representatives in the congruence class.

**Exercise 1.11 (Lax 1.11)**

Prove that if $X$ is finite dimensional and the direct sum of $Y_1, \dots, Y_m$, then

$$\dim X = \sum \dim Y_j. \tag{33}$$

**Exercise 1.12 (Lax 1.12)**

Show that every finite-dimensional space $X$ over $K$ is isomorphic to $K^n$, $n = \dim X$. Show that this isomorphism is not unique when $n$ is $> 1$.

**Exercise 1.13 (Lax 1.14)**

Show that two congruence classes are either identical or disjoint.

**Exercise 1.14 (Lax 1.18)**

Show that

$$\dim X_1 \oplus X_2 = \dim X_1 + \dim X_2. \tag{34}$$

**Exercise 1.15 (Lax 1.19)**

$X$ a linear space, $Y$ a subspace. Show that $Y \oplus X/Y$ is isomorphic to $X$.

**Exercise 1.16 (Lax 1.17)**

Prove Corollary 6': A subspace $Y$ of a finite-dimensional linear space $X$ whose dimension is the same as the dimension of $X$ is all of $X$.

**Exercise 1.17 (Lax 2.1)**

Given a nonzero vector $x_1$ in $X$, show that there is a linear function $l$ such that

**Exercise 1.18 (Lax 2.2)**

Verify that $Y^\perp$ is a subspace of $X'$.

**Exercise 1.19 (Lax 2.3)**

Prove Theorem 6: Denote by $Y$ the smallest subspace containing $S$:

$$S^\perp = Y^\perp. \tag{35}$$

**Exercise 1.20 (Lax 2.4)**

In Theorem 6 take the interval $I$ to be $[-1, 1]$, and take $n$ to be 3. Choose the three points to be $t_1 = -a$, $t_2 = 0$, and $t_3 = a$.

(i) Determine the weights $m_1, m_2, m_3$ so that (9) holds for all polynomials of degree $< 3$.
(ii) Show that for $a > \sqrt{1/3}$, all three weights are positive.
(iii) Show that for $a = \sqrt{3/5}$, (9) holds for all polynomials of degree $< 6$.

**Exercise 1.21 (Lax 2.5)**

In Theorem 6 take the interval $I$ to be $[-1, 1]$, and take $n$ to be 4. Choose the four points to be $-a, -b, b, a$.

(i) Determine the weights $m_1, m_2, m_3$, and $m_4$ so that (9) holds for all polynomials of degree $< 4$.

(ii) For what values of $a$ and $b$ are the weights positive?

**Exercise 1.22 (Lax 2.6)**

Let $\mathcal{P}_2$ be the linear space of all polynomials

$$p(x) = a_0 + a_1 x + a_2 x^2 \tag{36}$$

with real coefficients and degree $\leq 2$. Let $\xi_1, \xi_2, \xi_3$ be three distinct real numbers, and then define

$$\ell_j = p(\xi_j) \quad \text{for} \quad j = 1, 2, 3. \tag{37}$$

(a) Show that $\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3$ are linearly independent linear functions on $\mathcal{P}_2$.

(b) Show that $\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3$ is a basis for the dual space $\mathcal{P}_2'$.

(c) (1) Suppose $\{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ is a basis for the vector space $V$. Show there exist linear functions $\{\ell_1, \dots \ell_n\}$ in the dual space $V'$ defined by

$$\ell_i(e_j) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i = j, \\ 0 & \text{if } i \neq j. \end{cases} \tag{38}$$

Show that $\{\ell_1, \dots, \ell_n\}$ is a basis of $V'$, called the *dual basis*.

(2) Find the polynomials $p_1(x), p_2(x), p_3(x)$ in $\mathcal{P}_2$ for which $\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3$ is the dual basis in $\mathcal{P}_2'$.

**Exercise 1.23 (Lax 2.7)**

Let W be the subspace of $\mathbb{R}^4$ spanned by $(1, 0, -1, 2)$ and $(2, 3, 1, 1)$. Which linear functions $\ell(x) = c_1 x_1 + c_2 x_2 + c_3 x_3 + c_4 x_4$ are in the annihilator of W?

**Exercise 1.24 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 1.2)**

If $e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n$ is a basis for $V$ and we define linear maps $e_i'$ to $K$ by

$$e_i'(e_j) = \delta_{ij}, \tag{39}$$

then prove $e_1', e_2', \dots, e_n'$ form a basis for $V'$.

**Exercise 1.25 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 4.2)**

Find the Jordan Normal Form, $J$, of

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 4 & -2 & -6 \\ -1 & 2 & 2 \\ 1 & -1 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{40}$$

and a matrix $S$ such that $J = S^{-1}AS$.

**Exercise 1.26 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 4.3)**

Let $d^n(\alpha)$ denote the dimension of the nullspace of $(\alpha I - A)^n$ for a matrix $A$ and a scalar $\alpha$. In the following examples we list all the possible nonzero values of $d^n(\alpha)$. In each case find the Jordan Normal Form of $A$ or prove $A$ cannot exist.

1. $d^1(1) = 2$, and $d^n(1) = 3$ if $n \geq 2$.
2. $d^n(2) = 1$ if $n \geq 1$; $d^1(1) = 2$, $d^n(1) = 4$ if $n \geq 2$.
3. $d^1(1) = 1$, $d^n(1) = 3$ if $n \geq 2$.

**Exercise 1.27 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 7.1)**

Let

$$\sigma_x = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \sigma_y = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & i \\ -i & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \sigma_z = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{41}$$

Compute $\Delta(\sigma_x)\Delta(\sigma_y)$ if the state vector is $\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$. Is this consistent with the Heisenberg Uncertainty Principle?

**Exercise 1.28 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 8.1)**

Compute the singular value decompositions of the following matrices

1. $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
2. $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
3. $\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$

**Exercise 1.29 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 8.2)**

Let $M$ be any matrix over $\mathbb{R}$ and let $M^{(k)}$ be the rank $k$ approximation of $M$ we did in class. That is $M^{(k)}$ is obtained from an SVD of $M$ where we set all but the $k$ largest singular values to 0.

1. Show that $B = M^{(k)}$ is not the *unique* matrix that minimizes the norm

$$\|M - B\|_2 \tag{42}$$

   if $\sigma_k = \sigma_{k+1}$ where $\sigma_1 \geq \sigma_2 \geq \cdots$ are the singular values of $M$.
2. Discuss if $B = M^{(k)}$ is the unique matrix that minimizes this norm if $\sigma_k > \sigma_{k+1}$.

**Exercise 1.30 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 9.1)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & 1/3 \\ 1/2 & 0 & 1 & 1/3 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1/3 \\ 1/2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{43}$$

Compute the asymptotic behaviour of $A^N v$ where $v$ has coordinates $(1/4, 1/4, 1/4, 1/4)$ and $N$ is large.

**Exercise 1.31 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 10.1)**

Prove $v \otimes 0 = 0$ in $V \otimes V$ for any vector $v \in V$.

**Exercise 1.32 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 10.2)**

Prove there is a natural isomorphism between the vector spaces $\text{Hom}(V, V)$ and $V \otimes V^*$.

**Exercise 1.33 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 10.3)**

If $\{e1, e2, \cdots\}$ is a basis for $V$, which vector in $V \otimes V^*$ is identified with the identity in $\text{Hom}(V, V)$ under this isomorphism.

**Exercise 1.34 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 10.4)**

Given a map $f : Y \otimes X \to Z$ what is the naturally associated map $Y \to X^* \otimes Z$? Give your answer in terms of components assuming bases are given for all the spaces involved.

**Exercise 1.35 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 10.5)**

Let $V = \mathbb{R}^3$ with a basis $\{e_1, e_2, e_3\}$ and with the standard inner product. Consider the vector $v \in V \otimes V$ which if we write in terms of components

$$v = \sum_{ij} m_{ij} e_i \otimes e_j, \tag{44}$$

then the matrix $M$ with entries $m_{ij}$ is given by

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & -1 \\ 1 & -2 & -1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{45}$$

Find vectors $x_1, x_2, y_1, y_2 \in V$ such that

$$v = x_1 \otimes y_1 + x_2 \otimes y_2, \tag{46}$$

with $x_1$ perpendicular to $x_2$, and $y_1$ perpendicular to $y_2$.

**Exercise 1.36 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 10.6)**

What does the exterior algebra of $\mathbb{R}^3$ look like? What is the wedge product of two vectors?

**Exercise 1.37 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 11.1)**

The Baker-Campbell-Hausdorff formula says $e^A e^B = e^{A*B}$, where

$$A * B = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} F_k \tag{47}$$

and $F_k$ is of total order $k$ in $A$ and $B$. We have

$$F_1 = A + B \tag{48}$$

$$F_2 = \frac{1}{2}[A, B]. \tag{49}$$

Compute $F_3$ expressing it in terms of commutators.

**Exercise 1.38 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 11.2)**

Let $H = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$ and $S = \exp(i\theta H) \in \mathrm{SU}(2)$. Let $M$ be a traceless self-adjoint $2 \times 2$ matrix. Then let $M$ correspond to a three dimensional vector with components $(x, y, z)$ by decomposing using the Pauli matrices as

$$M = x\sigma_x + y\sigma_y + z\sigma_z. \tag{50}$$

Suppose we define

$$M' = S^{-1}MS. \tag{51}$$

Show $M'$ is also traceless and self-adjoint. If $M'$ is similarly associated to a three dimensional vector, show $S$ thereby induces a linear transformation on $\mathbb{R}^3$. What exactly is this transformation?

**Exercise 1.39 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 12.1)**

Recall that the Baker-Campbell-Hausdorff formula says the group law is given by $e^A e^B = e^{A*B}$, where

$$A * B = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} F_k \tag{52}$$

and $F_k$ is of total order $k$ in $A$ and $B$. We have

$$F_1 = A + B \tag{53}$$

$$F_2 = \frac{1}{2}[A, B]. \tag{54}$$

You computed $F_3$ last week and expressed it purely in terms of the bracket. Let $A$ and $B$ be elements of the vector space $V$ and let the bracket be a bilinear form $V \otimes V \to V$. Now think of this as an arbitrary map not necessarily given by commutators.

1. Prove $-(-B) * (-A) = A * B$ and thus the bracket obeys $[A, B] = -[B, A]$.
2. Using your knowledge of $F_3$, prove that associativity of the group law implies the Jacobi identity

$$[A, [B, C]] + [B, [C, A]] + [C, [A, B]] = 0. \tag{55}$$

**Exercise 1.40 (Math 403 Spring 2020, Week 12.2)**

Let $n$ denote the irreducible representation of $\mathfrak{sl}_2\mathbb{C}$ of dimension $n$. In class we showed $2 \otimes 2 = 3 \oplus 1$. Perform similar decompositions for:

1. $3 \otimes 2$
2. $\mathrm{Sym}^2 3$
3. $\Lambda^3 4$.

# 2 Linear Maps

Recall what a linear map is. Linear maps over vector spaces over different fields are generally not well defined since the definition of homomorphisms do not cover the fields in which vector spaces are associated with.

**Example 2.1 (Linear Map from $\mathbb{R}^2$ to $\mathbb{R}^2$)**

A nice visual is to imagine a linear map as "mapping squares to parallelograms."

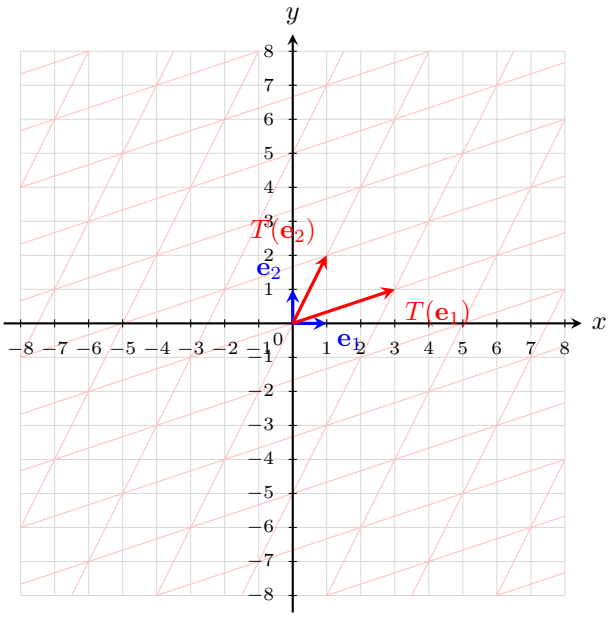



Figure 4: The basis vector $(1, 0)$ gets mapped to $(3, 1)$, and the vector $(0, 1)$ gets mapped to $(1, 2)$. Due to linearity, the map is completely determined. Given any $v \in \mathbb{R}^2$, since $\{e_1, e_2\}$ spans the domain, we can write $v = a_1e_1 + a_2e_2$. Therefore, $T(v) = T(a_1e_1 + a_2e_2) = a_1T(e_1) + a_2T(e_2)$. This means that we just need to take the same linear combination of the images of the basis vectors to find the image of $v$.

**Example 2.2 (Left Matrix Multiplication)**

Left matrix multiplication is a linear map from $\mathbb{R}^2$ to $\mathbb{R}^2$. Consider the matrix

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \tag{56}$$

Therefore

$$A(av + bw) = \begin{pmatrix} 3(av_1 + bw_1) + (av_2 + bw_2) \\ (av_1 + bw_1) + 2(av_2 + bw_2) \end{pmatrix} \tag{57}$$

$$= a \begin{pmatrix} 3v_1 + v_2 \\ v_1 + 2v_2 \end{pmatrix} + b \begin{pmatrix} 3w_1 + w_2 \\ w_1 + 2w_2 \end{pmatrix} \tag{58}$$

$$= a \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} v_1 \\ v_2 \end{pmatrix} + b \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} w_1 \\ w_2 \end{pmatrix} = aAv + aBw \tag{59}$$

**Example 2.3 (Differentiation)**

Let $C^1[a,b]$ be the vector space of all continuously differentiable functions $f : [a,b] \to \mathbb{R}$. Then, recall that

$$\frac{d}{dx}(f+g) = \frac{d}{dx}f + \frac{d}{dx}g \tag{60}$$

$$\frac{d}{dx}(cf) = c\left(\frac{d}{dx}f\right) \tag{61}$$

Therefore, this makes differentiation a linear operator.

**Example 2.4 (Integration)**

Let $C^0[a,b]$ be the vector space of all continuous functions $f : [a,b] \to \mathbb{R}$. Then, recall that

$$\int_a^b (f+g) = \int_a^b f + \int_a^b g \tag{62}$$

$$\int_a^b cf = c\int_a^b f \tag{63}$$

Therefore, this makes integration a linear operator.

## 2.1 Image and Null Space

Let's first recall some of the basic properties an notation for functions.

**Definition 2.1 (Image)**

The **image** of linear map $T : U \to V$, denoted $\text{Im}(T)$, is the range of $T$.

$$\text{Im}(T) \coloneqq \{T(u) \in V \mid u \in U\} \tag{64}$$

We claim $\text{Im}(T)$ is a subspace of $V$.

*Proof.* It suffices to show that the image is a subspace.

**Definition 2.2 (Rank)**

The **rank** of a linear map $A$ is the dimension of its image.

**Definition 2.3 (Nullspace, Kernel)**

The **nullspace** of $T : U \to V$, denoted $\ker(T)$, is the is the kernel of $T$.

$$\ker(T) \coloneqq \{u \in U \mid T(u) = 0\} \tag{65}$$

We claim $\ker(T)$ is a subspace of $U$.

*Proof.* It suffices to show that the image is a subspace.

**Example 2.5 (Image and Kernel of Quotient Map)**

Let $U_1$ be a subspace of $U$ and given the quotient map

$$\pi : U \longrightarrow U/U_1 \tag{66}$$

Then,

$$\ker \pi = U_1,\ \operatorname{Im} \pi = U/U_1 \tag{67}$$

Note that a quotient map is always surjective.

A key problem in linear algebra is to solve the following equation $Ax = b$, i.e. what is the set of all $x$'s such that $Ax = b$? The following theorem reduces this problem to finding one solution and the kernel of $A$.

**Theorem 2.1**

Given linear map $A : V \longrightarrow U$ and $b \in U$, then all solutions to the equation $Ax = b$ is of the form

$$a + \ker(A) \coloneqq \{a + v \in V : v \in \ker(A)\} \tag{68}$$

where $a$ is one solution.

*Proof.* Let $a, a'$ be any two solutions. Then, $Aa = b$ and $Aa' = b$. So

$$Aa - Aa' = 0 \implies A(a - a') = 0 \implies a - a' \in \ker(A) \tag{69}$$

**Corollary 2.2 (Injectivity via the Kernel)**

A linear map $A$ is injective if and only if $\ker A = 0$.

**Theorem 2.3 (Rank Nullity Theorem)**

Let $T : U \longrightarrow V$ be linear. Then,

$$\dim \ker T + \dim \operatorname{Im} T = \dim U \tag{70}$$

This theorem is quite intuitive, if we visualize the map.

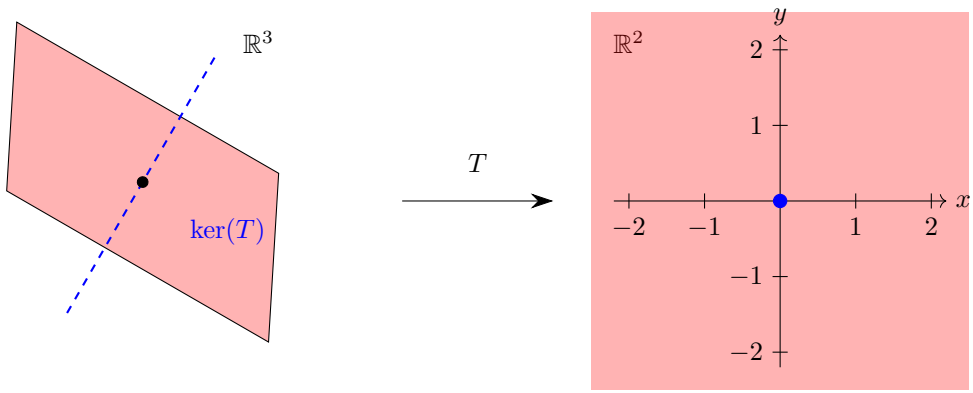



Figure 5: We just have to realize that given a linear transformation mapping from a $n$-dimensional $V$ to a $m$-dimensional $U$, every vector in $V$ will either get mapped to $0 \in U$ or will get mapped to a nonzero vector in $U$. In this case, the kernel will get mapped to 0 and everything else is (not always, but in this case) $\mathbb{R}^2$.

*Proof.*

## 2.2 Invertibility

We now introduce the concepts of left and right invertibility of linear mappings.

**Theorem 2.4 (Left/Right-Invertibility)**

A linear mapping $T : U \longrightarrow V$, with $\dim U = n, \dim V = m$, is **left-invertible**. That is, there exists linear $S$ such that

$$ST = I \tag{71}$$

if and only if $T$ is injective $\iff \operatorname{rank}(T) = n$. Linear $T$ is **right-invertible**, that is, there exists linear $S$ such that

$$TS = I \tag{72}$$

if and only if $T$ is surjective $\iff \operatorname{rank}(T) = m$.

*Proof.* We will only prove the case for left-invertibility. Right invertibility follows analogously.

1. ($\leftarrow$) $T$ is injective $\implies \operatorname{rank}(T) = \dim U = \dim \operatorname{Im} T$. Let $(\operatorname{Im} T)'$ exist such that

$$\operatorname{Im} T \oplus (\operatorname{Im} T)' = V \tag{73}$$

We define the isomorphism

$$\tilde{T} : V \longrightarrow \operatorname{Im} T \tag{74}$$

and then define $S$. Given that $v = w + w' \in V$, with $w \in \operatorname{Im} T, w' \in (\operatorname{Im} T)'$,

$$S : V \longrightarrow U,\ S(v) \equiv \tilde{T}^{-1}(v) \tag{75}$$

$\implies ST(u) = \tilde{T}^{-1}T(u) = u \iff ST = I$.

2. ($\rightarrow$) We prove the contrapositive. $T$ is not injective $\implies \dim \ker T > 0 \implies$ there exists 2 linearly independent vectors $x, y \in U$ such that

$$Tx = Ty \tag{76}$$

Assume that a left inverse $S$ exists. Then

$$x = STx = STy = y \implies x = y \tag{77}$$

leading to a contradiction $\implies$ the left-inverse does not exist.

**Definition 2.4 (Inverse)**

The inverse of a linear map $A$, denoted $A^{-1}$ is a unique linear map satisfying

$$AA^{-1} = A^{-1}A = I \tag{78}$$

where $I$ is the identity map.

**Corollary 2.5 (Invertible Linear Maps Are Isomorphisms)**

A linear map is invertible if and only if it is an isomorphism.

## 2.3 Factorization of Linear Maps

**Definition 2.5 (Invariant Subspace Under Linear Map)**

Given a subspace $U_1 \subset U$ and linear transformation $T : U \longrightarrow U$. We say that $U_1$ is **invariant** under $T$ if

$$u \in U_1 \implies Tu \in U_1 \tag{79}$$

The construction of the restriction is an enormously helpful tool for many proofs and very useful for factoring linear mappings.

**Definition 2.6 (Restriction)**

Let $\varphi : U \longrightarrow V$ be a linear mapping and let $U_1 \subset U, V_1 \subset V$ be subspaces. Such that

$$\varphi u \in V \text{ for all } u \in U \tag{80}$$

Then, the linear mapping

$$\varphi_1 : U_1 \longrightarrow V_1,\ \varphi_1 u = \varphi_u, u \in U_1 \tag{81}$$

is called the **restriction** of $\varphi$ to $U_1, V_1$. It suffices the identity

$$\varphi \circ i_U = i_V \circ \varphi_1 \tag{82}$$

where $i_U : U_1 \longrightarrow U, i_V : V_1 \longrightarrow V$ are canonical injections. Equivalently, we say that the diagram below is **commutative**.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & V \\ {\scriptstyle i_U}\uparrow & & \uparrow{\scriptstyle i_V} \\ U_1 & \xrightarrow{\varphi_1} & V_1 \end{array} \tag{83}$$

We can also define

$$\varphi_1 \equiv i_v^{-1} \varphi i_U \tag{84}$$

**Theorem 2.6 (Universal Property of Factorization)**

Given linear mappings $T : E \longrightarrow F$, $S : E \longrightarrow G$ such that $\ker T \subseteq \ker S$, there exists a map $\kappa$ such that

$$S = \kappa T \tag{85}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E & \xrightarrow{T} & F \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle S} & \swarrow{\scriptstyle \kappa} & \\ G & & \end{array} \tag{86}$$

Figure 6: The theorem states the existence of $\kappa$ satisfying the commutative diagram.

**Definition 2.7 (Induced Mapping of Quotients)**

Given $T : U \longrightarrow V$ with quotient maps

$$\pi_U : U \longrightarrow U/U_1, \qquad \pi_V : V \longrightarrow V/V_1 \tag{87}$$

the **induced mapping of the quotient spaces** is the unique mapping $\bar{T} : U/U_1 \longrightarrow V/V_1$ such that

$$\bar{T} \circ \pi_U = \pi_V \circ T \tag{88}$$

or equivalently, the following diagram commutes.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{T} & V \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_U} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_V} \\ U/U_1 & \xrightarrow{\bar{T}} & V/V_1 \end{array} \tag{89}$$

**Theorem 2.7 (First Isomorphism Theorem)**

Every linear mapping can be written as the composition of a surjective mapping followed by an injective mapping. That is, every $T$ can be factored into

$$T = T_{inj} \circ T_{surj} \tag{90}$$

*Proof.* We can induce a quotient mapping to construct a factoring of a linear mapping. We can define the unique mapping

$$\bar{T} : U/\ker T \longrightarrow V \tag{91}$$

such that, $T = \bar{T} \circ \pi_U$, or that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{T} & V \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_U} & \nearrow{\scriptstyle \bar{T}} & \\ U/\ker T & & \end{array} \tag{92}$$

commutes. Clearly, $\bar{T}$ is injective since if it were not, $\bar{T}\pi_U x = 0 \implies Tx = 0 \implies x \in \ker T \implies \pi_U x = 0$. This also means that the restriction of $\bar{T}$ to $U/\ker T$

$$\bar{\bar{T}} : U/\ker T \longrightarrow \operatorname{Im} T \tag{93}$$

is a linear isomorphism. Thus, for any $T$, it can be written as $\bar{T} \circ \pi_U$, with $\bar{T}$ injective and $\pi_U$ surjective.

**Theorem 2.8 (Second Isomorphism Theorem)**

Given $E_1, E_2$ subspaces of $E$. Then,

$$\frac{E_1}{E_1 \cap E_2} \simeq \frac{E_1 + E_2}{E_2} \tag{94}$$

In fact, they are naturally isomorphic.

*Proof.* $E_1 + E_2$ can be decomposed to $E_1' \oplus (E_1 \cap E_2) \oplus E_2'$, where $E_1'$ consists of the subspace of vectors $x$ that can only be expressed as $x = x_1, x_1 \in E_1$ and $E_2'$ are vectors that can only be expressed as $x = x_2, x_2 \in E_2$. Define the projection mapping

$$\text{proj} : E_1 + E_2 \longrightarrow E_1' \tag{95}$$

Since $E_1 = E_1' \oplus (E_1 \cap E_2)$, we can define the natural isomorphism

$$\kappa : E_1' \longrightarrow \frac{E_1}{E_1 \cap E_2},\ \kappa x = \{x\} \tag{96}$$

We now define the mapping $\varphi : E_1' \longrightarrow (E_1 + E_2)/E_2$ such that

$$\pi = \varphi \text{proj} \tag{97}$$

given by the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E_1 + E_2 & \xrightarrow{\pi} & \frac{E_1+E_2}{E_2} \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle proj} & \nearrow{\scriptstyle \varphi} & \\ E_1' & \xrightarrow{\kappa} & \frac{E_1}{E_1 \cap E_2} \end{array} \tag{98}$$

Such a $\varphi$ exists because proj is surjective and can thus be inverted. We now claim that $\varphi$ is an isomorphism. $\ker \text{proj} = \ker \pi = E_2 \implies \kappa$ is injective. Given $x = x_1 + y + x_2 \in E_1 + E_2$ such that $x_1 \in E_1', y \in E_1 \cap E_2, x_2 \in E_2'$,

$$\pi(x) = \pi(x_1 + y + x_2) = \pi(x_1) = \varphi \text{proj}(x_1) = \varphi(x_1) \tag{99}$$

meaning that for every vector $v \in (E_1 + E_2)/E_2$, it can be expressed as $v = \pi(x) = \varphi(x_1)$, meaning that there exists a $x_1 \in E_1'$ mapping to $v$ under $\varphi \iff \varphi$ is surjective. So, $\varphi$ is an isomorphism $\implies \varphi\kappa^{-1}$ is an isomorphism.

**Corollary 2.9 (Rank-Nullity for a Direct Sum)**

In the special case when $E_1 \oplus E_2 = E$, then the theorem states that

$$E_1 \simeq \frac{E}{E_2} \tag{100}$$

**Theorem 2.10 (Third Isomorphism Theorem)**

Let $V$ be a vector space, and let $W$ and $U$ be subspaces of $V$ such that $U \subset W$. Then $W/U$ is a subspace of $V/U$, and we have the natural isomorphism

$$\frac{V/U}{W/U} \simeq \frac{V}{W} \tag{101}$$

*Proof.* Define a linear map $T : V/U \longrightarrow V/W$ by $T([v]_U) = [v]_W$. This map is well-defined and surjective. The kernel of $T$ is the set of all $[v]_U \in V/U$ such that $[v]_W = [0]_W$, which implies $v \in W$. Thus $\ker(T) = W/U$. By the First Isomorphism Theorem, $(V/U)/\ker(T) \simeq \text{Im}(T)$, which yields $(V/U)/(W/U) \simeq V/W$.

Let $f_1, f_2, \cdots, f_n$ be any $n$ linear functionals of $U$. Define the subspace $F \subset E$ as

$$F \equiv \bigcap_{i=1}^{n} \ker f_i \tag{102}$$

and define linear map

$$T : U \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}^n,\ T(x) \equiv (f_1(x), f_2(x), \cdots, f_n(x)) \tag{103}$$

$\implies \ker T = F$. So, $T : U \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}^n$ defines the isomorphism

$$\bar{T} : U/F \longrightarrow \text{Im}\, T \tag{104}$$

## 2.4 Algebra of Linear Maps

We have linear maps, but what can we do with multiple linear maps? It turns out that the set of all linear maps from $V$ to $W$ is itself a vector space!

**Theorem 2.11 (Vector Space of Linear Maps)**

Let $V, W$ be vector spaces. Then, the set of all linear maps $T : V \to W$, denoted $\mathcal{L}(V, W)$, is a vector space. That is given linear maps $T, S : V \to W$ and scalars $a, b \in \mathbb{F}$, the map $aT + bS : V \to W$ is also linear.

*Proof.* We prove linearity of $T + S$ first. Given $u, v \in V$, $c \in \mathbb{F}$,

$$(T+S)(u+v) = T(u+v) + S(u+v) = T(u) + T(v) + S(u) + S(v) = (T+S)(u) + (T+S)(v) \tag{105}$$

$$(T+S)(cu) = T(cu) + S(cu) = cT(u) + cS(u) = c\big(T(u) + S(u)\big) = c(T+S)(u) \tag{106}$$

To prove linearity of $aT$, we have

$$(aT)(u+v) = aT(u+v) = a\big(T(u) + T(v)\big) = aT(u) + aT(v) = (aT)(u) + (aT)(v) \tag{107}$$

$$(aT)(cu) = aT(cu) = acT(u) = caT(u) = c(aT)(u) \tag{108}$$

If we restrict it to be the set of all endomorphisms, it turns out to be a bit more than that, since we can also compose mappings.

**Lemma 2.12 (Composition of Linear Maps is Linear)**

Given linear maps $T : U \to V$ and $S : V \to W$, the composition $S \circ T$—denoted $ST$—is a linear map.

*Proof.* We see that for addition, given $v, w \in V$,

$$(ST)(v+w) = S(T(v) + T(w)) = S(T(v)) + S(T(w)) = (ST)(v) + (ST)(w) \tag{109}$$

For scalar multiplication, given $c \in \mathbb{F}$, $v \in V$,

$$(ST)(cv) = S(T(cv)) = S(cT(v)) = cS(T(v)) = c(ST)(v) \tag{110}$$

In the theorem above, it seems like composition acts sort of like multiplication. Recall that such an algebraic structure that has both the properties of a vector space and multiplication is called an algebra.

**Theorem 2.13 (Algebra of Linear Maps)**

Let $V$ be a vector space. Then, the set of all linear maps $T : V \to V$, denoted $\mathcal{L}(V)$, is a noncommmutative associative algebra.

*Proof.* We prove the axioms of an algebra.

1. *Distributive Property.* Composition is (right and left) distributive with respect to addition.

$$(R + S) \circ T = R \circ T + S \circ T \tag{111}$$
$$T \circ (R + S) = T \circ R + T \circ S \tag{112}$$

Since $\mathcal{L}(V)$ is a vector space, we can endow it with a norm itself.

**Definition 2.8 (Operator Norm)**

Let $V, W$ be normed vector spaces. Given linear map $A \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$, the **operator norm** is defined as the norm

$$\|A\| \coloneqq \sup_{\|v\|=1} \|Av\| \tag{113}$$

*Proof.* We prove the 3 properties of the norm.

1. *Positive Definiteness.* Given linear map $A \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$, $\|Av\| \geq 0 \implies \|A\| \geq 0$. Also, $\|A\| = 0$ iff $\|Av\| = 0$ for all unit $v \in V$ iff $A = 0$.
2. *Absolute Homogeneity.* Given linear map $A \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$ and $c \in \mathbb{F}$,

$$\|cA\| = \sup_{\|v\|=1} \|(cA)v\| = \sup_{\|v\|=1} |c|\|Av\| = |c| \sup_{\|v\|=1} \|Av\| = |c|\|A\| \tag{114}$$

3. *Triangle Inequality.* Given linear maps $A, B \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$,

$$\|A+B\| \coloneqq \sup_{\|v\|=1} \|(A+B)v\| = \sup_{\|v\|=1} \|Av\|+\|Bv\| \leq \sup_{\|v\|=1} \|Av\|+ \sup_{\|v\|=1} \|Bv\| = \|A\|+\|B\| \tag{115}$$

Note that the operator norm is not an instrinstic property of the linear map. It depends on the norms endowed on the domain and codomain! There is another norm called the Frobenius norm, but this requires a basis.

**Lemma 2.14 (Operator Norm Bound)**

Let $V, W$ be normed vector spaces. For any linear map $A : V \to W$ and $v \in V$,

$$\|Av\| \leq \|A\|\|v\| \tag{116}$$

*Proof.* Immediate by definition.

**Lemma 2.15 (Uniform Continuity of Linear Maps)**

Let $V, W$ be finite-dimensional normed vector spaces. For all $A \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$, $\|A\| < +\infty$ and $A : V \to W$ is uniformly continuous over $V$.

*Proof.* Since all norms on finite-dimensional vector spaces are equivalent, let us choose the $L_2$ norm. Let $v_1, \dots, v_n$ be a basis for $V$. Then, for any unit $v \in V$, we can expand it as $v = c_1 v_1 + \dots c_n v_n$ where $|c_i| \leq 1$. So

$$\|Av\| = \left\| A\left( \sum_{i=1}^{n} c_i A v_i \right) \right\| \leq \sum_{i=1}^{n} |c_i| \|Av_i\| \tag{117}$$

$$\leq \sum_{i=1}^{n} \|Av_i\| < +\infty \tag{118}$$

since the images of each basis vector is a vector in $W$ of finite norm. Therefore, taking the supremum over $v$ leads to $\|A\| \leq \sum_i \|Av_i\| < +\infty$. As for uniformly continuous, let $u, w \in V$ and fix an $\epsilon > 0$. Then,

$$\|Av - Aw\| = \|A(v - w)\| \leq \|A\| \|v - w\| \tag{119}$$

Since $\|A\|$ is finite, we can set $\delta < \frac{\epsilon}{\|A\|}$, and so

$$\|v - w\| < \delta = \frac{\epsilon}{\|A\|} \implies \|Av - Aw\| \leq \|A\| \frac{\epsilon}{\|A\|} = \epsilon \tag{120}$$

**Lemma 2.16 (Cauchy Schwarz (Sort Of))**

Let $U, V, W$ be normed vector spaces. If $A \in \mathcal{L}(U, V)$ and $B \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$, then[a]

$$\|BA\| \leq \|B\| \|A\| \tag{121}$$

[a] Note that this is not really Cauchy Schwarz. First, this norm is not even induced by an inner product. Second, $A$ and $B$ are in completely different vector spaces!

*Proof.* By definition, we know that for $\|u\| = 1$,

$$\|A\| \geq \|Au\| \tag{122}$$

Also, for $\|v\| = 1$,

$$\|B\| \geq \|Bv\| \geq \left\| B \frac{Au}{\|Au\|} \right\| = \frac{1}{\|Au\|} \|BAu\| \tag{123}$$

Therefore, multiplying the two identities give

$$\|BAu\| = \|Au\| \frac{1}{\|Au\|} \|BAu\| \leq \|A\| \|B\| \tag{124}$$

**Theorem 2.17 (Subset of Invertible Maps are Open)**

Let $V$ be a normed vector space. If $A : V \to V$ is invertible and $B : V \to V$ satisfies

$$\|A - B\| \leq \frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}, \tag{125}$$

then $B$ is invertible and thus the set of all invertible maps, denoted $\Omega$, is an open set.

*Proof.* We can see that for all $v \in V$,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}\|v\| &= \frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}\|A^{-1}Av\| && (126)\\ &\leq \|Av\| && (127)\\ &= \|Av - Bv + Bv\| && (128)\\ &\leq \|(A-B)v\| + \|Bv\| && (129)\\ &\leq \|A-B\|\|v\| + \|Bv\| && (130) \end{aligned}$$

So if $v \neq 0$, then

$$\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}\|v\| \leq \|A-B\|\|v\| + \|Bv\| < \frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}\|v\| + \|Bv\| \tag{131}$$

This implies that $0 < \|Bx\|$. Therefore, $B$ has a trivial kernel and so $B$ is injective. By linearity, $B$ is also surjective. Therefore $B^{-1}$ exists. To prove openness, for every $A \in \Omega$, we can see that the ball of radius $\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}$ is contained in $\Omega$, and hence $\Omega$ is open.

**Theorem 2.18 (Inversion is Continuous Operator)**

Let $V$ be a normed vector space. Then, the map $A \in \mathcal{L}(V) \mapsto A^{-1} \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ is continuous.

*Proof.* Fix $\epsilon > 0$ and $A \in \Omega$. We wish to show that there exists a $\delta > 0$ s.t. for all $B \in \Omega$,

$$\|A-B\| < \delta \implies \|A^{-1} - B^{-1}\| < \epsilon \tag{132}$$

We can use the identity

$$\|A^{-1} - B^{-1}\| = \|A^{-1}(B-A)B^{-1}\| \leq \|A^{-1}\|\|B-A\|\|B^{-1}\| \tag{133}$$

$\|A^{-1}\|$ is constant and $\|B-A\|$ is bounded, so we wish to show that $\|B^{-1}\|$ is bounded.
Unfortunately, we don't have anything about $B^{-1}$ to work with here, but from the proof of the previous theorem, we can see that for all $v \in V$,

$$\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}\|v\| \leq \|A-B\|\|v\| + \|Bv\| \tag{134}$$

So this means that for all $w \in V$, since $B^{-1}$ exists, we can plug in $v = B^{-1}w$ to get

$$\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|}\|B^{-1}w\| \leq \|A-B\|\|B^{-1}w\| + \|w\| \tag{135}$$

Rearranging terms, we get

$$\left(\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|} - \|A-B\|\right)\|B^{-1}w\| \leq \|w\| \implies \|B^{-1}w\| \leq \left(\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|} - \|A-B\|\right)^{-1}\|w\| \tag{136}$$

Taking the supremum over all unit vectors $w$ gives

$$\|B^{-1}\| \leq \left(\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|} - \|A-B\|\right)^{-1} \tag{137}$$

But this still depends on $B$. Fortunately, we can let $\delta_1 = \frac{1}{2\|A^{-1}\|}$, and so

$$\|A-B\| < \delta_1 = \frac{1}{2\|A^{-1}\|} \implies \frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|} - \|A-B\| > \frac{1}{2\|A^{-1}\|} \tag{138}$$

$$\implies \left(\frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|} - \|A-B\|\right)^{-1} < 2\|A^{-1}\| \tag{139}$$

$$\implies \|B^{-1}\| \leq 2\|A^{-1}\| \tag{140}$$

Therefore, we have

$$\|A^{-1} - B^{-1}\| \leq 2\|A^{-1}\|^2 \|A-B\| \tag{141}$$

and by setting $\delta_2 = \frac{\epsilon}{2\|A^{-1}\|^2}$, we have

$$\|A-B\| < \delta_2 \implies \|A^{-1} - B^{-1}\| \leq 2\|A^{-1}\|^2 \frac{\epsilon}{2\|A^{-1}\|^2} \leq \epsilon \tag{142}$$

Therefore, we can set $\delta = \min\{\delta_1, \delta_2\}$.

## 2.5 Transpose

**Definition 2.9 (Transpose)**

Given a linear mapping $A : U \longrightarrow V$, let there exist a certain $\varphi \in V^*$. Then, there exists a corresponding $l \in U^*$ such that

$$l \equiv \varphi A \tag{143}$$

This mapping $A^T : V^* \longrightarrow U^*$ that assigns every $\varphi$ to a corresponding $l$ is called the **transpose** of $A$. Note that the transpose is canonically formed when defining any linear map. We do not need any additional structure on $U$ or $V$ to define $A^T$.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{A} & V \\ & \searrow^{l=\varphi A} & \downarrow \varphi \\ & & \mathbb{F} \end{array} \tag{144}$$

It is worth mentioning that $A^T$ maps every element in the annihilator $V^0$ to an element in $U^0$, but not necessarily the other way around.

**Theorem 2.19 (Annihilator of Image is the Kernel of the Transpose)**

For a linear map $A$, it is true that

$$(\operatorname{Im} A)^0 = \ker A^T, \quad \operatorname{Im} A = (\ker A^T)^0 \tag{145}$$

*Proof.*

## 2.6 Stable Subspaces and Induced Maps

**Definition 2.10 (Stable Subspaces)**

Given $T : E \longrightarrow E$, a subspace $E_1 \subset E$ is called **stable**

$$x \in E_1 \implies Tx \in E_1 \tag{146}$$

That is, the restriction of $T$ to $E_1$, denoted

$$T_1 : E_1 \longrightarrow E_1 \tag{147}$$

is well-defined. Clearly, $\operatorname{Im} T$ and $\ker T$ is stable, and the induced map

$$\bar{T} : E/E_1 \longrightarrow E/E_1 \tag{148}$$

is a linear endomorphism of $E/E_1$.

We end this subsection by defining the induced linear map from the direct sum of spaces.

**Definition 2.11 (Induced Linear Map on a Direct Sum)**

Given linear maps $T_i \in \text{End}(V_i)$ for $i = 1, 2, \cdots, n$, the induced linear map

$$\bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} T_i : \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} V_i \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} V_i \tag{149}$$

is defined

$$(\bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} T_i)(\bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} x_i) \equiv \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} T_i x_i \tag{150}$$

## 2.7 General Linear Groups

**Definition 2.12 (General Linear Group)**

The **general linear group** over vector space $V$ is the group of all automorphisms of $V$, denoted $\text{GL}(V)$.

**Definition 2.13 (Special Linear Group)**

The **special linear group** over vector space $V$ is the group of all automorphisms of $V$ of determinant 1, denoted $\text{SL}(V)$.

## 2.8 Exercises

# 3 Inner Product Spaces

One of the structures that we can put on a vector space is an inner product.

**Definition 3.1 (Inner Product)**

An **inner product** on a vector space $V$ over field $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{R}$ or $\mathbb{C}$ is a mapping

$$\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle : V \times V \longrightarrow \mathbb{F} \tag{151}$$

satisfying three properties

1. *First Argument Linearity.*[a] $\langle \lambda x + \mu y, z \rangle = \lambda \langle x, z \rangle + \mu \langle y, z \rangle$
2. *Conjugate symmetry.* $\langle x, y \rangle = \overline{\langle y, x \rangle}$
3. *Positive Definiteness.* $\langle x, x \rangle \geq 0$, with $\langle x, x \rangle = 0 \iff x = 0$

A vector space $V$ with an inner product is called an **inner product space**.

[a] When the field is $\mathbb{C}$, the inner product is **sesqui-linear**, that is, linear with respect to the first argument and **skew linear** with respect to the second. When $\mathbb{R}$, it is bilinear.

An inner product allows us to define some notion of an angle between two vectors in $V$. The inner product of a vector space $V$ over $\mathbb{R}$ is an element of $V^* \otimes V^*$. This concept of the metric tensor occurs when studying Riemannian manifolds in general relativity.

**Theorem 3.1 (Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality)**

Let $V$ be a vector space over $\mathbb{C}$. For all $v, w \in V$,[a]

$$|\langle v, w \rangle| \leq \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle} \sqrt{\langle w, w \rangle} \tag{152}$$

[a] This inequality is often written $|\langle v, w \rangle| \leq \|v\| \|w\|$, but we must first prove that the norm induced by an inner product is actually norm.

*Proof.* We use a variational method. First, if $\|w\| = 0$, then $w = 0$ so by first argument linearity, $\langle v, w \rangle = 0$ and the inequality trivially holds. Now for the case where $w \neq 0$, note that by positive definiteness of the norm, for all $t \in \mathbb{C}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &\leq \|v - tw\|^2 && (153)\\ &= \langle v - tw, v - tw \rangle && (154)\\ &= \langle v, v \rangle - \langle v, tw \rangle - \langle tw, v \rangle + \langle tw, tw \rangle && (155)\\ &= \|v\|^2 - \bar{t} \langle v, w \rangle - t \overline{\langle v, w \rangle} + t\bar{t} \|w\|^2 && (156)\\ &= \|v\|^2 - 2\text{Re}\{\bar{t} \langle v, w \rangle\} + t\bar{t} \|w\|^2 && (157) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, by setting

$$t = \frac{\langle v, w \rangle}{\|w\|^2}, \tag{158}$$

we get

$$0 \leq \|v\|^2 - 2\frac{\text{Re}\{\langle v,w\rangle\overline{\langle v,w\rangle}\}}{\|w\|^2} + \frac{\langle v,w\rangle\overline{\langle v,w\rangle}}{\|w\|^4}\|w\|^2 \tag{159}$$

$$= \|v\|^2 - 2\frac{\text{Re}\{|\langle v,w\rangle|^2\}}{\|w\|^2} + \frac{|\langle v,w\rangle|^2}{\|w\|^2} \tag{160}$$

$$= \|v\|^2 - 2\frac{|\langle v,w\rangle|^2}{\|w\|^2} + \frac{|\langle v,w\rangle|^2}{\|w\|^2} \tag{161}$$

$$= \|v\|^2 - \frac{|\langle v,w\rangle|^2}{\|w\|^2} \tag{162}$$

Since $|\langle v,w\rangle|$ is a real number. So, rearranging gives $|\langle v,w\rangle|^2 \leq \|v\|^2\|w\|^2$, and square rooting both sides gives the inequality.

*Proof.* For our second proof, we can restrict ourselves to real vector spaces and apply the same method to get we apply the steps in the previous proof to get

$$0 \leq \|v\|^2 - 2t\langle v,w\rangle + t^2\|w\|^2 \tag{163}$$

This is a quadratic form with respect to $t$, and since it is always greater than 0, it has no solutions. So the discriminant must be less than 0.

$$(2\langle v,w\rangle)^2 - 4\|w\|^2\|v\|^2 < 0 \tag{164}$$

Rearranging gives $|\langle v,w\rangle|^2 \leq \|v\|^2\|w\|^2$, and square rooting both sides gives the inequality.

**Example 3.1 (Dot Product)**

Given vectors $v, w \in \mathbb{R}^n$,

$$v \cdot w = \begin{pmatrix} v_1 \\ v_2 \\ \vdots \\ v_n \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} w_1 \\ w_2 \\ \vdots \\ w_n \end{pmatrix} \coloneqq \sum_{i=1}^{n} v_i w_i \tag{165}$$

**Example 3.2 (Integral Product)**

We haven't established any notion of integration yet, but after learning analysis, we can say the following. Let $C^0[a,b]$ be the space of all continuous real-valued functions defined over the interval $[a,b] \subset \mathbb{R}$. Given $f, g \in C^0[a,b]$,

$$\langle f,g\rangle \coloneqq \int_a^b f(x)g(x)dx \tag{166}$$

is an inner product on $C^0[a,b]$.

**Theorem 3.2 (Basis-Free Isomorphism Induced by Inner Product)**

The inner product endowed on $V$ induces a natural isomorphism between $V$ and $V^*$.

*Proof.* Fix $v \in V$. Then, we define the corresponding $l \in V^*$ to be the dual vector satisfying

$$l(w) = \langle w, v \rangle \tag{167}$$

for all $w \in V$.

## 3.1 Induced Norms

**Lemma 3.3 (Inner Product Induces Norm)**

An inner product induces a norm in the following way

$$\|v\| \coloneqq \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle} \tag{168}$$

*Proof.* We must prove that the following norm satisfies the three properties of a norm:

1. *Positive Definite.* For any vector $v \in V$,

$$\|v\| = \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle} = 0 \implies \langle v, v \rangle = 0 \implies v = 0 \tag{169}$$

2. *Absolute Homogeneity.* For any vector $v \in V$ and $c \in \mathbb{F}$,

$$\|cv\| = \sqrt{\langle cv, cv \rangle} = \sqrt{c^2 \langle v, v \rangle} = |c| \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle} = |c| \|v\| \tag{170}$$

3. *Triangle Inequality.* For all $v, w \in V$, we can use Cauchy-Schwarz to get

$$\begin{aligned} \|v + w\|^2 &= \|v\|^2 + \langle v, w \rangle + \langle w, v \rangle + \|w\|^2 && (171) \\ &\leq \|v\|^2 + 2\|v\|\|w\| + \|w\|^2 && (172) \\ &= (\|v\| + \|w\|)^2 && (173) \end{aligned}$$

Then square rooting both sides gives $\|v + w\| \leq \|v\| + \|w\|$.

Now combining the following theorems give the fact that if $\| \cdot \|$ is the norm induced by an inner product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$, then $|\langle v, w \rangle| \leq \|v\| \|w\|$.

**Theorem 3.4 (Parallelogram Identity)**

Let $V$ be a real vector space with norm $\|v\| \coloneqq \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle}$. Then, the identity holds for all $u, v \in V$.

$$\|u + v\|^2 + \|u - v\|^2 = 2\|u\|^2 + 2\|v\|^2 \tag{174}$$

*Proof.* We simply expand

$$\begin{aligned} \|u + v\|^2 + \|u - v\|^2 &= \langle u, u \rangle + 2\langle u, v \rangle + \langle v, v \rangle + \langle u, u \rangle - 2\langle u, v \rangle + \langle v, v \rangle && (175) \\ &= 2\langle u, u \rangle + 2\langle v, v \rangle && (176) \\ &= 2\|u\|^2 + 2\|v\|^2 && (177) \end{aligned}$$

Similar to metrization of topological spaces, a natural question to ask is whether all norms are induced by some inner product. The answer is no.

**Example 3.3 (L1 Norm)**

The L1 norm on $\mathbb{R}^n$ is not induced by any inner product, since if it was, the parallelogram identity will hold for all $u, v \in \mathbb{R}^2$. But for $u = (1, 0), v = (0, 1)$, and $u + v = (1, 1), u - v = (1, -1)$, we have

$$\|u + v\|^2 + \|u - v\|^2 = 2^2 + 2^2 = 8 \neq 4 = 2 + 2 = 2\|u\|^2 + 2\|v\|^2 \tag{178}$$

**Theorem 3.5 (Variational Definition of Norm)**

$$\|v\| = \max_{\|w\|=1} \langle v, w \rangle \tag{179}$$

*Proof.* It suffices to prove the following inequalities.

1. $\max_{\|w\|=1} \langle v, w \rangle \leq \|v\|$. Let $v \in V$ and $w \in V$ be a unit vector. Then,

$$\langle v, w \rangle \leq \|v\|\|w\| = \|v\| \tag{180}$$

   Therefore, by taking the maximum of both sides we get the desired result.

2. $\max_{\|w\|=1} \langle v, w \rangle \geq \|v\|$. Consider the case when $w = \frac{v}{\|v\|}$. Then,

$$\langle v, w \rangle = \langle v, \frac{v}{\|v\|} \rangle = \frac{1}{\|v\|} \langle v, v \rangle = \frac{\|v\|^2}{\|v\|} = \|v\| \tag{181}$$

   Therefore, the maximum of $\langle v, w \rangle$ must be at least $\|v\|$.

## 3.2 Orthogonality

**Definition 3.2 (Orthogonal Vectors)**

Two vectors $v, w \in V$ of an inner product space are said to be **orthogonal** if

$$\langle v, w \rangle = 0 \tag{182}$$

Note that the definition of orthogonality is dependent on the definition of the inner product. If the inner product is defined differently, then orthogonality will be defined differently. In the case when the inner product is defined to be the dot product, orthogonality is defined to be the "normal" perpendicularity between vectors. We can further define subspaces to be orthogonal.

**Definition 3.3 (Orthogonal Subspaces)**

Two subspaces $U, W$ of inner product space $V$ are said to be orthogonal to each other if

$$\langle u, w \rangle = 0, \qquad u \in U, w \in W \tag{183}$$

**Definition 3.4 (Orthogonal Complement)**

Given a subspace $W$ of inner product space $V$, the **orthogonal complement** of $W$, denoted $W^\perp$, is defined

$$\{v \in V : \langle v, w \rangle = 0 \quad \forall w \in W\} \tag{184}$$

which is the set of all vectors in $V$ orthogonal to every vector in $W$.

**Definition 3.5 (Orthogonal, Orthonormal Basis)**

A basis $\{v_i\}_i$ of an inner product space $V$ is said to be **orthogonal** if for every pair $i, j$ where $i \neq j$, $\langle v_i, v_j \rangle = 0$. It is said to be **orthonormal** if

$$\langle v_i, v_j \rangle = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases} \text{ [a]} \tag{185}$$

[a] This is often called the *Kronecker delta function*.

## 3.3 Projections

**Definition 3.6 (Projection)**

A **projection mapping** is a linear mapping $P$ where

$$P = P^2 \tag{186}$$

The concept of orthogonality also allows us to define orthogonal projections onto a vector or subspace.

**Lemma 3.6 (Orthogonal Decomposition Theorem)**

Given subspace $W$ of inner product space $V$,

$$W \oplus W^\perp = V \tag{187}$$

*Proof.* Take any vector $v \in V$, and take

$$w = \underset{u \in W}{\operatorname{argmin}} \|u - v\|^2 \tag{188}$$

which is well defined since subspace $W$ is closed, $u \to \|u - v\|^2$ is continuous, and so by the Extreme Value Theorem, the minimum is attained. Now set

$$w^\perp = v - w. \tag{189}$$

We wish to show that $\langle w^\perp, u \rangle = 0$ for all $u \in W$. For sake of contradiction, assume that this isn't true, and we want to arrive at a result that contradicts the fact that $w$ is really the minimizer. So, there exists some $u_0 \in W$ s.t. $\langle w^\perp, u_0 \rangle = c \neq 0$. WLOG assume $\|u_0\| = 1$. Choose a new vector

$$u_1 = w + \overline{c} u_0 \in W \tag{190}$$

where $\overline{c}$ is the complex conjugate of $c$. Note that $u_1$—as a linear combination of vectors in $W$—is also in $W$. Now let's take a look at the distance between $u_1$ and $v$.

$$\begin{aligned} \|v - u_1\|^2 &= \|v - w - \overline{c} u_0\|^2 && (191) \\ &= \|w^\perp - \overline{c} u_0\|^2 && (192) \\ &= \langle w^\perp - \overline{c} u_0, w^\perp - \overline{c} u_0 \rangle && (193) \\ &= \langle w^\perp, w^\perp \rangle - \overline{c} \langle w^\perp, u_0 \rangle - \overline{c} \langle u_0, w^\perp \rangle + c\overline{c} \langle u_0, u_0 \rangle && (194) \\ &= \|w^\perp\|^2 - \overline{c} c - c\overline{c} + c\overline{c} && (195) \\ &= \|w^\perp\|^2 - |c|^2 < \|w^\perp\|^2 && (196) \end{aligned}$$

This contradicts the fact that $w$ minimizes $u \mapsto \|u - v\|^2$, and we are done. Now to prove uniqueness, assume that there is another decomposition $v = w' + w'^{\perp}$. Then,

$$w + w^{\perp} = w' + w'^{\perp} \implies w - w' = w'^{\perp} - w' \tag{197}$$

But the LHS is a vector in $W$ and the RHS is a vector in $W^{\perp}$. The only such vector in both subspaces is 0.

With this decomposition theorem, the orthogonal projection operator is well-defined.

**Definition 3.7 (Orthogonal Projection)**

Let $v \in V$ and let $W$ be a subspace of $V$. The **orthogonal projection** of $v$ onto $W$ is then defined as

$$\text{proj}_W(v) = w \tag{198}$$

where $v = w + w^{\perp}$, where $w \in W, w^{\perp} \in W^{\perp}$, is the orthogonal decomposition of $v$.

**Lemma 3.7 (Orthogonal Projections are Linear)**

Orthogonal projections are linear transformations.

*Proof.* Let $u, v \in V$, $c \in \mathbb{F}$, and $W$ be a subspace of $V$. Then, the orthogonal decompositions are $u = u_W + u_W^{\perp}$, $v = v_W + v_W^{\perp}$. Therefore, the following are valid orthogonal decompositions of $u + v$ and $cu$:

$$u + v = (u_W + v_W) + (u_W^{\perp} + v_W^{\perp}) \tag{199}$$

$$cu = cu_W + cu_W^{\perp} \tag{200}$$

Since orthogonal decompositions are unique, this defines the linear map.

**Lemma 3.8 (Orthogonal Projection Formula onto 1-Dimension in $\mathbb{R}^n$)**

Let $W = \text{span}\{w\}$ be a 1-dimensional subspace of $\mathbb{R}^n$. Then, the orthogonal projection of $v$ onto $W$ is

$$\text{proj}_W(v) = \frac{\langle v, w \rangle}{\|w\|^2} w \tag{201}$$

*Proof.* By definition of the orthogonal projection, we are looking for the minimizer

$$\underset{u \in W}{\text{argmin}} \, \|v - u\|^2 \tag{202}$$

Since $u \in W$, we can simply rewrite this problem as

$$\underset{t \in \mathbb{R}}{\text{argmin}} \, \|v - tw\|^2 \tag{203}$$

By expanding, we need to minimize the quadratic form

$$\langle v, v \rangle - 2t\langle v, w \rangle + t^2 \langle w, w \rangle \tag{204}$$

with respect to $t$. This is a parabola that clearly opens up, and so the minimizer is

$$t = -\frac{-2\langle v, w\rangle}{2\langle w, w\rangle} = \frac{\langle v, w\rangle}{\|w\|^2} \tag{205}$$

**Theorem 3.9 (Orthogonal Projection Formula in $\mathbb{R}^n$)**

Given $k$-dimensional subspace $W$ of $\mathbb{R}^n$ with an *orthogonal* basis $\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_k\}$, the orthogonal projection of $v \in \mathbb{R}^n$ to $W$ can be computed with the formula

$$\text{proj}_W(v) = \sum_{i=1}^{k} \text{proj}_{w_i}(v) = \sum_{i=1}^{k} \frac{\langle v, w_i\rangle}{\|w_i\|^2} w_i \tag{206}$$

*Proof.* Let's decompose $v$ into the basis of $w_i$'s, plus some orthogonal term in $W^\perp$.[a]

$$v = a_1 w_1 + \ldots + a_k w_k + w^\perp, \qquad w^\perp = W^\perp \tag{207}$$

By linearity of projection,

$$\text{proj}_W(v) = \left(\sum_{i=1}^{k} a_i \,\text{proj}_W(w_i)\right) + \text{proj}_W(w^\perp) \tag{208}$$

$$= \left(\sum_{i=1}^{k} a_i w_i\right) + 0 \tag{209}$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^{k} a_i \,\text{proj}_{w_i}(v) \tag{210}$$

Note that in the last line, we need the orthogonality of the $w_i$'s.

[a] I first tried to prove it by letting $u = \text{proj}_W(v) \implies v = w + w^\perp$, and $u_i = \text{proj}_{w_i}(u) \implies v = u_i + u_i^\perp$. Then I tried setting $w + w^\perp = u_i + u_i^\perp$ for all $i$, but this requires me to prove some properties of the projection with respect to the vector being projected on. So I'm not allowed to use linearity here and was stuck.

Given that we have an orthonormal basis $\{r_i\}_{i=1}^k$ of subspace $Y$ in $\mathbb{R}^n$, we can more simply define

$$\text{proj}_Y(x) = \sum_{i=1}^{k} \langle x, r_i\rangle r_i \tag{211}$$

**Theorem 3.10 (Gram-Schmidt)**

Every basis in a finite-dimensional vector space can be transformed into an orthonormal basis.

*Proof.* We start off with any basis, not necessarily orthonormal, of $X$, denoted $\{x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n\}$. We first assign

$$x_1 = l_1 \tag{212}$$

Then we take $x_2$ and find the orthogonal component (with respect to $l_1$) with the equation

$$l_2 = x_2 - \text{proj}_{l_1}(x_2) \tag{213}$$

This creates an orthogonal basis for $\text{span}\{x_1, x_2\}$. Then we take $x_3$ and find the orthogonal component

(with respect to span$\{l_1, l_2\}$.

$$l_3 = x_3 - \text{proj}_{l_1}(x_3) - \text{proj}_{l_2}(x_3) \tag{214}$$

This creates an orthogonal basis for span$\{x_1, x_2, x_3\}$. We repeat this process until we complete the basis of $X$, using the general equation

$$l_k = x_k - \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \text{proj}_{l_k}(x_k) = x_k - \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \frac{x_k \cdot l_k}{\|l_k\|^2} l_k, \ k = 1, 2, \cdots, n \tag{215}$$

Finally, we take these orthogonal vectors and normalize them to magnitude 1. Note that this algorithm does not produce a unique orthonormal basis. Rather, it is highly un-unique.

## 3.4 Isometries

**Definition 3.8 (Isometry)**

An **isometry** $M$ of metric space $(X, d)$ is a mapping that preserves all distances. That is, for all $x, y \in X$,

$$d(x, y) = d(Mx, My) \tag{216}$$

The set of all isometries, denoted Isom$(X)$, is a group that is generated by all translations, rotations, and reflections.

**Example 3.4 (Rotations and Reflections Are Isometries)**

A rotation around any axis or a flip across any hyperplane are all isometries.

Since linear maps always preserve the origin, we will focus on origin-preserving isometries, which is a subgroup called the orthogonal group.

**Definition 3.9 (Orthogonal Group)**

The **orthogonal group**, denoted $O(n)$, is the group of all linear isometries of $\mathbb{R}^n$.

**Definition 3.10 (Special Orthogonal Group)**

The **special orthogonal group**, denoted $SO(n)$, is the group of all isometries of $\mathbb{R}^n$ that preserve the handedness.

$SO(n)$ is a subgroup of $O(n)$. We extend this concept to complex Euclidean spaces.

**Definition 3.11 (Unitary Group)**

The **unitary group**, denoted $U(n)$ is the group of all isometrices of $\mathbb{C}^n$.

**Example 3.5 ($U(1)$ as the Unit Circle)**

$U(1)$ is the set of complex numbers with norm 1.

**Definition 3.12 (Special Unitary Group)**

The **special unitary group**, denoted $SU(n)$ is the group of all isometrices of $\mathbb{C}^n$ that preserve the handedness.

The groups mentioned in this section are examples of *Lie Groups*. Lie groups in general will not be defined in here, since they require knowledge of smooth manifolds and differential geometry. In order to analyze these abstract groups, we use the exponential map $e \in \text{End}(\text{ Mat}(n, \mathbb{F})$ to reduce these Lie groups to Lie algebras.

## 3.5 Adjoint Operators

Let $A : U \to V$ be a linear mapping between inner product spaces, with the inner product in $U$ and $V$ denoted $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_U$ and $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_V$, respectively. First, fix any $v \in V$ and define the linear function $l \in U^*$

$$l(\cdot) \coloneqq \langle A(\cdot), v \rangle_V \tag{217}$$

Since $U$ is naturally isomorphic to $U^*$, for this specific $l$, we can find a $u \in U$ such that

$$l(\cdot) \coloneqq \langle A(\cdot), v \rangle_V = \langle \cdot, u \rangle_U \tag{218}$$

Such a map from $v \mapsto u$ is linear (should verify this), and we call this map the *adjoint operator* $A^\dagger : V \to U$. Therefore, we can write the equation above to

$$\langle A(\cdot), v \rangle_V = \langle \cdot, A^\dagger(u) \rangle \tag{219}$$

**Definition 3.13 (Adjoint Operator)**

Let $A : U \to V$ be a linear mapping between inner product spaces. Then, the **adjoint operator** of $A$ is any operator $A^\dagger : V \to U$ such that

$$\langle u, A^\dagger v \rangle_U = \langle Au, v \rangle_V \tag{220}$$

for all $u, v \in U$.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{A} & V \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle i} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle j} \\ U^* & \xleftarrow[A^T]{} & V^* \end{array}$$

Figure 7: The adjoint operator is the map $A^\dagger$ such that the diagram commutes.

It is important to note that the adjoint is not the same as the transpose since the transpose is a mapping between the dual spaces. Furthermore, the transpose is canonically defined upon defining the linear transformation $A : U \to V$, while defining the adjoint requires the additional structure of an isomorphism from $U$ to $U^*$ and from $V$ to $V^*$. There are two ways to define these isomorphisms.

First, we can define dot products on both $U$ and $V$ and define the natural isomorphism

$$i : U \longrightarrow U^*,\ i(u) \equiv (u, \cdot) \in U^*$$
$$j : V \longrightarrow V^*,\ j(v) \equiv (v, \cdot) \in V^*$$

This canonically creates the mapping

$$i^{-1} A^T j : V \longrightarrow U \tag{221}$$

which we define as the adjoint $A^\dagger$. This method using natural isomorphisms is precisely how we have defined the adjoint above. There is a second way, however. We can fix **orthonomal** bases on $U$ and $V$ and then assign them their respective dual spaces (satisfying the Kronecker delta function). Let the basis of $U$ be $\{u_1, \cdots, u_n\}$, $U^*$ be $\{u_1', \cdots, u_n'\}$, $V$ be $\{v_1, \cdots, v_m\}$, and $V^*$ be $\{v_1', \cdots, v_m'\}$. Now we can define the isomorphisms

$$i' : U \longrightarrow U^*,\ i'(u) \equiv c_1 u_1' + \cdots + c_n u_n'$$
$$j' : V \longrightarrow V^*,\ j'(v) \equiv k_1 v_1' + \cdots + k_m v_m'$$

and then define the adjoint as

$$A^\dagger \equiv i'^{-1} A^T j' \tag{222}$$

Let us compare these two definitions. Given a vector $u = a_1 u_1 + \cdots + a_n u_n, \tilde{u} = b_1 u_1 + \cdots b_n u_n \in U$,

$$i(u)(\tilde{u}) \equiv (u, \tilde{u}) = \Big( \sum_{\alpha=1}^n a_\alpha u_\alpha, \sum_{\beta=1}^n b_\beta u_\beta \Big) = \sum_{\alpha,\beta} a_\alpha b_\beta \delta_\beta^\alpha = \sum_{\gamma=1}^n a_\gamma b_\gamma$$
$$i'(u)(\tilde{u}) \equiv \Big( \sum_{i=1}^n a_i u_i' \Big) \Big( \sum_{j=1}^n b_j u_j \Big) = \sum_{i,j} a_i b_j u_i'(u_j) = \sum_{i,j} a_i b_j \delta_j^i = \sum_{k=1}^n a_k b_k$$

Similarly for vector $v = g_1 v_1 + \cdots g_n v_n, \tilde{v} = h_1 v_1 + \cdots + h_n v_n \in V$,

$$i(v)(\tilde{v}) \equiv (v, \tilde{v}) = \Big( \sum_{\alpha=1}^n g_\alpha v_\alpha, \sum_{\beta=1}^n h_\beta v_\beta \Big) = \sum_{\alpha,\beta} g_\alpha h_\beta \delta_\beta^\alpha = \sum_{\gamma=1}^n g_\gamma h_\gamma$$
$$i'(v)(\tilde{v}) \equiv \Big( \sum_{i=1}^n g_i u_i' \Big) \Big( \sum_{j=1}^n h_j v_j \Big) = \sum_{i,j} g_i h_j v_i'(v_j) = \sum_{i,j} g_i h_j \delta_j^i = \sum_{k=1}^n g_k h_k$$

Therefore, $i = i'$ and $j = j'$, meaning that the two derivations of the adjoint $A = i^{-1} A^T j = i^{-1\prime} A^T j'$ are exactly the same! We must note that the basis endowed on both $U$ and $V$ must be orthonormal for it to "mimic" the inner product. The derivation of the adjoint in these two equivalent methods may help the reader further understand that the adjoint $A^\dagger$ is really just a composition of fundamental linear functions $j : V \longrightarrow V^*$, $A^T : V^* \longrightarrow U^*$, and $i^{-1} : U^* \longrightarrow U$ that are all canonically created as soon as $A : U \longrightarrow V$ is created, along with the inner product spaces $U$ and $V$.

However, it is hard to grasp a visual intuition of adjoint operators in general. Note that the properties of the transpose indicate that given $A : \mathbb{R}^n \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ with the standard orthonormal basis and dot product, the matrix representation of $A^\dagger$ is just $A^T$. If $A$ is a matrix over $\mathbb{C}$, then $A^\dagger$ is $A^H \equiv \bar{A}^T$, the **Hermitian transpose**, or **conjugate transpose**, of $A$.

Note that this definition of the adjoint of linear operators is completely unrelated to the definition of an adjoint of a matrix!

We now describe one common application of adjoints.

**Theorem 3.11 (Least Squares Solution of an Overdetermined System)**

Let $A \in \text{Mat}(m \times n, \mathbb{R})$ with $m > n$. This means that the system of equations $Ax = p$ is an overdetermined system and will have no solutions with probability 1. However, we can find the **best-fit solution** of the system. That is, the vector $x$ that minimizes $\|Ax - p\|^2$ is the solution $z$ of

$$A^\dagger A z = A^\dagger p \tag{223}$$

$z$ is therefore, the "closest approximation" of the solution of $Ax = p$ that lives in $\mathbb{R}^n$.

**Theorem 3.12 (Properties of the Adjoint)**

Let $A, B : X \longrightarrow U,\ C : U \longrightarrow V$ be linear mappings. Then,
1. $(A+B)^\dagger = A^\dagger + B^\dagger$
2. $(CA)^\dagger = A^\dagger C^\dagger$
3. $(A^{-1})^\dagger = (A^\dagger)^{-1}$ if $A$ is bijective
4. $(A^\dagger)^\dagger = A$

**Definition 3.14 (Self-Adjoint Map)**

Linear mapping $A$ is **self-adjoint** if and only if $A = A^\dagger$.

**Theorem 3.13 (Restrictions of Self-Adjoint Maps)**

Let $A : V \to V$ be self-adjoint and $W$ be a subspace of $V$. If $W$ is invariant under $A$, then $A|_W : W \to W$ is self-adjoint.

*Proof.* Let $w, u \in W$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \langle A|_W w, u\rangle &= \langle Aw, u\rangle && (224)\\ &= \langle w, Au\rangle && (225)\\ &= \langle w, A|_W u\rangle && (226) \end{aligned}$$

If $M$ is any linear mapping, then its self-adjoint part is

$$M_\delta = \frac{M + M^\dagger}{2} \tag{227}$$

**Theorem 3.14 (Orthogonal Projections are Self-Adjoint)**

Let $P$ be an orthogonal projection. Then, $P = P^\dagger$.

**Definition 3.15 (Anti-Self-Adjoint)**

Map $A$ is **anti-self adjoint** if $A^\dagger = -A$. Conjugate symmetry implies that

$$A^\dagger = A \iff (iA)^\dagger = -(iA) \tag{228}$$

# 4 Matrices

We have developed a good theory of vector spaces and linear maps so far. But in order to do computations in practice, we should identify a concrete realization of vectors and linear maps. We will focus on finite-dimensional vector spaces.

**Definition 4.1 (Column Vector)**

Let $V$ be a finite-dimensional vector space over $\mathbb{F}$ and $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ be a basis of $V$. Then, any vector $v \in V$ can be written as the linear combination

$$v = a_1 v_1 + \ldots + a_n v_n \tag{229}$$

Since $V$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{F}^n$, we can associate such $v$ with the **column vector**

$$v \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ \vdots \\ a_n \end{pmatrix} \tag{230}$$

Therefore, as long as we choose a basis of $V$, we can basically treat the vectors as $\mathbb{F}^n$. What about linear maps from $V$ to $W$? First, let's put a basis on each of them $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $\{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ and identify the isomorphisms:

$$\iota_V : V \to \mathbb{F}^n, \qquad v = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i v_i \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ \vdots \\ a_n \end{pmatrix} \in \mathbb{F}^n \tag{231}$$

$$\iota_W : W \to \mathbb{F}^m, \qquad w = \sum_{j=1}^{m} b_j w_j \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} b_1 \\ \vdots \\ b_m \end{pmatrix} \in \mathbb{F}^m \tag{232}$$

Let's first identify how $A$ should map the $n$ basis vectors to. That is, just choose any $n$ vectors $u_1, \dots, u_n \in W$ and set them to be

$$u_1 = A(v_1), u_2 = A(v_2), \dots, u_n = A(v_n) \in W \tag{233}$$

By linearity of $A$, this completely determines the map. This is because for every $v \in V$,

$$A(v) = A\left( \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i v_i \right) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i A(v_i) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i u_i \tag{234}$$

But since each $u_i$ is a vector in $W$ and $W$ has a basis, we can expand it with respect to the basis of $W$.

$$A(v_i) = \sum_{j=1}^{m} a_{ji} w_j, \qquad i = 1, \dots, n \tag{235}$$

Therefore, we have identified a *new* map $M : \mathbb{F}^n \to \mathbb{F}^m$ such that

$$A = \iota_W^{-1} \circ M \circ \iota_V \tag{236}$$

So basically, any linear map between finite-dimensional vector spaces can be treated as a linear map from $\mathbb{F}^n$ to $\mathbb{F}^m$. For convenience, we encode this linear map as a rectangular array of numbers.

**Definition 4.2 (Matrix)**

Let $V, W$ be finite dimensional vector spaces over $\mathbb{F}$, with bases $B_V = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $B_U = \{u_1, \dots, u_m\}$, respectively. Let $A : V \to W$ be a linear map. Then, the **matrix realization** of linear map $A$ with respect to bases $B_V$ and $B_U$[a] is

$$M_A \coloneqq \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & \dots & a_{1n} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & \dots & a_{2n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{m1} & a_{m2} & \dots & a_{mn} \end{pmatrix} \in \mathbb{F}^{m \times n} \tag{237}$$

where the elements satisfy

$$A(v_i) = \sum_{j=1}^{m} a_{ji} w_j \in W \tag{238}$$

[a]Note that $M_A$ is really dependent on the bases, but generally, we omit the basis if it is clear from context.

Therefore, the action of linear map $A$ on vector $v \in V$ can be realized as the *left matrix multiplication* of $M_A$ on vector $\iota_V(v) \in \mathbb{F}^n$. It is important to note that the matrix is *not* $A$ in of itself. In the most rigorous sense, the matrix $A$ is really just equal to the composition of mappings $\iota_W^{-1} A \iota_V$, but for simplicity it is just written as $A$. It is just one representation of a linear map given the two bases of the domain and codomain. As soon as one writes down a matrix to represent a linear map, they are automatically assuming some choice of basis given by $\iota_V$ and $\iota_W$.

Note that the way we represent vectors and linear transformation has all been arbitrarily chosen. There is nothing innate about the way we express these transformation as matrix multiplication. It is dependent on our *initial choice* to represent linear mappings as *left* matrix multiplication and to represent all vectors as column vectors. This leads us to write dual vectors $l$ as *row vectors*, since we can interpret their action on a vector $v$ as left matrix multiplication as well.

$$l(v) = lv \tag{239}$$

**Definition 4.3 (Row Vector)**

Let $V$ be a finite-dimensional vector space over $\mathbb{F}$ and $V^*$ be the dual space of $V$ with basis $\{l_1, l_2, \dots, l_n\}$. Then, any vector $l \in V^*$ can be written as the linear combination

$$v = a_1 l_1 + \dots + a_n l_n \tag{240}$$

Since $V^*$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{F}^n$, we can assocaite such $l \in V^*$ with the **row vector**

$$l \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} a_1 & \dots & a_n \end{pmatrix} \tag{241}$$

Numerically, when computing the product two $n \times n$ matrices $A$ and $B$ to another $n \times n$ matrix $C$, since each entry of $C$ is the product of a row of $A$ with a column of $B$, and since $C$ has $n^2$ entries, we need $n^3$ scalar multiplications to compute (as well as $n^3 - n^2$ additions). In order words, the computing efficiency of the algorithm is at $O(n^3)$. However, there are faster algorithms than this. This is algorithm is known as the **Strassen Algorithm** (however, there do exist faster algorithms).

**Algorithm 4.1 (Strassen Algorithm)**

Let $A, B$ be $2 \times 2$ matrices such that $AB = C$. That is, component-wise,

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} b_{11} & b_{12} \\ b_{21} & b_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} c_{11} & c_{12} \\ c_{21} & c_{22} \end{pmatrix} \tag{242}$$

where for $i, j = 1, 2$,

$$c_{ij} = a_{i1}b_{1j} + a_{i2} + b_{2j} \tag{243}$$

Then, let us define

$$\begin{aligned} P_1 &= (a_{11} + a_{22})(b_{11} + b_{22}) \\ P_2 &= (a_{21} + a_{22})b_{11} \\ P_3 &= a_{11}(b_{12} - b_{22}) \\ P_4 &= a_{22}(b_{21} - b_{11} \\ P_5 &= (a_{11} + a_{12})b_{22} \\ P_6 &= (a_{21} - a_{11})(b_{11} + b_{12}) \\ P_7 &= (a_{12} - a_{22})(b_{21} + b_{22}) \end{aligned}$$

Then, the theorem states that we the entries of $C$ are

$$\begin{aligned} c_{11} &= P_1 + P_4 - P_5 + P_7 \\ c_{12} &= P_3 + P_5 \\ c_{21} &= P_2 + P_4 \\ c_{22} &= P_1 + P_3 - P_2 + P_6 \end{aligned}$$

This algorithm for multiplying $2 \times 2$ matrices requires 7 scalar multiplications, while regular multiplication requires 8. Using block multiplication, we can use this algorithm to calculate any matrix of order $2^k$. That is, to calculate $2^k \times 2^k$ matrices, we have to perform seven multiplications of blocks of size $2^{k-1} \times 2^{k-1}$, and doing this recursively, it reduces it down to

$$7^k = 2^{k \log_2 7} = n^{\log_2 7} \tag{244}$$

where $n$ is the order of the matrices being multiplied.
Additionally, the number of scalar additions or subtractions needed is bounded by

$$6 \times 7^k = 6 \times 2^{k \log_2 7} = 6n^{\log_2 7} \tag{245}$$

Since $\log_2 7 \approx 2.807 < 3$, this algorithm does indeed have more computational efficiency.[a] Note that matrices whose order is not a power of 2 can be turned into one by adjoining a suitable number of 1s on the diagonal.

[a] It is conjectured that for any positive number $\varepsilon$, there is an algorithm that computes the product of two $n \times n$ matrices with computational efficiency of $O(n^{2+\varepsilon})$.

**Definition 4.4 (Column Space)**

The **column space** of an $m \times n$ matrix

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} | & \dots & | \\ a_1 & \dots & a_n \\ | & \dots & | \end{pmatrix} \tag{246}$$

is called $C(A) \coloneqq \text{span}\{a_1, \dots, a_n\}$.

**Definition 4.5 (Null Space)**

The **null space** of a matrix $\mathbb{F}^{m \times n}$ is the set

$$N(A) \coloneqq \{v \in \mathbb{F}^n \colon Av = 0\} \tag{247}$$

## 4.1 Algebra of Matrices

We hope that this set of all $m \times n$ matrices, denoted $\mathbb{F}^{m \times n}$, satisfies the same properties of the set of linear maps $\mathcal{L}(V, W)$. Indeed, it has a vector space structure isomorphic to the vector space of linear maps.

We want to add the additional vector space and algebra structure on these sets of matrices.

**Theorem 4.1 (Vector Space of Matrices)**

The set of all $m \times n$ matrices over $\mathbb{F}$, denoted $\mathbb{F}^{m \times n}$, is a vector space over $\mathbb{F}$, with the following operations.

1. *Addition.* Given $A, B \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$,
$$(A + B)_{ij} = A_{ij} + B_{ij} \tag{248}$$
2. *Scalar Multiplication.* Given $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ and $c \in \mathbb{F}$,
$$(cA)_{ij} = cA_{ij} \tag{249}$$

Furthermore, $\mathbb{F}^{m \times n} \simeq \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{F}^n, \mathbb{F}^m)$ as vector spaces.

Furthermore, it is the case that the composition operation in the algebra of linear operators is realized as the operation of matrix multiplication. These are two distinct operations that are related only through the basis mappings $i$ and $j$.

**Definition 4.6 (Matrix Multiplication)**

Given two matrices $A \in \mathbb{F}^{m \times n}$ and $B \in \mathbb{F}^{n \times p}$, the **matrix multiplication** of $A$ and $B$ is defined as the matrix $AB$ where

$$(AB)_{ij} = \sum_{k=1}^{n} A_{ik} B_{kj} \tag{250}$$

**Lemma 4.2 (Matrix Multiplication as Realization of Composition)**

Let $U, V, W$ be finite-dimensional vector spaces each with their respective bases and $T : U \to V, S : V \to W$ be linear maps. Then,

$$M_{ST} = M_S M_T \tag{251}$$

That is, the matrix realization of the composition $ST$ is the matrix product of the realizations $S$ and $T$.

*Proof.*

**Theorem 4.3 (Algebra of Matrices)**

The set of all $n \times n$ matrices over field $\mathbb{F}$, denoted $\mathbb{F}^{n\times n}$, is a noncommutative associate algebra isomorphic to $\mathcal{L}(\mathbb{F}^n)$.

**Example 4.1 (Trigonometric Identities from Rotations)**

Let $\alpha : \mathbb{R}^2 \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be the linear transformation of the counterclockwise rotation by $\theta$ and $\beta : \mathbb{R}^2 \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be the counterclockwise rotation of $\phi$. Then the matrix representation of $\alpha \circ \beta$ is

$$\begin{pmatrix} \cos\theta & -\sin\theta \\ \sin\theta & \cos\theta \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \cos\phi & -\sin\phi \\ \sin\phi & \cos\phi \end{pmatrix} \tag{252}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} \cos\theta\cos\phi - \sin\theta\sin\phi & -\sin\phi\cos\theta - \cos\phi\sin\theta \\ \sin\theta\cos\phi + \cos\theta\sin\phi & -\sin\theta\sin\phi + \cos\theta\cos\phi \end{pmatrix} \tag{253}$$

But the counterclockwise rotation by $\theta$ and then $\phi$ is really just a counterclockwise rotation by $\theta + \phi$, which has the matrix representation

$$\begin{pmatrix} \cos(\theta+\phi) & -\sin(\theta+\phi) \\ \sin(\theta+\phi) & \cos(\theta+\phi) \end{pmatrix} \tag{254}$$

Since both matrices must be equivalent, this produces the trigonometric identities for angle addition.

$$\sin(\theta+\phi) = \sin\theta\cos\phi + \cos\theta\sin\phi$$
$$\cos(\theta+\phi) = \cos\theta\cos\phi - \sin\theta\sin\phi$$

Unsurprisingly, we can define a Euclidean norm on the vector space of matrices.

**Definition 4.7 (Frobenius Norm)**

The **Frobenius norm** of a matrix $A$ is defined as

$$\|A\|_F = \sqrt{\sum_{i,j} a_{ij}^2} \tag{255}$$

A natural question to ask is how this is related to the operator norm for general linear maps? It turns out that it is an upper bound.

**Theorem 4.4 (Frobenius Norm vs Operator Norm)**

For any matrix $A$,

$$\|A\| \leq \|A\|_F \tag{256}$$

*Proof.*

## 4.2 Row Reduction

Matrices are generally unruly to work with since they require a lot of computation. Therefore, we would like to transform them into some "nicer" matrices. Let's first define some nice matrices.

**Definition 4.8 (Diagonal Matrix)**

A square matrix $A$ is **diagonal** if $a_{ij} = 0$ for $i \neq j$.

**Definition 4.9 (Triangular Matrices)**

A matrix $A$ is called
1. **lower triangular** if $a_{ij} = 0$ for $i < j$.
2. **upper triangular** if $a_{ij} = 0$ for $i > j$.

**Definition 4.10 (Pivot)**

Let $A \in \mathbb{F}^{m \times n}$. Then,
1. The **pivot** of a row $(a_1, a_2, \cdots, a_n)$ is its first nonzero element.
2. If this element is $a_k$, then $k$ is the **index** of the pivot.
3. The rest of the columns that don't contain a pivot are called **free variables**.

**Definition 4.11 (Row Echelon Form)**

A matrix is in **Echelon form**, or **row Echelon form**, if
1. the indices of the pivots of its nonzero rows form a strictly increasing sequence, like steps
2. zero rows, if they exist, are at the bottom

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_{1j_1} & * & \dots & \dots & * \\ 0 & a_{2j_2} & * & \dots & * \\ 0 & 0 & \ddots & \dots & * \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & a_{rj_r} & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{257}$$

Figure 8: A matrix in Echelon form is in form where $*$'s represent arbitrary numbers, $a_{ij_i}$'s are nonzero (with indices $j_i$, and the entries to the left of below them are 0. Property $(i)$ also states that $j_1 < j_2 < \cdots < j_r$.

**Definition 4.12 (Reduced Row Echelon Form)**

A matrix is in **reduced row echelon form**, denoted rref$(A)$, if
1. it is in row echelon form
2. the pivots are all equal to 1
3. each column containing a pivot has zeros in all other entries

**Definition 4.13 (Elementary Row Transformation)**

An **elementary row transformation** of a matrix $A$ is one of the following three types of transformations
1. *Scalar Multiplication.* Multiplying a row by a nonzero scalar: $A_i \leftarrow cA_i$.

2. *Swap Rows.* Interchanging two rows: $A_i \leftarrow A_j, A_j \leftarrow A_i$.
3. *Scaled Addition* Adding a row multiplied by a scalar to another row: $A_i \leftarrow A_i + cA_j$.

**Example 4.2 (Elementary Row Transformations)**

We present an example of each of the three transformations. Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{258}$$

1. *Scalar Multiplication.* If we multiply the second row by 2, then

$$A_2 \leftarrow 2A_2 \tag{259}$$

gives

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} \longrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 8 & 10 & 12 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{260}$$

2. *Swap Rows.* If we interchange the first and third rows, then

$$A_1 \leftrightarrow A_3 \tag{261}$$

gives

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} \longrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 7 & 8 & 9 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{262}$$

3. *Scaled Addition.* If we add $-4$ times the first row to the second row, then

$$A_2 \leftarrow A_2 - 4A_1 \tag{263}$$

gives

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} \longrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & -3 & -6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{264}$$

**Lemma 4.5 (Elementary Row Transformations as Matrix Multiplication)**

The elementary transformations on a $m \times n$ matrix $A$ is equivalent to left matrix multiplication by the following $m \times m$ matrices.[a]

1. Adding row $i$ multiplied by scalar $\alpha$ to row $j$ (where $j > i$) is denoted $E^1_{\alpha \times i + j}$. The matrix is the identity matrix with $\alpha$ in the $(j, i)$ position.

$$E^1_{2\times 1+2} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad E^1_{-3\times 2+4} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{265}$$

2. Interchanging the $i$th and $j$th row is denoted by matrix $E^2_{ij}$. Note that these are permutation

matrices, or more speficially, transpositions.

$$E^2_{23} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad E^2_{24} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{266}$$

3. Multiplying the $i$th row by a scalar $\alpha$ is denoted by matrix $E^3_{\alpha \times i}$.

$$E^3_{3\times 3} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad E^3_{7\times 1} = \begin{pmatrix} 7 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{267}$$

[a]Due to the following difficulty in presenting these matrices in a general form, we present them in the specific $4 \times 4$ case and hope that the reader can extrapolate this process to general matrices.

*Proof.* Trivial.

**Lemma 4.6 (Inverse of Elementary Row Transformations)**

Each elementary matrix is invertible and their inverses are also elementary matrices. More specifically,
1. $(E^1_{\alpha \times i+j})^{-1} = E^1_{-\alpha \times i+j}$ (same matrix but $\alpha$ changed to -$\alpha$)
2. $(E^2_{ij})^{-1} = E^2_{ij}$ (same matrix)
3. $(E^3_{\alpha \times i})^{-1} = E^3_{(1/\alpha)\times i}$ (same matrix but $\alpha$ changed to $1/\alpha$)

Elementary column operations of are equivalent to right multiplication of matrices. However, since we defined the action of a linear map as left matrix multiplication, we don't focus on column operations.

**Theorem 4.7 (Gauss Jordan Elimination)**

Every matrix can be reduced to row echelon form and reduced row echelon form by elementary row transformations.

*Proof.* The relevant algorithm used will not be shown here, but we will mention that this procedure is called **Gauss Elimination**, or **row reduction**. Then, we perform the algorithm known as **back substitution**, where we start with the bottom row and use elementary operations to cancel out terms in upper rows.

Under the column space interpretation, Gaussian Elimination is really just an algorithm that performs a change of basis in steps. Each elementary operation simultaneously changes all of the vectors of the column space in such a way that eventually, this set of vectors will be "nice-looking" with a lot of zero entries.

The computational efficiency of Gauss Elimination is well known. Solving a system of $n$ equations with $n$ variables with this algorithm requires approximately $2n^3/3$ operations, meaning that it has arithmetic complexity of $O(n^3)$. However, for matrices of large order, multiple problems can occur. The algorithm generally does not have memory problems if the field is finite or if the coefficients are floating-point numbers. However, if the coefficients are integers or rational numbers, the intermediate entries of the algorithm can grow exponentially large, so bit complexity is exponential. However, there is a variant of Gaussian elimination, called the Bareiss algorithm, that avoids this problem, but has bit complexity of $O(n^5)$. Another problem is numerical instability, caused by the possibility of dividing by numbers very close to 0. Any such number would have its existing error amplified. Gaussian elimination algorithm is generally known to be stable for

positive-definite matrices.

**Definition 4.14 (Rank)**

The number of pivots in $\text{ref}(A)$ is called the **rank** of $A$, denoted $\text{rank}(A)$.

**Theorem 4.8 (Rank as Dimension of Image)**

For any $A \in \mathbb{F}^{m \times n}$, it is true that

$$\text{rank}(A) = \dim(\text{Im}(A)) = \dim(C(A)) \leq \min\{m, n\} \tag{268}$$

There are $k$ free variables in $A$ if and only if $\dim(N(A)) = k$.

*Proof.* By definition, the number of pivots cannot exceed the number of variables nor can it exceed the number of equations. Let $A$ be a $m \times n$ matrix over $\mathbb{F}$. Then, let $\text{rank}(A) = k$, which implies that there are $n - k$ free variables $\implies \dim(N(A)) = n - k$. By rank nullity,

$$\dim(\text{Im}(A)) = n - \dim(N(A)) = n - (n - k) = k = \text{rank}(A) \tag{269}$$

For the free variables part, we do not give a rigorous proof but we outline one. Each free variable corresponds to a free vector in the row echelon form of $A$ that are all linearly independent. Since the span of these free vectors is equal to $N(A)$, the $k$ vectors form a basis of $A \implies$ by definition, $\dim(N(A)) = k$.

This theorem establishes the consistency in definition between the rank of an abstract mapping mentioned in chapter 2 and the rank of its matrix representation. We can in fact establish strong claims on top of this. When we have a square matrix, we have additional properties.

**Definition 4.15 (Nonsingular Matrix)**

$A \in \mathbb{F}^{n \times n}$ is called
1. **nonsingular** if $\text{rank}(A) = n$, and
2. **singular** if $\text{rank}(A) < n$.

**Theorem 4.9 (Invertibility)**

$n \times n$ matrix $A$ is invertible if and only if it is nonsingular.

*Proof.* $A$ is nonsingular $\iff$ $Ax = b$ will always have a unique solution $\iff$ $A$ is an isomorphism from $\mathbb{F}^n$ to itself $\iff$ by definition, $A$ is invertible.

## 4.3 The (Hermitian) Transpose

**Definition 4.16 (Transpose of a Matrix)**

The **transpose** of matrix $A$, denoted $A^T$, is the matrix with entries $(a^T)_{ij} = a_{ij}$. That is, it is $A$, "flipped over" its diagonal.

We illustrate why this definition of a transpose is equivalent to the abstract definition to the transpose of a linear map. Given a linear map $A : U \longrightarrow V$ with $\dim U = n, \dim V = m$, we can fix a basis on both $U$ and $V$ to define its matrix $A$. The abstract definition states that

$$A^T : V^* \longrightarrow U^*,\ l \equiv \varphi A \tag{270}$$

Treating $l$ and $\varphi$ as row vectors, we can see that the $m \times n$ matrix $A$ maps the $1 \times m$ covector $\varphi$ to the $1 \times n$ covector $l$. Note that this linear mapping is realized through *right multiplication* of $A$ on $\varphi$. It is customary to present linear maps as *left* multiplication, so by "flipping" (i.e. taking the matrix transpose) of all the elements in the equation, we get

$$l^T \equiv A^T \varphi^T \tag{271}$$

which presents the mapping in the more usual way of left matrix multiplication. Note that $l^T$ and $\varphi^T$ are still covectors. Just because they are now represented as column vectors, it does not mean that they are not covectors, which is why we shouldn't be too dependent on the row vector interpretation of dual vectors mentioned above.

**Theorem 4.10 (Properties of the Matrix Transpose)**

Given that $A, B : U \longrightarrow V$ is linear, $c$ a constant

1. $(A^T)^T = A$.
2. $(A + B)^T = A^T + B^T,\ (cA)^T = cA^T$.
3. $(AB)^T = B^T A^T$.
4. If $A$ is invertible, $(A^{-1})^T = (A^T)^{-1}$ and $A$ invertible $\implies A^T$ invertible.
5. $x \cdot y = x^T y$. Furthermore,

$$Ax \cdot y = (Ax)^T y = x^T A^T y = x \cdot A^T y \tag{272}$$

**Definition 4.17 (Symmetric Matrices)**

Matrix $A$ is

1. a **symmetric matrix** if $A = A^T$.
2. a **skew-symmetric** or **anti-symmetric** matrix if $A^T = -A$.

**Definition 4.18 (Row Space)**

The **row space** of matrix $A$, denoted $R(A)$, is the span of its row vectors. That is,

$$R(A) = \text{span}\{A_1, A_2, \cdots, A_m\} \tag{273}$$

We will denote the row vectors with uppercase $A_i$'s.

**Definition 4.19 (Left Nullspace)**

The **left nullspace** of matrix $A$ is the nullspace of $A^T$. It is denoted $N(A^T)$.

**Theorem 4.11 (Four Fundamental Subspaces of a Matrix)**

Let $A : \mathbb{F}^n \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}^m$ be a $m \times n$ matrix with rank $k$. Assuming that $\mathbb{F}^n$ and $\mathbb{F}^m$ are inner product spaces,

$$N(A) = R(A)^\perp \iff N(A)^\perp = R(A) \tag{274}$$

$$N(A^T) = C(A)^\perp \iff N(A^T)^\perp = C(A) \tag{275}$$

That is, $N(A)$ and $R(A)$ are orthogonal complements in $\mathbb{F}^n$, with $\dim R(A) = k$ and $\dim(N(A)) = n-k$. $N(A^T)$ and $C(A)$ are orthogonal complements in $\mathbb{F}^m$, with $\dim C(A) = k$ and $\dim(N(A^T)) = m - k$.

**Theorem 4.12 (Column and Row Spaces are Isomorphic)**

Given matrix

$$C(A) \simeq R(A) \tag{276}$$

*Proof.* The dimensions of the two subspaces are equal to the rank, and so they are isomorphic.

*Proof.* We will prove that the linear mapping $A$ is the isomorphism itself. Let $\text{rank}(A) = r$ and let $\{v_1, v_2, \cdots, v_r\}$ be a basis for $R(A)$. Then, the set $\{Av_1, Av_2, \cdots, Av_r\}$ are $r$ vectors in $C(A)$. They are linearly independent because

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{i=1}^r c_i A v_i = A \sum_{i=1}^r c_i v_i = 0 &\implies \sum_{i=1}^r c_i v_i \in N(A), \text{ but } \sum_{i=1}^r c_i v_i \in R(A) \\ &\implies \sum_{i=1}^r \in N(A) \cap R(A) = \{0\} \end{aligned}$$

Since $\dim C(A) = r$, $\{Av_i\}$ must form a basis of $C(A)$. Therefore, $A$ is a bijection between vector spaces and is thus an isomorphism.

**Corollary 4.13 (Row Rank Equals Column Rank)**

$$\text{rank}(A) = \text{rank}(A^T) \tag{277}$$

## 4.4 Block Matrices

**Theorem 4.14 (Matrix of an Induced Map on a Direct Sum)**

Given mappings $A_i \in \text{End}(V_i)$ for $i = 1, 2, \cdots, n$, the matrix representation of the induced linear

mapping $A_1 \oplus A_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus A_n$ is the block matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} A_1 & & & \\ & A_2 & & \\ & & \ddots & \\ & & & A_n \end{pmatrix} : \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} V_i \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} V_i \tag{278}$$

**Theorem 4.15 (Arithmetic of $2 \times 2$ Block Matrices)**

Given $2 \times 2$ block matrices

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} A_1 & B_1 \\ C_1 & D_1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad Y = \begin{pmatrix} A_2 & B_2 \\ C_2 & D_2 \end{pmatrix} \tag{279}$$

We can compute $XY$ similarly to regular matrix multiplication, treating the blocks as entries.

$$XY = \begin{pmatrix} A_1 & B_1 \\ C_1 & D_1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} A_2 & B_2 \\ C_2 & D_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} A_1A_2 + B_1C_2 & A_1B_2 + B_1D_2 \\ C_1A_2 + D_1C_2 & C_1B_2 + D_1D_2 \end{pmatrix} \tag{280}$$

Furthermore, this process can be done in general for any $m \times n$ block matrix $X$ and $n \times p$ block matrix $Y$.

**Theorem 4.16 (Determinant Identity via a Block Construction)**

Given that $I, A, B$ are $n \times n$ matrices, define the $(2n) \times (2n)$ matrix

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} I & 0 \\ A & B \end{pmatrix} \tag{281}$$

Then

$$\det X = \det B \tag{282}$$

*Proof.* We can perform Gauss elimination to reduce $X$ without affecting the determinant.

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} I & 0 \\ A & B \end{pmatrix} = \det \begin{pmatrix} I & 0 \\ 0 & B \end{pmatrix} = \det B \tag{283}$$

since it satisfies the correct properties for $\det B$.

**Corollary 4.17 (Determinant of a Block Triangular Matrix)**

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ C & D \end{pmatrix} = \det A \det D \tag{284}$$

*Proof.*

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ C & D \end{pmatrix} = \det \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ C & I \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} I & 0 \\ 0 & D \end{pmatrix} = \det \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ C & I \end{pmatrix} \det \begin{pmatrix} I & 0 \\ 0 & D \end{pmatrix} \tag{285}$$

However,

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ C & D \end{pmatrix} \neq \det A \det D - \det B \det C \tag{286}$$

Rather, we introduce the following theorem

**Theorem 4.18 (Schur Complement Determinant Formulas)**

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ C & D \end{pmatrix} = \det(A) \det(D - CA^{-1}B) \tag{287}$$

$$= \det(D) \det(A - BD^{-1}C) \tag{288}$$

*Proof.*

$$\begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ C & D \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ C & I \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} I & A^{-1}B \\ 0 & D - CA^{-1}B \end{pmatrix} \tag{289}$$

by similarity, equation (6) is equal to equation (7).

**Definition 4.20 (Block Diagonal Matrix)**

A **block diagonal matrix** is a square matrix in block form such that the diagonal blocks are square matrices and all off-diagonal blocks are zero matrices.

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} A_1 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 0 & A_2 & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & A_k \end{pmatrix} \tag{290}$$

**Theorem 4.19 (Determinant and Trace of a Block Diagonal Matrix)**

Given a matrix $A$ in block diagonal form, with diagonal blocks $A_1, A_2, \cdots, A_k$,

$$\det A = \prod_{i=1}^{k} A_i, \quad \operatorname{Tr} A = \sum_{i=1}^{k} \operatorname{Tr} A_i \tag{291}$$

Furthermore, $A$ is invertible if and only if all the $A_i$'s are invertible, and

$$A^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} A_1 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 0 & A_2 & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & A_k \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} A_1^{-1} & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 0 & A_2^{-1} & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & A_k^{-1} \end{pmatrix} \tag{292}$$

*Proof.* The results are obvious when performing block multiplication or Gauss Elimination.

## 4.5 Determinants and Trace

The definition of the determinant is given first and then shown that it has the corresponding properties. We will work backward and construct the determinant from its properties.

**Definition 4.21 (Determinant)**

The determinant of a $n \times n$ matrix $A$, with column vectors $a_1, a_2, \cdots, a_n$, is a function

$$\det : \text{Mat}(n, \mathbb{F}) \longrightarrow \mathbb{F} \tag{293}$$

with the following three properties

1. The determinant of the identity matrix is 1.

$$\det(I) \coloneqq \det(e_1, e_2, \cdots, e_n) = 1 \tag{294}$$

2. Interchanging two columns $a_i$ and $a_j$ of $A$ once changes the sign of $\det A$.

$$\det(a_1, \cdots, a_i, \cdots, a_j, \cdots, a_n) = -\det(a_1, \cdots, a_j, \cdots, a_i, \cdots, a_n) \tag{295}$$

3. It is a multilinear function of the $n$ column vectors.

$$\det(a_1, \cdots, \lambda a_i + \mu a_i', \cdots a_n) = \lambda \det(a_1, \cdots, a_i, \cdots a_n) + \mu \det(a_1, \cdots, a_i', \cdots a_n) \tag{296}$$

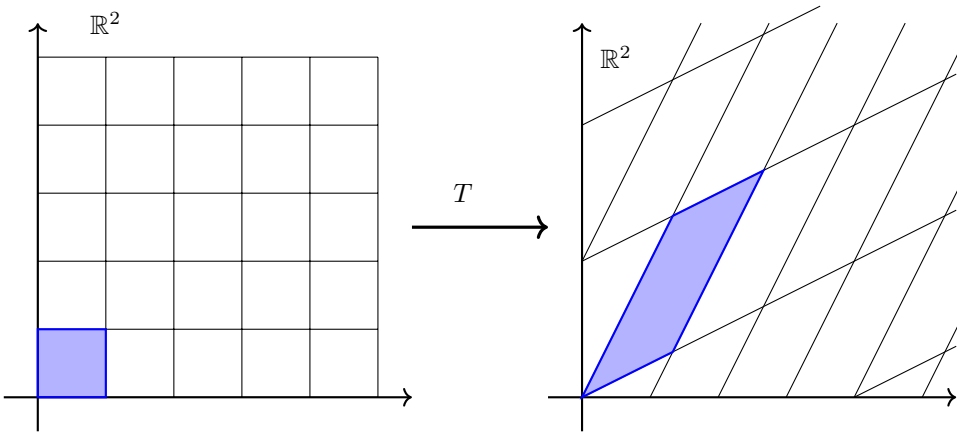



Figure 9: An important way to visualize determinants is by using the linear map visualization introduced before. That is, the determinant is the area of the transformed shaded unit square.

**Theorem 4.20 (Vanishing Determinant and Linear Dependence)**

The column vectors of $A$ are linearly dependent if and only if $\det A = 0$.

*Proof.* By linearity, it is sufficient to prove that if two column vectors $a_i$ and $a_j$ of a matrix $A$ are equal, then $\det A = 0$. This can be easily seen by property (ii) of determinants.

**Theorem 4.21 (Multiplicativity of the Determinant)**

$$\det\left(\prod_i A_i\right) = \prod_i \det A_i \tag{297}$$

**Theorem 4.22 (Invertibility via the Determinant)**

A matrix is invertible if and only if its determinant is nonzero.

*Proof.* A matrix is invertible $\iff$ it is nonsingular $\iff$ its columns are linearly independent $\iff$ its determinant is nonzero, by the previous theorem.

**Corollary 4.23 (Determinant of an Inverse)**

Given $n \times n$ matrix $A$,

$$\det(A^{-1}) = \frac{1}{\det A} \tag{298}$$

**Theorem 4.24 (Similar Matrices Have Equal Determinants)**

The determinants of similar matrices are equal.

*Proof.* Let $A$ and $B$ be similar matrices. Then, there exists an $S$ such that $A = S^{-1}BS$ and

$$\det(A) = \det(S^{-1}BS = \det(S^{-1})\det(B)\det(S) = \det B \tag{299}$$

This theorem implies that the determinant is an intrinsic property of a linear transformation, so it is invariant under a change of basis. That is, choosing different matrix representations of a linear transformation does not change the determinant.

**Corollary 4.25 (Determinant of a Transpose)**

$$\det(A) = \det(A^T) \tag{300}$$

*Proof.* $A$ is similar to $A^T$, which will be proven in chapter 6.

**Theorem 4.26 (Effect of Row Operations on the Determinant)**

The properties of the determinant combined with the previous corollary implies that

1. Adding a scalar multiple of a row/column to another row/column doesn't affect the determinant.
2. Interchanging two rows/columns switches the sign of the determinant.
3. Multiplying a row/column by $\alpha$ multiplies the determinant by $\alpha$.

**Theorem 4.27 (Determinant via the First Column)**

Let $A$ be an $n \times n$ matrix whose first column is $e_1$

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & * & * & * \\ 0 & & & \\ \dots & & A_{11} & \\ 0 & & & \end{pmatrix} \tag{301}$$

where $A_{11}$ is the $(n-1) \times (n-1)$ submatrix of $A$ with entries $a_{ij},\ i,j > 1$. Given this,

$$\det A = \det A_{11} \tag{302}$$

*Proof.* Using column reduction, we can see that

$$\det A = \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & & & \\ \cdots & & A_{11} & \\ 0 & & & \end{pmatrix} \tag{303}$$

it is clear that the right hand side is equal to $\det A_{11}$ since it behaves exactly like $\det A_{11}$ with respect to the three properties.

**Corollary 4.28 (Determinant of a Triangular Matrix)**

Let $A$ be an upper or a lower triangular matrix. Then the determinant of $A$ is the product of its diagonal entries. That is,

$$\det A = \prod_i a_{ii} \tag{304}$$

*Proof.* We apply the previous theorem recursively to satisfy when $A$ is upper triangular. Since $\det(A) = \det(A^T)$, this fact can be applied to lower triangular matrices too.

It is once again verified that the three elementary row (and column) operations affect the determinant in the way stated in Theorem 5.5. To elaborate, since $E_1, E_2$, and $E_3$ are all lower triangular, we can compute their determinants easily

$$\begin{aligned} \det E^1_{\alpha \times i+j} &= 1 \\ \det E^2_{ij} &= -1 \\ \det E^3_{\alpha \times i} &= \alpha \end{aligned}$$

and multiplying matrix $A$ by elementary matrices $E^1, E^2$, and $E^3$ multiplies the determinant by $1, -1$, and $\alpha$, respectively.

We can describe the determinant visually. Given a linear mapping $A : V \longrightarrow V$, we can fix any basis $\{e_1, e_2, \cdots, e_n\}$ on $V$. Note that these basis vectors do not need to be orthogonal, nor are they restricted to any magnitude. The set of vectors

$$\left\{ \sum_{i=1}^n c_i e_i \mid 0 \leq c_i \leq 1, i = 1, 2, \cdots, n \right\} \tag{305}$$

forms an $n$-dimensional parallelepiped in $V$. Let the volume of this parallelepiped be $U$. Let $W$ be the volume of the parallelepiped

$$\left\{ \sum_{i=1}^n c_i A e_i \mid 0 < c_i < 1, i = 1, 2, \cdots, n \right\} \tag{306}$$

which is formed by the transformed basis vectors $\{Ae_1, Ae_2, \cdots, Ae_n\}$. We can view this latter shape as the image of the first parallelepiped under transformation $A$. Then,

$$\det A = W/V \tag{307}$$

That is, the ratio of the transformed parallelepiped to the original parallelepiped is the determinant. This is consistent with the properties of the determinant. For example, if $A$ is not isomorphic, then the parallelepiped

will get "squished" into a lower-dimensional parallelepiped with volume 0. The fact that we use a ratio between the original and transformed parallelepiped allows this value to be invariant under the basis that we use.

Computationally, finding the LUP decomposition of a matrix $A$ is the best known algorithm to compute the determinant of a general $n \times n$ matrix. That is,

$$\det A = \det L \det U \det P = \pm \det U = \pm \prod_i u_{ii} \tag{308}$$

since $\det L = 1$ and $\det P = \pm 1$.

There are other methods to compute the determinant. First, we state the simple but useful formula.

**Theorem 4.29 (Determinant of a $2 \times 2$ Matrix)**

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} = ad - bc \tag{309}$$

**Definition 4.22 (Minor of a Matrix)**

Given an $n \times n$ matrix $A$, the $(ij)$th minor of $A$, denoted $A_{ij}$, is the determinant of the $(n-1) \times (n-1)$ matrix formed by removing the $i$th row and $j$ th column from $A$.

**Theorem 4.30 (Laplace Expansion)**

Let $A$ be an $n \times n$ matrix and $j$ any index between 1 and $n$. Then

$$\det A = \sum_i (-1)^{i+j} a_{ij} A_{ij} \tag{310}$$

that is, the alternating sums of the $ij$th minors multiplied by the $ij$th entries in the $j$th column of $A$. This can be done by choosing an arbitrary $i$th row, which leads to the alternative formula

$$\det A = \sum_j (-1)^{i+j} a_{ij} A_{ij} \tag{311}$$

**Theorem 4.31 (Cramer's Rule)**

Given a system of linear equations in the form $Ax = b$ where $A$ is an $n \times n$ matrix, the solutions of this system can be expressed with the formulas

$$x_i = \frac{\det A_i}{\det A} \tag{312}$$

where $\det A_i$ is the matrix formed by replacing $a_i$, the $i$th column of $A$, by the column vector $b$.

Albeit very computationally heavy, determinants can also be used to calculate the inverse of a matrix.

**Theorem 4.32 (Inverse via the Adjugate)**

The inverse matrix $A^{-1}$ of an invertible matrix $A$ has the form

$$(A^{-1})_{ij} = (-1)^{i+j} \frac{\det A_{ij}}{\det A} \tag{313}$$

**Definition 4.23 (Trace of a Square Matrix)**

The trace of a square matrix $A$, denoted $\operatorname{Tr} A$, is the sum of its diagonal entries.

$$\operatorname{Tr}(A) = \sum_i a_{ii} \tag{314}$$

**Theorem 4.33 (Linearity of the Trace)**

$$\operatorname{Tr}(\lambda A + \alpha B) = \lambda \operatorname{Tr}(A) + \alpha \operatorname{Tr}(B) \tag{315}$$

*Proof.* Obvious if we look at the entries of $A$ and $B$ and see that it is bilinear.

**Theorem 4.34 (Cyclic Property of the Trace)**

$$\operatorname{Tr}\left( \prod_{i=1}^{n} A_i \right) = \operatorname{Tr}\left( A_n \prod_{i=1}^{n-1} A_i \right) \tag{316}$$

*Proof.* We first prove when $m = 2$. Given that the subscripts $ij$ denote that $(i, j)$th element of a matrix, observe that

$$\begin{aligned} (AB)_{ij} = \sum_k A_{ik} B_{kj} \implies (AB)_{ii} &= \sum_K A_{ik} B_{ki} \\ \implies \operatorname{Tr}(AB) &= \sum_i \sum_k A_{ik} B_{ki} \\ &= \sum_k \sum_i B_{ki} B_{ik} = Tr(BA) \end{aligned}$$

Similarly, for $m = 3$

$$\begin{aligned} (ABC)_{ij} = \sum_{k,l} A_{ik} B_{kl} C_{lj} \implies \operatorname{Tr}(ABC) &= \sum_{i,k,l} A_{ik} B_{kl} C_{li} \\ &= \sum_{i,k,l} C_{li} A_{ik} B_{kl} = \operatorname{Tr}(CAB) \end{aligned}$$

And so we can generalize for $m$.

**Corollary 4.35 (Invariance of the Trace under Change of Basis)**

The trace is invariant under a change of basis. That is, the trace is an intrinsic property of a linear transformation since it does not change depending on how it is represented.

*Proof.* Given that $A$ is similar to $B$.

$$\text{Tr}(B) = \text{Tr}(SAS^{-1}) = \text{Tr}(S^{-1}SA) = \text{Tr}(A) \tag{317}$$

**Theorem 4.36 (Odd-Order Skew-Symmetric Matrices Are Singular)**

Let $A$ be a $n \times n$ skew-symmetric matrix over $\mathbb{C}$ (or any field of characteristic $\neq 2$). If $n$ is odd,

$$\det A = 0 \tag{318}$$

*Proof.*

$$\det A = \det A^T = \det -A = (-1)^n \det A \implies \det A = 0 \tag{319}$$

We can actually conclude something even futher about antisymmetric matrices.

**Theorem 4.37 (Pfaffian)**

The determinant of an antisymmetric matrix $A$ of even order is the square of a homogeneous polynomial of degree $n/2$ in the entries of $A$. That is,

$$\det A = P^2 \tag{320}$$

The polynomial $P$ is called the **Pfaffian**.

**Theorem 4.38 (As Eigenvalues)**

Let $a_1, a_2, \cdots, a_n$ be the eigenvalues of $A$. Then

$$\sum_i a_i = \text{Tr}\, A, \qquad \prod_i a_i = \det A \tag{321}$$

*Proof.* The mapping $A \mapsto \det(A - xI)$ is a mapping from the set of $n \times n$ matrices to the polynomial algebra $\mathbb{F}[x]$. Direct application of the Viete's formulas in $\mathbb{F}[x]$ produces the statement and this result can be extended to the rest of the formulas.

**Definition 4.24 (Vandermonde Matrix)**

A **Vandermonde matrix** is a square matrix whose columns form a geometric progression. That is,

let $a_1, a_2, \cdots, a_n$ be $n$ scalars. Then, $V(a_1, a_2, \cdots, a_n)$ is the $n \times n$ matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & \dots & 1 & 1 \\ a_1 & a_2 & \dots & a_{n-1} & a_n \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ a_1^{n-2} & a_2^{n-2} & \dots & a_{n-1}^{n-2} & a_n^{n-2} \\ a_1^{n-1} & a_2^{n-1} & \dots & a_{n-1}^{n-1} & a_n^{n-1} \end{pmatrix} \tag{322}$$

**Theorem 4.39 (Determinant of a Vandermonde Matrix)**

The determinant of a Vandermonde matrix is

$$\det V(a_1, a_2, \cdots, a_n) = \prod_{j>i} (a_j - a_i) \tag{323}$$

A symmetry in the multivariable expression of a determinant can also reveal a symmetry in the matrix.

**Example 4.3 (2019 Putnam A1)**

The symmetric polynomial

$$f(x, y, z) = x^3 + y^3 + z^3 - 3xyz \tag{324}$$

can be expressed as the determinant of the $3 \times 3$ matrix

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} x & y & z \\ z & x & y \\ y & z & x \end{pmatrix} \tag{325}$$

We already know that the LUP decomposition is an algorithm used to compute the determinant of a general $n \times n$ matrix.

**Algorithm 4.2 (Dodgson Condensation)**

We will introduce another, called **Dodgson condensation**. The algorithm can be described in the following steps.

1. Let $A$ be a given $n \times n$ matrix. Arrange $A$ so that no zeros occur in its interior (this can be done by any combination of elementary row or column operations that would not change the determinant).
2. Create an $(n-1) \times (n-1)$ matrix $B$ consisting of the determinants of every $2 \times 2$ submatrix of $A$. Explicitly,
$$B = \det \begin{pmatrix} a_{i,j} & a_{i,j+1} \\ a_{i+1,j} & a_{i+1,j+1} \end{pmatrix} \tag{326}$$
3. With this $(n-1) \times (n-1)$ matrix $B$, perform step 2 to obtain an $(n-2) \times (n-2)$ matrix $C$. Divide each term in $C$ by the corresponding term in the interior of $A$.
$$C_{i,j} = \det \begin{pmatrix} b_{i,j} & b_{i,j+1} \\ b_{i+1,j} & b_{i+1,j+1} \end{pmatrix} \Big/ a_{i+1,j+1} \tag{327}$$
4. Let $A = B$ and $B = C$. Repeat step 3 as necessary until the $1 \times 1$ matrix is found, which is the determinant.

The reason that we do not want 0s in $A$ is because then in doing step 3 we may divide by 0.

**Example 4.4 (Computing a $4 \times 4$ Determinant)**

Let us find

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} -2 & -1 & -1 & -4 \\ -1 & -2 & -1 & -6 \\ -1 & -1 & 2 & 4 \\ 2 & 1 & -3 & -8 \end{pmatrix} \tag{328}$$

All of the interior elements are nonzero, so there is no need to rearrange the matrix. We calculate

$$\begin{pmatrix} -2 & -1 & -1 & -4 \\ -1 & -2 & -1 & -6 \\ -1 & -1 & 2 & 4 \\ 2 & 1 & -3 & -8 \end{pmatrix} \to \begin{pmatrix} 3 & -1 & 2 \\ -1 & -5 & 8 \\ 1 & 1 & -4 \end{pmatrix} \to \begin{pmatrix} -16 & 2 \\ 4 & 12 \end{pmatrix} \tag{329}$$

With this $2 \times 2$ matrix, we must divide each term by the interior of the original $A$.

$$\begin{pmatrix} -16/-2 & 2/-1 \\ 4/-1 & 12/2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 8 & -2 \\ -4 & 6 \end{pmatrix} \tag{330}$$

Calculating this determinant gives 40, and dividing by the interior of the $3 \times 3$ matrix $(-5)$ gives $\det A = 40/-5 = -8$.

## 4.6 Change of Basis

So far, we have interpreted linear automorphisms as a map $A : V \to V$ mapping $v$ to $Av$. This interpretation of $A$ as an *active transformation* is the most straightforward. But given a basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$, we can see that $A$ is not acting on the coefficients, but the *on the basis vectors themselves.*

$$Av = A(a_1 v_1 + \ldots + a_n v_n) = a_1 Av_1 + \ldots + a_n Av_n \tag{331}$$

Therefore, we can interpret the mapping $A$ as a mapping of the basis vectors only, while keeping the coefficients fixed. That is, $Av$ merely represents $v$ with respect to another set of basis vectors $\{Av_1, \dots, Av_n\}$. If we interpret map as this, then this is called a *passive transformation.* We can interpret $A$ as both an active or a passive transformation.

Suppose $\{u_1, u_2, \dots, u_n\}$ is a basis for vector space $V$ and $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\}$ is another basis for $V$. Then, for any vector $v \in V$, we can write

$$v = a_1 u_1 + \ldots + a_n u_n \tag{332}$$

$$= b_1 v_1 + \ldots + b_n v_n \tag{333}$$

The realization of $v$ with respect to $\{a_i\}$ will be $a = (a_1, \dots, a_n)^T$ and the realization of $v$ with respect to $\{b_i\}$ will be $b = (b_1, \dots, b_n)^T$. Therefore, we want to find some matrix $S$ such that

$$b = Sa \iff \begin{pmatrix} b_1 \\ \vdots \\ b_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} s_{11} & \dots & s_{1n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ s_{n1} & \dots & s_{nn} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ \vdots \\ a_n \end{pmatrix} \tag{334}$$

This matrix certainly exists, and to find matrix $S$ that transforms from the $u_i$'s to the $v_j$'s, we must start off by representing $v = \sum_i a_i u_i$, and trying to present it into a form like $\sum_j b_j v_j$. To do this, we work backwards by writing each term of the *old basis* as linear combinations of the *new basis.*

$$u_i = \sum_j s_{ji} v_j \tag{335}$$

Once we have figured out all values $s_{ji}$, we can rewrite $v$ from the old basis to the new basis.

$$v = \sum_i a_i u_i \tag{336}$$
$$= \sum_i a_i \sum_j s_{ji} v_j \tag{337}$$
$$= \sum_{i,j} a_i s_{ji} v_j \tag{338}$$
$$= \sum_j \left( \sum_i a_i s_{ji} \right) v_j \tag{339}$$
$$= \sum_j b_j v_j \tag{340}$$

Therefore, we find that

$$b_j = \sum_i s_{ji} a_i \tag{341}$$

**Definition 4.25 (Change of Basis Matrix)**

For all $v \in V$, the matrix $S$ thaat transforms the coefficients $(a_1, \dots, a_n)^T$ of $v$ with respect to basis $\{u_1, \dots, u_n\}$ to the coefficients $(b_1, \dots, b_n)^T$ of $v$ with respect to basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ is called a **change-of-basis matrix**.

**Example 4.5 (Computation of a Change-of-Basis Matrix)**

Let

$$\{u_1, u_2, u_3\} = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\}, \qquad \{v_1, v_2, v_3\} = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{342}$$

by two bases of $\mathbb{R}^3$. Then, we see that

$$u_1 = \frac{1}{2} v_1 - \frac{1}{2} v_2 + \frac{1}{2} v_3 \tag{343}$$
$$u_2 = \frac{1}{2} v_1 + \frac{1}{2} v_2 - \frac{1}{2} v_3 \tag{344}$$
$$u_3 = -\frac{1}{2} v_1 + \frac{1}{2} v_2 + \frac{1}{2} v_3 \tag{345}$$

Therefore, our change-of-basis matrix should be

$$S = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} \tag{346}$$

To test this out, let us take the vector

$$v = 1 \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + 1 \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + 1 \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{347}$$

So $(1, 1, 1)^T$ should map to $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2})^T$. Indeed, it is the case that

$$\begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{348}$$

Given $n$-dimensional vector space $W$ over $\mathbb{F}$, let's say that we have linear map $A : W \to W$ and vector $w \in W$, with $w' = Aw$. Given basis $\{u_1, \dots, u_n\}$, we can write the vector $w_v \in \mathbb{R}^n$ with respect to this basis $\{u_i\}$. Furthermore, if we endow this basis to *both* the domain $W$ and codomain $W$ of $A$, then we can write $A_{uu} \in \mathbb{F}^{n \times n}$ (where the left index represents the codomain and the right index represents the domain). This allows us to correctly compute

$$w'_u = A_{uu} w_u \tag{349}$$

since they are all with respect to the same basis. If we have a second basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ of $V$ and choose to represent $w$ with respect to this basis, we will have $w_v = S w_u$, where $S$ is the change of basis matrix. But we can't just replace $w_u$ with $w_v$ since they are not with respect to the same basis. This won't work.

$$w'_u \neq A_{uu} w_v \tag{350}$$

We must change the basis of the domain of $A$ to $\{v_i\}$ in order for this to work. So we can do

$$\begin{aligned} w'_u &= (A_{uu} S^{-1})(S w_u) && (351) \\ &= A_{uv} s_v && (352) \end{aligned}$$

Furthermore, if we wanted to change the basis of the codomain, i.e. change the representation of $w'$, then we can just multiply $S$ to $w'_u$.

$$\begin{aligned} w'_v = S w'_u &= (S A_{uu} S^{-1})(S w_u) && (353) \\ &= A_{vv} s_v && (354) \end{aligned}$$

This new matrix $A_{vv} = S A_{uu} S^{-1}$ is simply another representation of the same linear map $A$ with respect to a different basis (in both the domain and codomain). To repeat again, $A_{vv}$ and $A_{ww}$ represent the same transformation $A$ but merely in different bases.

**Definition 4.26 (Similar Matrices)**

Two matrices $A$ and $B$ are **similar** if and only if there exists an invertible matrix $S$ such that $B = SAS^{-1}$.

**Lemma 4.40 (Similarity is an Equivalence Relation)**

Matrix similarity is an equivalence relation on $\mathbb{F}^{n \times n}$.

*Proof.* We prove the three properties of an equivalence relation.

1. *Reflexive.* $A \sim A$ since $A = IAI^{-1}$.
2. *Symmetric.* If $A \sim B$, then $B = SAS^{-1}$, so $A = S^{-1}BS = S^{-1}B(S^{-1})^{-1}$, and so $B \sim A$.
3. *Transitive.* If $A \sim B, B \sim C$, then $B = SAS^{-1}$ and $C = RBR^{-1}$, so $C = RSAS^{-1}R^{-1} = (RS)A(RS)^{-1} \implies A \sim C$.

## 4.7 LUP Decomposition

**Theorem 4.41 (Triangularity Is Preserved under Multiplication)**

The product of square lower triangular matrices is a lower triangular matrix. The product of square upper triangular matrices is an upper triangular matrix.

**Theorem 4.42 (LU Decompositions)**

Suppose $A \in \mathbb{F}^{m \times n}$ can be reduced to echelon form using only row additions, i.e. without any row interchanges. Then $A$ admits a factorization, called the **LU decomposition**, in the form

$$A = LU \tag{355}$$

where $L$ is a lower triangular matrix and $U$ is an upper triangular matrix. The hypothesis cannot be dropped, as the remark after this proof explains; the $PLU$ decomposition is what holds for every square matrix.

*Proof.* We reduce $A$ to its echelon form $\text{ref}(A)$ by successively multiplying elementary matrices $E^{\gamma_i}$ representing elementary operation (i). After a finite amount of steps $r$, we will reduce it to $\text{ref}(A)$.

$$\text{ref}(A) = E^{\gamma_r} E^{\gamma_{r-1}} \cdots E^{\gamma_2} E^{\gamma_1} A = \left( \prod_{i=0}^{r-1} E^{\gamma_{r-i}} \right) A \tag{356}$$

Since each $E^{\gamma_i}$ is invertible, we multiply the product of the inverses of the elementary matrices of operation (i), which are also elementary matrices of operation (i).

$$(E^{\gamma_1})^{-1}(E^{\gamma_2})^{-1} \cdots (E^{\gamma_r})^{-1} ref(A) = \left( \prod_{j=1}^{r} (E^{\gamma_j})^{-1} \right) \left( \prod_{i=1}^{r-1} E^{\gamma_{r-i}} \right) A = A \tag{357}$$

Since each $(E^{\gamma_j})^{-1}$ is an elementary row operation, it is lower diagonal, and by theorem 3.16, their product is also lower triangular. It is easy to prove that if the diagonal entries are furthermore equal to 1, then the product has diagonal entries equal to 1. Finally, it is clear that every matrix in row echelon form is upper triangular, and we are done.

$$A = \left( \prod_{j=1}^{r} (E^{\gamma_j})^{-1} \right) \text{ref}(A) = LU \tag{358}$$

Note that the existence of the LU decomposition for a general $m \times n$ matrix is not guaranteed. It will not exist if we must switch rows in matrix $A$ in order to reduce it to its echelon form. It does not matter whether we need to use elementary operation (ii) or not. Only the necessity of elementary operation (iii) to reduce the matrix determines the existence of the LU decomposition. The decomposition is also unique.

Finding the LU decomposition of a matrix is useful for solving systems of linear equations. Given a system in the form of $Ax = b$, if we know the LU decomposition of $A$, we can rewrite the system as

$$LUx = b \tag{359}$$

Setting $y = Ux$, we can easily solve the system $Ly = b$ using forward substitution and then we can solve the system $Ux = y$ using back substitution. Therefore, knowing this decomposition beforehand greatly aids in computing the solutions to the linear system. But computing $L$ and $U$ in order to solve this system takes as much effort as solving the system using Gauss Elimination in the first place.

It is imperative to mention a similar decomposition for $n \times n$ matrices, known as **LUP decomposition**.

**Definition 4.27 (Permutation Matrix)**

An $n \times n$ permutation matrix is a matrix of 0s and 1s with exactly one 1 in each row and column. The set of all $n \times n$ permutation matrices form a multiplicative matrix group of order $n!$. We can also view this group as the matrix representation of the symmetric group $S_n$.

**Example 4.6 (The $2 \times 2$ Permutation Matrices)**

The set of all $2 \times 2$ permutation matrices is

$$S_2 = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{360}$$

and the set of all $3 \times 3$ permutation matrices is

$$S_3 = \left\{ I_3, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{361}$$

**Theorem 4.43 ($PLU$ Decomposition)**

Every $n \times n$ matrix $A$ can be decomposed into the form $A = PLU$, where $L$ is lower triangular, $U$ is upper triangular, and $P$ is a permutation matrix.

*Proof.* We run Gauss-Jordan elimination on $A$ one column at a time, recording every elementary row transformation as a matrix acting on the left.
Set $A^{(1)} = A$ and suppose that after $k-1$ steps we have reached $A^{(k)}$, whose first $k-1$ columns are already zero below the diagonal. Look at the entries $a_{ik}^{(k)}$ for $i \geq k$ in column $k$. If they all vanish there is nothing to clear, and we set $P_k = E_k = I$. Otherwise choose some $r \geq k$ with $a_{rk}^{(k)} \neq 0$ and let $P_k$ be the permutation matrix transposing rows $k$ and $r$; taking $r$ to maximise $|a_{rk}^{(k)}|$ is *partial pivoting*, but any nonzero choice suffices for existence. This is the point at which rows get permuted, and it is forced precisely when the natural pivot $a_{kk}^{(k)}$ happens to be 0. After the swap the pivot is nonzero, so writing

$$m_{ik} = \frac{(P_k A^{(k)})_{ik}}{(P_k A^{(k)})_{kk}}, \quad i > k \tag{362}$$

we may clear column $k$ by subtracting $m_{ik}$ times row $k$ from row $i$ for every $i > k$. Performing all of these at once is left multiplication by

$$E_k = I - \sum_{i>k} m_{ik}\, e_i e_k^T \tag{363}$$

whose only off-diagonal entries lie in column $k$ strictly below the diagonal, so $E_k$ is unit lower triangular. Putting $A^{(k+1)} = E_k P_k A^{(k)}$ and running $k$ from 1 to $n-1$ leaves

$$E_{n-1} P_{n-1} \cdots E_2 P_2 E_1 P_1 A = U \tag{364}$$

where $U = A^{(n)}$ is upper triangular. So far this is just the elimination algorithm; the work is in separating the permutations from the eliminations, since they are interleaved.
For $j < n$ put $Q_j = P_{n-1} P_{n-2} \cdots P_{j+1}$, with $Q_{n-1} = I$, and define

$$\tilde{E}_j = Q_j E_j Q_j^{-1} \tag{365}$$

Every $P_i$ making up $Q_j$ transposes two rows whose indices both exceed $j$. Conjugating therefore only permutes the multipliers among the positions $i > j$ of column $j$, leaving the column index and the diagonal alone:

$$\tilde{E}_j = I - \sum_{i>j} m_{\sigma_j(i)\, j}\, e_i e_j^T \tag{366}$$

for the permutation $\sigma_j$ induced by $Q_j$. In particular each $\tilde{E}_j$ is again unit lower triangular. Writing $P' = P_{n-1} \cdots P_1$, an induction on $n$ using $Q_j = Q_{j+1} P_{j+1}$ gives

$$E_{n-1} P_{n-1} \cdots E_1 P_1 = \tilde{E}_{n-1} \tilde{E}_{n-2} \cdots \tilde{E}_1 P' \tag{367}$$

which is the claimed separation: for $n - 1 = 2$, for instance, $\tilde{E}_2 \tilde{E}_1 P' = E_2 (P_2 E_1 P_2^{-1})(P_2 P_1) = E_2 P_2 E_1 P_1$.
Now $M = \tilde{E}_{n-1} \cdots \tilde{E}_1$ is a product of unit lower triangular matrices, hence unit lower triangular by closure under multiplication, and so is $L \coloneqq M^{-1}$. From $MP'A = U$ we get

$$P'A = LU \implies A = (P')^{-1} LU = (P')^T LU \tag{368}$$

Since the permutation matrices form a group, $P \coloneqq (P')^T$ is again a permutation matrix, giving $A = PLU$. The entries of $L$ below the diagonal are exactly the multipliers $m_{ij}$, reordered by the later row swaps, and under partial pivoting they all satisfy $|m_{ij}| \leq 1$.

**Corollary 4.44 ($LUP$ Decomposition)**

Every $n \times n$ matrix $A$ can be decomposed into the form $LUP$. That is, in the form

$$A = LUP = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ * & 1 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ * & * & 1 & \dots & \vdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & 0 \\ * & * & \cdots & * & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} u_{11} & * & * & \dots & * \\ 0 & u_{22} & * & \dots & * \\ 0 & 0 & u_{33} & \dots & \vdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & * \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 & u_{nn} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \\ \\ P \\ \\ \\ \end{pmatrix} \tag{369}$$

*Proof.* We decompose $A^T = P_0 L_0 U_0$, where $P_0$ is a permutation matrix, $L_0$ lower triangular, $U_0$ upper triangular. This implies that

$$A = A^{TT} = U_0^T L_0^T P_0^T = LUP \tag{370}$$

since $U_0^T$ is lower triangular and $L_0^T$ is upper triangular. Note that $L$ is unique, but $U$ is not unique, so this decomposition is not unique.

This decomposition can also be used to solve matrix equations

$$AX = B \tag{371}$$

Since this equation can be expressed in the form

$$A \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ x_1 & \cdots & x_n \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ Ax_1 & \cdots & Ax_n \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ b_1 & \cdots & b_n \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix} \tag{372}$$

solving this matrix is equivalent to solving the system of systems of linear equations

$$Ax_1 = b_1, Ax_2 = b_2, \cdots, Ax_n = b_n \tag{373}$$

i.e. by solving one column at a time. This method can also be used to solve

$$AX = I \tag{374}$$

to find $X = A^{-1}$. Equivalently, we can left multiply elementary matrices to reduce $A$ to $\text{rref}(A)$.

$$E^{\gamma_r} E^{\gamma_{r-1}} \cdots E^{\gamma_2} E^{\gamma_1} AX = \text{rref}(A) X = E^{\gamma_r} E^{\gamma_{r-1}} \cdots E^{\gamma_2} E^{\gamma_1} I = \prod_{i=0}^{r-1} E^{\gamma_{r-i}} \tag{375}$$

If $\text{rref}(A) = I$, then

$$A^{-1} = \prod_{i=0}^{r-1} E^{\gamma_{r-i}} \tag{376}$$

and if $\text{rref}(A) \neq I$, then $A^{-1}$ does not exist. This is in fact precisely the method of finding the inverse where we do Gauss Elimination on the extended matrix

$$\left( \begin{array}{c|c} & \\ A & I \\ & \end{array} \right) \longrightarrow \left( \begin{array}{c|c} & \\ I & A^{-1} \\ & \end{array} \right) \tag{377}$$

## 4.8 QR Decomposition

The QR decomposition is often used to simplify these linear least squares problems into a more manageable equation.

**Definition 4.28 (QR Decomposition)**

Any $m \times n$ matrix $A$ over $\mathbb{F}$ (where $m \geq n$) may be decomposed into the product

$$A = QR \tag{378}$$

where $Q$ is an $m \times n$ matrix with pairwise orthonormal column vectors (meaning $Q^\dagger Q = I_n$), and $R$ is an $n \times n$ upper triangular matrix. If $A$ has full column rank ($\text{rank}(A) = n$), the decomposition is unique provided that we require the diagonal entries of $R$ to be strictly positive.

*Proof.* We use the Gram-Schmidt orthogonalization process on the column vectors of $A$. Let $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ be the columns of $A$. We can recursively construct the orthonormal columns $q_1, \dots, q_n$ of $Q$.
For the first step, let $v_1 = a_1$. Then $q_1 = v_1/\|v_1\|$. We set $r_{11} = \|v_1\|$, giving $a_1 = r_{11} q_1$.
For step $j$ (where $1 < j \leq n$), we subtract the projections of $a_j$ onto the previously computed orthogonal vectors $q_1, \dots, q_{j-1}$:

$$v_j = a_j - \sum_{i=1}^{j-1} (a_j, q_i) q_i \tag{379}$$

If $A$ has full column rank, then $a_j$ is not in the span of the previous vectors, so $v_j \neq 0$. We define $q_j = v_j/\|v_j\|$.
Let $r_{ij} = (a_j, q_i)$ for $i < j$ and $r_{jj} = \|v_j\|$. This allows us to write $a_j$ as:

$$a_j = \sum_{i=1}^{j} r_{ij} q_i \tag{380}$$

This is precisely the matrix multiplication $A = QR$, where $R$ is upper triangular and $Q$ has orthonormal columns $q_i$. The condition $r_{jj} = \|v_j\| > 0$ makes the decomposition unique for full-rank matrices.

Because $Q^\dagger Q = I$, the QR decomposition can greatly simplify normal equations in linear least squares problems:

$$A^T Ax = A^T b \implies (QR)^T (QR)x = R^T Q^T QRx = R^T Rx = R^T Q^T b \tag{381}$$

$$\implies Rx = Q^T b \tag{382}$$

$$\implies x = R^{-1} Q^T b \tag{383}$$

The classical Gram-Schmidt process is often numerically unstable.

**Algorithm 4.3 (Modified Gram-Schmidt for QR Decomposition)**

The Modified Gram-Schmidt algorithm provides better numerical stability by orthogonalizing the remaining column vectors against the newly computed orthonormal vector immediately at each step.

```
for j = 1, ..., n do
    v_j = a_j
end for
for i = 1, ..., n do
    r_ii = ||v_i||
    q_i = v_i / r_ii
    for j = i + 1, ..., n do
        r_ij = (v_j, q_i)
        v_j = v_j − r_ij q_i
    end for
end for
```

## 4.9 Cholesky Decomposition

**Definition 4.29 (Cholesky Decomposition)**

Every Hermitian (or real symmetric), positive-definite matrix $A$ can be decomposed into the product

$$A = LL^\dagger \tag{384}$$

where $L$ is a lower triangular matrix with strictly positive real diagonal entries. This decomposition is unique.

*Proof.* We proceed by induction on the dimension $n$ of the matrix $A$.
**Base case:** For $n = 1$, $A = (a_{11})$. Since $A$ is positive-definite, $a_{11} > 0$. We simply choose $L = (\sqrt{a_{11}})$, which is unique and positive.
**Inductive step:** Assume the theorem holds for $(n-1) \times (n-1)$ matrices. We partition the $n \times n$ matrix $A$ as:

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & w^\dagger \\ w & A_{22} \end{pmatrix} \tag{385}$$

where $a_{11}$ is a positive scalar (since $A$ is positive-definite, its diagonal entries are positive), $w$ is an $(n-1) \times 1$ column vector, and $A_{22}$ is an $(n-1) \times (n-1)$ Hermitian matrix.
We seek a lower triangular matrix $L$ of the form:

$$L = \begin{pmatrix} l_{11} & 0 \\ l_{21} & L_{22} \end{pmatrix} \tag{386}$$

such that $A = LL^\dagger$. Multiplying out $LL^\dagger$, we get:

$$\begin{pmatrix} l_{11}^2 & l_{11}l_{21}^\dagger \\ l_{11}l_{21} & l_{21}l_{21}^\dagger + L_{22}L_{22}^\dagger \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & w^\dagger \\ w & A_{22} \end{pmatrix} \tag{387}$$

Matching the blocks, we uniquely determine $l_{11} = \sqrt{a_{11}}$ (since $l_{11} > 0$). Then we can uniquely determine the column vector $l_{21} = w/l_{11}$.
Finally, we must satisfy $L_{22}L_{22}^\dagger = A_{22} - l_{21}l_{21}^\dagger$. The matrix $S = A_{22} - l_{21}l_{21}^\dagger$ is the Schur complement of $a_{11}$ in $A$. Because $A$ is positive-definite, its Schur complement $S$ is also positive-definite. By our inductive hypothesis, the $(n-1)\times(n-1)$ positive-definite matrix $S$ has a unique Cholesky decomposition $S = L_{22}L_{22}^\dagger$. Thus, $L_{22}$ exists and is unique, completing the proof.

**Algorithm 4.4 (Cholesky-Banachiewicz Algorithm)**

Intuitively, this algorithm computes the lower triangular matrix $L$ starting from the upper left corner and proceeding row by row. It requires about half the operations of the LU decomposition.

**for** $i = 1, \dots, n$ **do**
  **for** $j = 1, \dots, i$ **do**
    **if** $j = i$ **then**
      $l_{jj} = \sqrt{a_{jj} - \sum_{k=1}^{j-1} |l_{jk}|^2}$
    **else**
      $l_{ij} = \frac{1}{l_{jj}} \left( a_{ij} - \sum_{k=1}^{j-1} l_{ik} \bar{l}_{jk} \right)$
    **end if**
  **end for**
**end for**

## 4.10 Matrix Groups

**Definition 4.30 (Orthogonal Matrix)**

An **orthogonal matrix** is the matrix representation of an element in $O(n)$. It is the real $n \times n$ matrix where all the column vectors are pairwise orthogonal and all have magnitude 1.
The matrix representation of this group is the set of real $n \times n$ matrices where the column vectors form an orthonormal basis. Note that the determinant of every element of $O(n)$ is $\pm 1$.

**Theorem 4.45 (Rows of an Orthogonal Matrix Are Orthonormal)**

The rows of an orthogonal matrix are also pairwise orthonormal.

**Definition 4.31 (Special Orthogonal Matrix)**

The matrix representation of this group is the set of real $n \times n$ matrices where the column vectors are pairwise orthonormal and the determinant $= 1$.

**Theorem 4.46 (Transpose of an Orthogonal Matrix Is Its Inverse)**

Given an orthogonal matrix $M$,

$$M^T = M^{-1} \tag{388}$$

## 4.11 Exercises

# 5 Tensors

Remember that given a vector space $V$ over $\mathbb{F}$, an element $l \in V^*$ is a linear map $l : V \to \mathbb{F}$. Since $V \simeq V^{**}$, we can interpret $v \in V$ also as a linear map $v : V^* \to \mathbb{F}$. Since all vectors are therefore linear maps, we hope to combine vectors together to create *bilinear maps*.

**Definition 5.1 (Bilinear Map)**

Let $U, V, W$ be vector spaces over $\mathbb{F}$.

1. A **bilinear map** is a map $f : U \times V \to W$ such that it is linear with respect to the first and second arguments.
   (a) *First Argument Linearity.* $f(au_1 + bu_2, v) = af(u_1, v) + bf(u_2, v)$.
   (b) *Second Argument Linearity.* $f(u, av_1 + bv_2) = af(u, v_1) + bf(u, v_2)$.
2. A **multilinear map** is a map $f : \prod_{k=1}^n V_k \to W$ that is linear in each of its arguments.

The set of all $n$-multilinear maps forms a vector space.

*Proof.* Trivial.

Multilinear maps are a natural extension of linear maps that we have been working with so far, and that is exactly what tensors are.[3] Informally, it turns out that the set of all multilinear maps is isomorphic to a bigger vector space, called the *tensor product space*, and this property is known as the *universal property of the tensor product*. We will start by first constructing a tensor product space, verifying the universal property, and finally describing its elements with respect to a natural basis.

**Definition 5.2 (Free Vector Space)**

A **free vector space** on set $S$ over field $\mathbb{F}$ is defined equivalently, up to isomorphism, by the following.

1. It is the vector space whose basis elements are the formal symbols $[s]$ for all $s \in S$.
2. It is the vector space of all functions $f : S \to \mathbb{F}$ that is nonzero for finitely many $s \in S$. That is,

$$F(S) \coloneqq \{f : S \to \mathbb{F} \colon f(s) \neq 0 \text{ for finitely many } s \in S\} \tag{389}$$

*Proof.* Let $F_1(S), F_2(S)$ be the first and second constructions, respectively. We define the bijection $\varphi : F_1(S) \to F_2(S)$ by first mapping $[s] \leftrightarrow \mathbb{1}_{\{s\}}$ and extending by linearity to every other element. That is, if $v \in F(S_1)$, then

$$\varphi(v) = \varphi\left( \sum_{k=1}^n a_k [s_k] \right) \coloneqq \sum_{k=1}^n a_k \mathbb{1}_{\{s_k\}} \tag{390}$$

It is easy to check that this is an isomorphism.

## 5.1 Tensor Product Spaces

This will give us a basis-free definition of the tensor product space, but we need to do a bit more work. We generally want to have bilinear maps, so we need to quotient out some things.

**Definition 5.3 (Tensor Product Space)**

Let $V, W$ be two vector spaces over the same field $\mathbb{F}$. The **tensor product space** of $V$ and $W$ is defined as the quotient space

$$V \otimes W \coloneqq \frac{F(V \times W)}{L} \tag{391}$$

[3] As Aspinwall says, it is a glorified comma.

where $F(V \times W)$ is the free vector space and $L$ is the subspace generated by all vectors of the form

$$[(v_1 + v_2, w)] - [(v_1, w)] - [(v_2, w)] \tag{392}$$
$$[(v, w_1 + w_2)] - [(v, w_1)] - [(v, w_2)] \tag{393}$$
$$[(cv, w)] - c[(v, w)] \tag{394}$$
$$[(v, cw)] - c[(v, w)] \tag{395}$$
$$\tag{396}$$

The canoncical map

$$\iota : V \times W \to V \otimes W, \quad \iota(v, w) \coloneqq v \otimes w \coloneqq [(v, w)] \pmod{L} \tag{397}$$

is bilinear (but not surjective).

1. A **tensor** is an element of $V \otimes W$.
2. An **elementary tensor** is an element of the form $v \otimes w \coloneqq \iota(v, w)$.[a]

[a] Not all tensors are elementary tensors! There are more elements in $V \otimes W$ that aren't elementary tensors.

*Proof.* This is indeed a vector space since quotients spaces are vector spaces. To prove that $\iota$ is bilinear, note that

$$\iota(v_1 + v_2, w) \equiv [(v_1 + v_2, w)] \pmod{L} \tag{398}$$
$$\equiv [(v_1 + v_2, w)] - [(v_1 + v_2, w)] + [(v_1, w)] + [(v_2, w)] \pmod{L} \tag{399}$$
$$= [(v_1, w)] + [(v_2, w)] \pmod{L} \tag{400}$$
$$\equiv \iota(v_1, w) + \iota(v_2, w) \tag{401}$$

and

$$\iota(cv, w) \equiv [(cv, w)] \pmod{L} \tag{402}$$
$$\equiv [(cv, w)] - [(cv, w)] + c[(v, w)] \pmod{L} \tag{403}$$
$$= c[(v, w)] \pmod{L} \tag{404}$$
$$\equiv c\iota(v, w) \tag{405}$$

The same argument follows for the second argument.

Note that the tensor product of vectors is not the same as the tensor product of spaces.

If we have a linear map $\psi : V \otimes W \to U$, then we can just compose it with the canonical map to get the *bilinear* map $\varphi = \psi \circ \iota : V \times W \to U$. But what about the other way around? For every bilinear $\varphi$, does there exist a correspond linear $\psi$? The answer is yes, as described by the universal property of tensor products.

**Theorem 5.1 (Universal Property of Tensor Products)**

For every bilinear map $\varphi : V \times W \longrightarrow U$, there exists a unique linear map $\psi : V \otimes W \longrightarrow U$ such that

$$\psi \circ \iota = \varphi \tag{406}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V \times W & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & U \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \iota} & \nearrow_{\psi} & \\ V \otimes W & & \end{array} \tag{407}$$

Figure 10

*Proof.* The elements of $F(V \times W)$ are of the form $\sum_i a_i[(v_i, w_i)]$. Now take any bilinear map $\varphi : V \times W \to U$, and define the linear map $\psi : F(V \times W) \to U$ by first defining the action on the basis vectors

$$\psi([v, w]) \coloneqq \varphi(v, w) \tag{408}$$

and extending it linearly. Then,

$$\varphi\bigg(\sum_i a_i[(v_i, w_i)]\bigg) = \sum_i a_i \psi\big([(v_i, w_i)]\big) = \sum_i a_i \varphi(v_i, w_i) \tag{409}$$

We wish to show that $\psi$ respects the quotient determined by $L$, i.e. prove that $\ker(\psi) \subset L$. We can simply verify.

$$\psi\big([(v_1 + v_2, w)] - [(v_1, w)] - [(v_2, w)]\big) = \varphi(v_1 + v_2, w) - \varphi(v_1, w) - \varphi(v_2, w) = 0 \tag{410}$$

$$\psi\big([(cv, w)] - c[(v, w)]\big) = \varphi(cv, w) - c\varphi(v, w) = 0 \tag{411}$$

$$\psi\big([(v, w_1 + w_2)] - [(v, w_1)] - [(v, w_2)]\big) = \varphi(v, w_1 + w_2) - \varphi(v, w_1) - \varphi(v, w_2) = 0 \tag{412}$$

$$\psi\big([(v, cw)] - c[(v, w)]\big) = \varphi(v, cw) - c\varphi(v, w) = 0 \tag{413}$$

Therefore, we can interpret maps from tensor product spaces precisely as bilinear maps. Going one step further, if we take a linear functional from the dual tensor product space, we can interpret that functional as a bilinear map as well!

**Lemma 5.2 (Commutativity of Tensor Products on Spaces)**

Given vector spaces $V, W$ over field $\mathbb{F}$,

$$V \otimes W \simeq W \otimes V \tag{414}$$

*Proof.* We again use the universal property.[a] Let $\varphi : V \times W \to W \otimes V, \varphi(v, w) = w \otimes v$ be the "swapped" bilinear map. Then, by the universal property, there exists a linear map $\psi : V \otimes W \to W \otimes V$ satisfying the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V \times W & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & W \otimes V \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \iota} & \nearrow_{\psi} & \\ V \otimes W & & \end{array} \tag{415}$$

Figure 11

Therefore, $\psi(v \otimes w) = (\psi \circ \iota)(v, w) = \varphi(v, w) = w \otimes v$ is linear. It's not straightforward to prove that it is bijective, so we just do the opposite by swapping $V$ and $W$ and repeating the whole process to get

a map $\phi : W \times V \to V \times W$ defined $\phi(w \otimes v) = v \otimes w$. We can see that both $\psi, \phi$ are linear with

$$\psi \circ \phi = \mathrm{id}_{W \otimes V}, \qquad \phi \circ \psi = \mathrm{id}_{V \otimes W} \tag{416}$$

and so they are inverses, implying that $\psi$ is an isomorphism.

[a] I was thinking of proving it directly from $V \otimes W = \frac{F(V \times W)}{L} \simeq \frac{F(W \times V)}{L'} = W \otimes V$. It's easy to prove that $F(V \times W) \simeq F(W \times V)$, but not for $L \simeq L'$.

**Corollary 5.3 (2-Tensors as Bilinear Functionals and Maps)**

$(V \otimes W)^\dagger$ is canonically isomorphic to the following as vectors spaces.

1. The space of all bilinear functionals on $V \times W$.

$$\mathrm{Bilinear}(V \times W, \mathbb{F}) \tag{417}$$

2. The space of all linear maps from $V \to W^\dagger$.

$$\mathrm{Hom}(V, W^\dagger) \tag{418}$$

3. The space of all linear maps from $W \to V^\dagger$.

$$\mathrm{Hom}(W, V^\dagger) \tag{419}$$

*Proof.* Listed.

1. The isomorphism sends the linear functional $\psi : V \times W \to \mathbb{F}$ to the bilinear map $\varphi(v, w) \coloneqq \psi(v \otimes w)$. The inverse map sends the bilinear map $\varphi$ to the unique linear map $\psi$ given by the universal property.
2. Given $\ell \in (V \otimes W)^\dagger$, define the map

$$A_\ell : V \to W^\dagger, \quad A_\ell(v)(w) = \ell(v \otimes w) \tag{420}$$

This is linear since for fixed $w \in W$,

$$\begin{aligned} A_\ell(v_1 + v_2)(w) &= \ell((v_1 + v_2) \otimes w) && (421)\\ &= \ell(v_1 \otimes w + v_2 \otimes w) && (422)\\ &= \ell(v_1 \otimes w) + \ell(v_2 \otimes w) && (423)\\ &= A_\ell(v_1)(w) + A_\ell(v_2)(w) && (424)\\ A_\ell(cv)(w) &= \ell((cv) \otimes w) && (425)\\ &= \ell(c(v \otimes w)) && (426)\\ &= c\ell(v \otimes w) && (427)\\ &= cA_\ell(v)(w) && (428) \end{aligned}$$

Conversely, given linear $A : V \to W^\dagger$, define the bilinear map

$$\varphi : V \times W \to \mathbb{F}, \quad \varphi_A(v, w) = A(v)(w) \tag{429}$$

By the universal property, this induces a unique functional $\psi_A : V \otimes W \to \mathbb{F}$.

3. The proof is identical to the second point, or we can just invoke commutativity.

Therefore, we can view tensors as linear maps between vector spaces, and we get this by fixing one component

$v$ or $w$. That is, given element $T \in (V \otimes W^\dagger)^\dagger$, we know that if $W$ is infinite-dimensional, then $W \simeq W^{\dagger\dagger}$, so

$$(V \otimes W^\dagger)^\dagger \simeq \text{Hom}(V, W^{\dagger\dagger}) \simeq \text{Hom}(V, W) \simeq V^\dagger \otimes W \tag{430}$$

We will later demonstrate how such a tensor acts as a linear map on its input vectors.

**Theorem 5.4 (Basis of Tensor Product Space)**

If vector spaces $V, W$ have bases $\{v_i\}$, $\{w_j\}$, then $V \otimes W$ has basis $\{v_i \otimes w_j\}_{i,j}$, and every element of the tensor product space can be thought of as a linear combination of the elementary tensors $v_i \otimes w_j$.

$$t = \sum_{i,j} a_{ij} v_i \otimes w_j \in V \otimes W \tag{431}$$

Therefore, we can construct new basis vectors $e_i \otimes f_j$ out of old basis vectors $e_i, f_j$. This is done so much in applications that its realization to column vectors is designated a name.

**Definition 5.4 (Outer Product)**

Given vector spaces $U, V$ with defined bases in each of them, the **outer product** of two vectors $u \in U$ and $v \in V$ is defined

$$u \otimes v \coloneqq uv^T = \begin{pmatrix} u_1 \\ u_2 \\ \cdots \\ u_m \end{pmatrix} \otimes \begin{pmatrix} v_1 & \cdots & v_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} u_1 v_1 & \cdots & u_1 v_n \\ u_2 v_1 & \cdots & u_2 v_n \\ \cdots & \cdots & \cdots \\ u_m v_1 & \cdots & u_m v_n \end{pmatrix} \tag{432}$$

Abstractly speaking, the outer product of $u \in U$ and $v \in V$ is the element $u \otimes v \in U \otimes V$, which is a rank-(2,0) tensor, not a rank-(1,1) tensor! Just because it "looks" like a matrix, $u \otimes v$ should not be interpreted as a linear map. Such a $m \times n$ matrix could really be the realization of either a (2,0) tensor, (1,1) tensor, or a (0,2) tensor. We can extrapolate and see that for higher order tensor products, we would get an $n$-dimensional array of scalars. A matrix is a 2-dimensional array of numbers since it is the tensor product of two vectors.

**Definition 5.5 (Kronecker Product)**

Given vector spaces $U, V$ with defined bases in each of them, the **Kronecker product** of two vectors $u \in U$ and $v \in V$ is defined

$$u \otimes_{Kron} v \coloneqq \begin{pmatrix} u_1 \\ u_2 \\ \cdots \\ u_m \end{pmatrix} \otimes \begin{pmatrix} v_1 & \cdots & v_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} u_1 v_1 \\ u_1 v_2 \\ \cdots \\ u_m v_{n-1} \\ u_m v_n \end{pmatrix} \tag{433}$$

Clearly, the outer product and Kronecker product are closely related, and we can interpret the Kronecker product as a form of "vectorization" or "flattening out" of the outer product. The outer product is the matrix realization of the tensor product.

**Example 5.1 ($4 \times 3$ Dimensional Tensor Product Space)**

Let $V$ be a 4-dimensional vector space with basis $\{e_0, e_1, e_2, e_3\}$ and $W$ be a 3-dimensional vector space with basis $\{f_1, f_2, f_3\}$. Denote the basis of $V^\dagger$ as $\{e^1, e^2, e^3, e^4\}$. Then, the basis of $V^\dagger \otimes W$ is the set

of 12 vectors of the form

$$e^i \otimes f_j, \quad 1 \leq i \leq 4, 1 \leq j \leq 3 \tag{434}$$

If we write the dual vectors $e^i$ in the conventional row vectors and vectors $f_j$ in column vectors, we can conventionally write the tensor product as the outer product. That is, $e^i \otimes f_j$ is written as the $3 \times 4$ matrix of

$$e^3 \otimes f_2 = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \otimes \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \tag{435}$$

Since finite-dimensional vectors spaces are isomorphic to their dual, we also write $V \otimes W$ as matrices as well.

**Corollary 5.5 (Dimension of Tensor Product Space)**

$$\dim(V \otimes W) = \dim(V)\ \dim(W) \tag{436}$$

Since $U \otimes W$ is a vector space itself, we can multiply it further to create higher order tensor product spaces.

$$U \otimes W \otimes U \otimes \cdots \tag{437}$$

**Lemma 5.6 (Associativity of Tensor Products on Spaces)**

Given vector spaces $V, W, U$ over field $\mathbb{F}$,

$$(V \otimes W) \otimes U = V \otimes (W \otimes U) \tag{438}$$

*Proof.* We again use universal property. Let us construct our bilinear map $\varphi : (V \otimes W) \times U \to V \otimes (W \otimes U)$ by defining on the elementary tensors as

$$\varphi(v \otimes w, u) = v \otimes (w \otimes u) \tag{439}$$

Then let us extend this linearly in the first argument to all arbitrary tensors $x = \sum_i a_i v_i \otimes w_i$.[a]

$$\varphi\bigg( \sum_i a_i v_i \otimes w_i, u) = \sum_i a_i \varphi(v_i \otimes w_i, u) \tag{440}$$

Then, we can confirm that this is bilinear.

$$\begin{aligned}
\varphi(a(v_1 \otimes w_1) + b(v_2 \otimes w_2), u) &= a\varphi(v_1 \otimes w_1, u) + b\varphi(v_2 \otimes w_2, u) && (441)\\
\varphi(v \otimes w, u_1 + u_2) &= v \otimes \big(w \otimes (u_1 + u_2)\big) && (442)\\
&= v \otimes (w \otimes u_1 + w \otimes u_2) && (443)\\
&= v \otimes (w \otimes u_1) + v \otimes (w \otimes u_2) && (444)\\
&= \varphi(v \otimes w, u_1) + \varphi(v \otimes w, u_2) && (445)\\
\varphi(v \otimes w, cu) &= v \otimes \big(w \otimes (cu)\big) && (446)\\
&= v \otimes \big(c(w \otimes u)\big) && (447)\\
&= c\big(v \otimes (w \otimes u)\big) && (448)\\
&= c\varphi(v \otimes w, u) && (449)
\end{aligned}$$

[a] We actually have to prove that this is well-defined, since one tensor can have multiple decompositions.

Therefore, we don't need to write parentheses when defining tensor product spaces since $(U \otimes V) \otimes W \simeq U \otimes (V \otimes W) \simeq U \otimes V \otimes W$. This gives us a clean definition.

**Definition 5.6 (Higher Order Tensor Product Spaces)**

Given vector spaces $V_1, \dots, V_n$ over the field $\mathbb{F}$, the **$n$-fold tensor product space** is defined

$$\bigotimes_{i=1}^{n} V_i \coloneqq V_1 \otimes V_2 \otimes \cdots \otimes V_n \tag{450}$$

In geometry and physics, we usually write shorthand: $\mathbb{T}_l^k(V) \coloneqq V^{\otimes k} \otimes (V^\dagger)^{\otimes l}$. A **rank $(k,l)$-tensor** is an element of $\mathbb{T}_l^k V$.

*Proof.* This is well defined since there is a higher-dimensional analogue of the universal property that states that for each multilinear map $\varphi : \prod_{i=1}^n V_i \to U$, there exists a unique linear map $\psi : \bigotimes_{i=1}^n V_i \to U$ satisfying $\varphi = \psi \circ \iota$. As a consequence, we can see that

$$\text{Hom}\left(\prod_{i=1}^{n} V_i^*, \mathbb{F}\right) \simeq \text{Hom}\left(\prod_{i=2}^{n} V_i^*, V_1\right) \simeq \text{Hom}\left(\prod_{i=3}^{n} V_i^*, V_1 \otimes V_2\right) \simeq \cdots \tag{451}$$

The order in which we multiply $V$'s and $V^\dagger$'s matter, but since $\otimes$ on vector spaces is commutative, we can just work with tensor product spaces strictly in the form $V^{\otimes k} \otimes V^{\dagger \otimes l}$. So, $\mathbb{T}_1^1 \coloneqq V \otimes V^\dagger$, but $\mathbb{T}_1^1 \coloneqq V^\dagger \otimes V$. We can do this because the tensor product of spaces are commutative in the sense that we can always find an isomorphism. We can now think of the tensor product as a bilinear operator

$$\otimes : \mathbb{T}_q^p V \times \mathbb{T}_s^r V \longrightarrow \mathbb{T}_{q+s}^{p+r} V, \quad \left(\bigotimes_{i=1}^{p} v_i \otimes \bigotimes_{j=1}^{q} w_j\right) \otimes \left(\bigotimes_{i=p+1}^{p+r} v_i \otimes \bigotimes_{j=q+1}^{q+s} w_j\right) = \bigotimes_{i=1}^{p+r} v_i \otimes \bigotimes_{j=1}^{q+s} w_j \in \mathbb{T}_{q+s}^{p+r} V \tag{452}$$

**Example 5.2 (Low-Rank Tensor Product Spaces)**

$\mathbb{F}$ is a rank (0,0)-tensor space. $V$ is a rank (1,0)-tensor space, and $V^*$ is a rank (0,1)-tensor space.

The following two are immediate.

**Theorem 5.7 (Basis of $n$-Way Tensor Product Space)**

Given that

$$\{e_{i_j}\}_{i_j=1}^{k_j} \text{ of } V_j, \ j = 1, 2, \cdots, n \tag{453}$$

are $n$ sets of bases for each $V_j$,

$$\{\bigotimes_{j=1}^{n} e_{i_j}\}_{i_1, \cdots, i_n} \text{ is a basis of } \bigotimes_{j=1}^{n} V_j \tag{454}$$

*Proof.* Induction.

**Corollary 5.8 (Dimension of $n$-Way Tensor Product Space)**

Given vector spaces $V_1, V_2, \cdots, V_n$,

$$\dim \bigotimes_{i=1}^{n} V_i = \prod_{i=1}^{n} \dim V_i \tag{455}$$

*Proof.* This follows naturally from the construction of the basis.

Therefore, we can think of higher order tensors as multidimensional arrays.

**Example 5.3 (3-Tensor as a Multidimensional Array)**

A tensor in $\mathbb{R}^n \otimes \mathbb{R}^m \otimes \mathbb{R}^p$ is a $(n \times m \times p)$ array, arranged in a "rectangular prism." For example, $T \in \mathbb{R}^3 \otimes \mathbb{R}^2 \otimes \mathbb{R}^4$ may be visualized with the following cross sections.

$$T_{1,:,:} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 & -1 & 7 \\ 0 & 9 & -11 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{2\times 4} \tag{456}$$

$$T_{2,:,:} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 & -1 & 7 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & -4 \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{2\times 4} \tag{457}$$

$$T_{3,:,:} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 & 5 & 9 \\ 9 & 8 & 7 & 21 \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{2\times 4} \tag{458}$$

**Definition 5.7 (Tensor Rank)**

The **tensor rank** of an arbitrary tensor $T \in V_1 \otimes \dots V_n$ is the smallest $r \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$T = \sum_{i=1}^{r} a_i v_{1,i} \otimes \dots \otimes v_{n,i} \tag{459}$$

For some $v_{j,i} \in V_j$.[a]

[a] The scalars $a_i$ aren't necessary since we can just absorb them into the tensors.

## 5.2 Tensor Products of Linear Operators

Note that linear maps are themselves tensors, so we can talk about the tensor product of them as well.

**Definition 5.8 (Tensor Product of Linear Operators)**

Given linear operators $A : V \to V'$, $B : W \to W'$, the **tensor product map** of $A$ and $B$ is the unique linear operator

$$A \otimes B : V \otimes W \to V' \otimes W' \tag{460}$$

satisfying

$$(A \otimes B)(v \otimes w) \coloneqq Av \otimes Bw \tag{461}$$

*Proof.* We show that this is well-defined and unique. First, the map

$$\varphi : V \times W \to V \otimes W, \quad \varphi(v, w) \mapsto Av \otimes Bw \tag{462}$$

is bilinear since

$$\begin{aligned}
\varphi(v_1 + v_2, w) &= A(v_1 + v_2) \otimes Bw && (463)\\
&= (Av_1 + Av_2) \otimes Bw && (464)\\
&= (Av_1 \otimes Bw) + (Av_2 \otimes Bw) && (465)\\
&= \varphi(v_1, w) + \varphi(v_2, w) && (466)\\
\varphi(cv, w) &= A(cv) \otimes Bw && (467)\\
&= c(Av) \otimes Bw && (468)\\
&= c(Av \otimes Bw) && (469)\\
&= c\varphi(v, w) && (470)
\end{aligned}$$

and the same argument goes for the second argument. Therefore, by the universal property, there exists a unique bilinear map $\psi : V \otimes W \to V \otimes W$ satisfying $\psi(v \otimes w) = \varphi(v, w) = Av \otimes Bw$. Set $\psi = A \otimes B$.

To gain more insight, let's expand $A$ and $B$ into their basis expansion.

**Example 5.4 (Tensor Product of Two $2 \times 2$ Matrices)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} \end{pmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{pmatrix} b_{11} & b_{12} \\ b_{21} & b_{22} \end{pmatrix} \tag{471}$$

Given that $U$ has basis $\{u_1, u_2\}$ and $V$ has basis $\{v_1, v_2\}$, $U \otimes V$ will have basis

$$\{u_1 \otimes v_1, u_1 \otimes v_2, u_2 \otimes v_1, u_2 \otimes v_2\} \tag{472}$$

We then define the induced linear mapping $A \otimes B : U \otimes V \longrightarrow U \otimes V, (A \otimes B)(u \otimes v) \coloneqq Au \otimes Bv$ by computing the action on its basis vectors.

$$\begin{aligned}
(A \otimes B)(u_1 \otimes v_1) &= (a_{11}u_1 + a_{21}u_2) \otimes (b_{11}v_1 + b_{21}v_2) && (473)\\
&= a_{11}b_{11}(u_1 \otimes v_1) + a_{11}b_{21}(u_1 \otimes v_2) && (474)\\
&\quad + a_{21}b_{11}(u_2 \otimes v_1) + a_{21}b_{21}(u_2 \otimes v_2) && (475)\\
\cdots &= \cdots && (476)\\
(A \otimes B)(u_2 \otimes v_2) &= (a_{12}u_1 + a_{22}u_2) \otimes (b_{12}v_1 + b_{22}v_2) && (477)\\
&= a_{12}b_{12}(u_1 \otimes v_1) + a_{12}b_{22}(u_1 \otimes v_2) && (478)\\
&\quad + a_{22}b_{12}(u_2 \otimes v_1) + a_{22}b_{22}(u_2 \otimes v_2) && (479)
\end{aligned}$$

In matrix form, this results in the $4 \times 4$ matrix

$$A \otimes B = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11}b_{11} & a_{11}b_{12} & a_{12}b_{11} & a_{12}b_{12} \\ a_{11}b_{21} & a_{11}b_{22} & a_{12}b_{21} & a_{12}b_{22} \\ a_{21}b_{11} & a_{21}b_{12} & a_{22}b_{11} & a_{22}b_{12} \\ a_{21}b_{21} & a_{21}b_{22} & a_{22}b_{21} & a_{22}b_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11}B & a_{12}B \\ a_{21}B & a_{22}B \end{pmatrix} \tag{480}$$

representing the linear transformation from $U \otimes V$ to itself under the basis $\{u_i \otimes v_j\}$.

**Theorem 5.9 (Matrix Realization of Tensor Product Operators)**

In general,the tensor product of matrices $A \in \text{End}(V)$ and $B \in \text{End}(W)$ (with basis of $V, W$ defined) is the $(mn) \times (mn)$ matrix

$$A \otimes B = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11}B & a_{12}B & \cdots & a_{1n}B \\ a_{21}B & a_{22}B & \cdots & a_{2n}B \\ \cdots & \cdots & \cdots & \cdots \\ a_{n1}B & a_{n2}B & \cdots & a_{nn}B \end{pmatrix} \tag{481}$$

represented in block form.

*Proof.* Proof by example above.

**Lemma 5.10 (Properties of Tensor Products of Linear Operators)**

Given linear operators $A : V \to W$, $C : U \to V$, $B : V' \to W'$, and $D : U' \to V'$, we have

$$(A \times B)(C \otimes D) = (AC) \otimes (BD) \tag{482}$$

$$(A \otimes B)^\dagger = A^\dagger \otimes B^\dagger \tag{483}$$

*Proof.*

**Theorem 5.11 (Endomorphisms of a Tensor Product)**

For finite dimensional space $V$ and $W$,

$$\text{End}(V \otimes W) \simeq \text{End}(V) \otimes \text{End}(W) \tag{484}$$

canonically.

## 5.3 Contractions

**Definition 5.9 (Covariant, Contravariant Tensors)**

Let $V$ be a vector space over $\mathbb{F}$.

1. A **contravariant tensor of rank** $k$ is an element of

$$V^{\otimes k}. \tag{485}$$

2. A **covariant tensor of rank** $l$ is an element of

$$(V^\dagger)^{\otimes l}. \tag{486}$$

3. More generally, a **tensor of type** $(k, l)$ is an element of

$$\mathbb{T}^k_l(V) \coloneqq V^{\otimes k} \otimes (V^\dagger)^{\otimes l}. \tag{487}$$

It has $k$ contravariant components and $l$ covariant components.

Thus, vectors $v \in V$ are tensors of type $(1, 0)$, while covectors $\ell \in V^\dagger$ are tensors of type $(0, 1)$.

When working with general tensors, they are a linear combination of elementary tensors, but is is very

tedious to write them with summations everywhere, so we adopt the *Einstein summation notation* from now on to write the following. It's hard to define, so we cut some corners and just give a bunch of examples.

**Definition 5.10 (Einstein Summation Notation)**

Let $V, W$ (over field $\mathbb{F}$) have bases $\{e_i\}_{i=1}^n, \{f_j\}_{j=1}^m$, respectively (covariant vectors), with $V^\dagger, W^\dagger$ having bases $\{\ell^i\}_{i=1}^n, \{\omega^j\}_{j=1}^m$, respectively (contravariant vectors). Then,[a]

1. An element in $V$ is written as
$$v^i e_i = \sum_{i=1}^n v^i e_i, \qquad v^i \in \mathbb{F} \tag{488}$$
2. An element in $V^\dagger$ is written as
$$\ell_i e^i = \sum_{i=1}^n \ell_i e^i, \qquad \ell_i \in \mathbb{F} \tag{489}$$
3. An element in $V \otimes W$ is written as
$$a^{ij} e_i \otimes f_j = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^m a^{ij} e_i \otimes f_j, \qquad a^{ij} \in \mathbb{F} \tag{490}$$
4. An element in $V \otimes V$ is written as
$$a^{ij} e_i \otimes e_i = \sum_{i,j=1}^n a^{ij} e_i \otimes e_j, \qquad a^{ij} \in \mathbb{F} \tag{491}$$
5. An element in $V \otimes W^\dagger$ is written as
$$a^i_j e_i \otimes \omega^j = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^m a^i_j e_i \otimes \omega^j, \qquad a^i_j \in \mathbb{F} \tag{492}$$

Note that $v^i$ and $\ell_i$ are components of the vector $v$ and $\ell$, respectively.

[a] The indices in this context are not important here (but they are significant in physics).

**Example 5.5 (More Complicated Tensors in Einstein Summation Notation)**

Let's look at a few harder examples.

1. A rank (0, 2) tensor is written
$$T_{\mu\nu} e^\mu \otimes e^\nu \coloneqq \sum_{\mu,\nu} T_{\mu\nu} e^\mu \otimes e^\nu \in V^\dagger \otimes V^\dagger \tag{493}$$
2. A rank $n$ covariant tensor is written
$$T_{\mu_1,\cdots,\mu_n} e^{\mu_1} \otimes e^{\mu_2} \otimes \cdots \otimes e^{\mu_n} = \sum_{\mu_1,\cdots,\mu_n} T_{\mu_1,\cdots,\mu_n} e^{\mu_1} \otimes e^{\mu_2} \otimes \cdots \otimes e^{\mu_n} \tag{494}$$
3. A general tensor with 2 covariant and 2 contravariant components is written
$$T_\mu{}^{\alpha\beta}{}_\nu \; e^\mu \otimes e_\alpha \otimes e_\beta \otimes e^\nu \coloneqq \sum_{\mu,\alpha,\beta,\nu} T_\mu{}^{\alpha\beta}{}_\nu \; e^\mu \otimes e_\alpha \otimes e_\beta \otimes e^\nu \in V^\dagger \otimes V \otimes V \otimes V^\dagger \tag{495}$$

Since the coefficients of the shorthand tensor notation implies the tensors themselves, we can simply write
$$T_{\mu_1,\cdots,\mu_n} \coloneqq T_{\mu_1,\cdots,\mu_n} \bigotimes_{i=1}^n e^{\mu_i} \tag{496}$$

Now we introduce contractions, probably the most important operation you can do with tensors. To motivate this, let's do 2 examples.

**Example 5.6 (Contraction of Rank (1, 1) Tensor)**

Recall that for any vector $v \in V$ and dual vector $\ell \in V^\dagger$, $\ell$ acts on $v \in V$ in the way that $\ell(v) \in \mathbb{F}$. We can think of this as a bilinear operator[a]

$$\varphi : V \times V^\dagger \to \mathbb{F}, \quad \varphi(v, \ell) \coloneqq \ell(v) \tag{497}$$

By the universal property, there exists a linear map $C : V \otimes V^\dagger \to \mathbb{F}$—which we denote $C$ for "contraction"—such that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V \times V^\dagger & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & \mathbb{F} \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \iota} & \nearrow_{C} & \\ V \otimes V^\dagger & & \end{array} \tag{498}$$

Figure 12

This is our contraction operator. Now if we had a basis $\{e_i\}, \{e^i\}$ on $V, V^\dagger$, then we can write $v = a^i e_i, \ell = b_i e^i$, and specifically, $\varphi$ acts as

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi(v, \ell) &= \varphi(a^i e_i, b_j e^j) && (499)\\ &= \varphi\bigg( \sum_{i=1}^n a^i e_i, \sum_{j=1}^n b_j e^j \bigg) && (500)\\ &= \sum_i \sum_j a^i b_j \varphi(e_i, e^j) && (501)\\ &= \sum_i \sum_j a^i b_j e^j(e_i) && (502)\\ &= \sum_i a^i b_i && (503) \end{aligned}$$

Likewise, in Einstein notation, $C$ acts on elementary tensors as

$$C : V \otimes V^\dagger \to \mathbb{F}, \quad C(v \otimes \ell) = C(a^i e_i \otimes b_i e^i) = \sum_i a^i b_i \tag{504}$$

That is, we can take a covariant vector and a contravariant vector and "cancel them" out by invoking the action of $\ell$ onto $v$. But our contraction operator does even more. More generally, we can extend this to all arbitrary tensors to define.

$$\begin{aligned} C(a^i_j e_i \otimes e^j) &= C\bigg( \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^n a^i_j e_i \otimes e^j \bigg) && (505)\\ &= \sum_i \sum_j a^i_j C(e_i \otimes e^j) && \text{(linearity of } C) \\ &= \sum_i \sum_j a^i_j e^j(e_i) && (506)\\ &= \sum_i a^i_i && (507) \end{aligned}$$

[a] This is clear since $\ell$ by definition is linear and hence $\varphi$ is linear on $v$. $\varphi$ is linear on $\ell$ since $V^\dagger$ is a vector space.

This is in some way a generalization of $\ell(v)$, but we want to be able to do this with higher order tensors. Let's do a higher order tensor.

**Example 5.7 (Contraction of Rank (2, 1) Tensor)**

On $V \otimes V \otimes V^\dagger$, we would like to contract the second and third spaces together. Define a multilinear operator

$$\varphi : V \times V \times V^\dagger \to V, \quad \varphi(v, w, \ell) \coloneqq \ell(w)v \tag{508}$$

Then, by the universal property, there exists a linear map $C : V \otimes V \otimes V^\dagger \to V$ such that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V \times V \times V^\dagger & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & V \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \iota} & \nearrow_{C} & \\ V \otimes V \otimes V^\dagger & & \end{array} \tag{509}$$

Figure 13

This becomes our contraction operator. If we had a basis $\{e_i\}, \{e^i\}$ on $V, V^\dagger$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi(v, w, \ell) &= \varphi(v, b^j e_j, c_k e^k) && (510)\\ &= \sum_{j=1}^{n} \sum_{k=1}^{n} b^j c_k \varphi(v, e_j, e^k) && (511)\\ &= \sum_{j} \sum_{k} b^j c_k \, e^k(e_j)v && (512)\\ &= \sum_{j=1}^{n} b^j c_j v && (513) \end{aligned}$$

and we can extend $C$ linearly so that for arbitrary tensors $a^{ij}_k e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^k$,

$$\begin{aligned} C(a^{ij}_k e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^k) &= \sum_{i,j,k} a^{ij}_k C(e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^k) && (514)\\ &= \sum_{i,j,k} a^{ij}_k e^k(e_j) e_i && (515)\\ &= \sum_{i,j} a^{ij}_j e_i && (516) \end{aligned}$$

You can see the pattern here. We choose any two vector spaces in our tensor product that are dual to each other, and then we can apply the contraction operator—which is guaranteed to exist by the universal property—to cancel them out and get a new vector in the tensor product space of the remaining non-contracted spaces. Usually, if we have already contracted two spaces together, we write them with the same index. So for $a^{ij}_k e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^k \in V \otimes V \otimes V^\dagger$,

1. If we wanted to contract the first and last indices, we would write

$$a^{ij}_k e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^k \in V \otimes V \otimes V^\dagger \xrightarrow{C^1_3} a^{ij}_i e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^i = \sum_j \underbrace{\left( \sum_i a^{ij}_i \right)}_{\alpha_j} e_j \tag{517}$$

2. If we wanted to contract the second and last indices, we would write

$$a^{ij}_k e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^k \in V \otimes V \otimes V^\dagger \xrightarrow{C^2_3} a^{ij}_j e_i \otimes e_j \otimes e^i = \sum_i \underbrace{\left( \sum_j a^{ij}_j \right)}_{\alpha_i} e_i \tag{518}$$

**Definition 5.11 (Contraction)**

Let $V_1 \otimes \dots V_n$ be a tensor product space, with $1 \leq p = q \leq n$ and $V_p \simeq V_q^\dagger$. Then, a **(p, q)-contraction** is a linear map defined as the linear extension of the map

$$C^p_q : \bigotimes_i V_i \to \bigotimes_{i \neq p,q} V_i, C^p_q \left( \bigotimes_{i=1}^n V_i \right) \coloneqq v_q(v_p) \bigotimes_{i \neq p,q} V_i \tag{519}$$

to the entire tensor product space domain.

*Proof.* Let us define the map

$$\tilde{C}^m_n : \prod_p V \times \prod_q V^* \longrightarrow \mathbb{T}^{p-1}_{q-1} V \tag{520}$$

such that (where the hatted elements are taken out)

$$(x_1, \cdots, x_p, \alpha_1, \cdots, \alpha_q) \mapsto \alpha_n(x_m)\, x_1 \otimes \cdots \hat{x_m} \cdots \otimes x_p \otimes \alpha_1 \otimes \cdots \hat{\alpha_n} \cdots \otimes \alpha_q \tag{521}$$

This is clearly a multilinear map, so by the universal property, there exists a unique linear map $C^m_n : \mathbb{T}^p_q V \longrightarrow \mathbb{T}^{p-1}_{q-1} V$ such that

$$\bigotimes_{i=1}^p x_i \otimes \bigotimes_{j=1}^q \alpha_j \mapsto \alpha_n(x_m) \bigotimes_{i \neq m} x_i \otimes \bigotimes_{j \neq n} \alpha_j \tag{522}$$

This contraction function is also canonical, i.e. we did not have to endow any structures to $V$ to define $C^n_m$. We could also contract multiple steps at once with the map $\mathbb{T}^p_q \longrightarrow \mathbb{T}^{p-k}_{q-k}$, but this is really just a composition of single contractions

$$\mathbb{T}^p_q \longrightarrow \mathbb{T}^{p-1}_{q-1} \longrightarrow \mathbb{T}^{p-2}_{q-2} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow \mathbb{T}^{p-k}_{q-k} \tag{523}$$

What we have just defined is internal contraction, where we contract the indices of a given tensor with each other. We could also contract against another external tensor, which we call *evaluation*.

**Example 5.8 (Evaluation of Rank (1, 2) Tensor)**

Let $e_\mu \otimes e^\nu \otimes e^\lambda \in \mathbb{T}^1_2$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} (e_\mu \otimes e^\nu \otimes e^\lambda)\big(B_\epsilon e^\epsilon, A^\delta e_\delta, C^\sigma e_\sigma\big) &= e_\mu(B_\epsilon e^\epsilon) \cdot e^\nu(A^\delta e_\delta) \cdot e^\lambda(C^\sigma e_\sigma) \\ &= B_\epsilon A^\delta C^\sigma \, \delta^\epsilon_\mu \, \delta^\nu_\delta \, \delta^\lambda_\sigma \\ &= B_\mu A^\nu C^\lambda \in \mathbb{R} \end{aligned}$$

It turns out that a lot of our familiar operations are just tensor contractions.

**Example 5.9 (Inner Product)**

The inner product is (sort of) like a contraction. Let $V$ be an inner product space. Given $v, w \in V$, we can identify $w$ with a covector $\ell \in V^\dagger$ such that $\langle v, w \rangle = \ell(v)$ for all $v \in V$. Therefore, we can view

$$\langle v, w \rangle = \ell(v) = C_1^1(v \otimes \ell) \tag{524}$$

**Example 5.10 (Linear Maps)**

Given bases $\{e_i\}$ and $\{f_j\}$ for finite-dimensional $V, W$, let $\{e^i\}$ be the dual basis for $V^\dagger$. A tensor $A \in V^\dagger \otimes W$ can be written as:

$$A = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \sum_{j=1}^{m} a_i^j \, e^i \otimes f_j \tag{525}$$

Given a vector $v = b^i e_i \in V$, we can externally contract it with $A$ to get

$$C_3^1(A \otimes v) = C\big((a_i^j e^i \otimes e_j) \otimes (b^i e_i)\big) = a_i^j b^i e_j = \sum_{j=1}^{m} \left( \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i^j b^i \right) e_j = A(v) \tag{526}$$

which is precisely what a linear map does! In fact, the coefficients $a_{ji}$ correspond exactly to the matrix entries of $A$.

**Theorem 5.12 (Rank of Linear Maps)**

The rank (dimension of image) of a linear map $A : V \to W$ is the tensor rank of $A \in V^\dagger \otimes W$.

*Proof.*

**Corollary 5.13 (Outer Products Have Tensor Rank One)**

The tensor rank of the outer product of any 2 vectors is 1.

*Proof.* Trivial.

**Example 5.11 (Composition of Linear Maps)**

The contraction of the tensor product of linear operators $A : V \to W, B : W \to U$ is just the regular composition $AB$. Note that this contraction contracts the second index of $A$ with the first index of $B$. If $V, W, U$ has basis $\{e_i\}, \{f_j\}, \{h_k\}$, then

$$C_3^2(A \otimes B) = C_3^2\big((A_i^j e^i \otimes f_j) \otimes (B_l^k f^l \otimes h_k)\big) \tag{527}$$

$$= (A_i^j e^i \otimes f_j) \otimes (B_j^k f^j \otimes h_k) \tag{528}$$

$$= A_i^j B_j^k e^i \otimes h_k \in V^\dagger \otimes U \tag{529}$$

**Definition 5.12 (Trace)**

The trace of a linear operator $A = A^i_j e_i \otimes e^j$ is the value of its (1, 1) contraction.
Given that $\{e_i\}$ is the basis for $n$-dimensional space $V$ and $\{f_i\}$ is the dual basis of $V^*$.

$$C^1_1(x \otimes \alpha) = \alpha(u) = \Big(\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i f_i\Big)\Big(\sum_{j=1}^n x_j e_j\Big) = \sum_{i,j} \alpha_i x_j \delta^j_i = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i x_i \tag{530}$$

which is clearly the definition of the trace.

**Corollary 5.14 (Trace and Determinant of Tensor Product Operators)**

$$\operatorname{Tr} A \otimes B = \operatorname{Tr} A \cdot \operatorname{Tr} B \tag{531}$$
$$\det A \otimes B = (\det A)^n (\det B)^m \tag{532}$$

Furthermore, just like linear mappings or vectors, we can factorize arbitrary tensors in their own way, called *tensor decompositions*.[4] One of the most popular decompositions is the following.

**Theorem 5.15 (Schmidt Decomposition)**

For any $w \in U \otimes V$, where $U, V$ $(\dim U = n, \dim V = m)$ are inner product spaces over $\mathbb{F} \in \{\mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}\}$, there exists an orthonormal basis $\{u_i\}$ of $U$ and $\{v_j\}$ of $V$ such that

$$w = \sum_{i=1}^{\min\{n,m\}} \alpha_i u_i \otimes v_i, \qquad \alpha_i \in \mathbb{F} \tag{533}$$

*Proof.* Since $U \otimes V \simeq \operatorname{Hom}(V^\dagger, U)$, we can interpret $w$ as a matrix $\tilde{w}$. Using singular value decomposition, there exists unitary matrices $A, B$ and diagonal matrix $\Sigma$ such that

$$\tilde{w} = A \Sigma B^\dagger \tag{534}$$

$C(A)$ and $R(B^\dagger)$ determine the orthonormal basis of $U \otimes V$, and we can thus see that the minimum number of required $u \otimes v$'s is precisely the number of nonzero singular values, which is the rank of $\tilde{w}$.

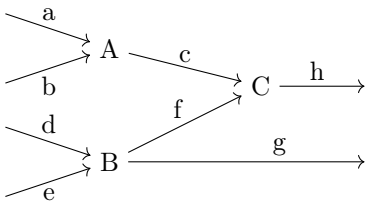
**Example 5.12 (Tensor Decompositions as Networks)**

We can factorize a complex tensor $X$ into a product of tensors that can be contracted to result in $X$. We can think of factoring tensors as analogous to anti-contraction. This process is best illustrated with the following example. Let us factor the tensor into three different tensors: a rank (1,2) tensor $A$, rank (2,2) tensor $B$, and rank (1,2) tensor $C$.

$$X_{abde}{}^{hg} = A_{ab}{}^{c} \otimes B_{de}{}^{fg} \otimes C_{cf}{}^{h} \tag{535}$$

We can visually represent factorization with the tensor network diagram

[4] The field of math dealing with this is called *Tensor Network Theory*, which has multiple applications in computer science, chemistry, and physics.




where the "inputs" at each node are covectors and the "outputs" are vectors. Therefore, the entire diagram, which represents the tensor $X$ has a total of 4 inputs (indices $a, b, d, e$) and two outputs (indices $h, g$). We can see from the diagram that the indices $c$ and $f$, which travels "between" the factors are the ones that are being contracted. Therefore, the contraction of $c$ and $f$ contracts the rank (4,6) tensor $A \otimes B \otimes C$ to a rank (2,4) tensor.

## 5.4 Symmetric and Alternating Tensors

Note that $v \otimes w \neq w \otimes v$ in general, but we would like to enforece some symmetry conditions.

**Definition 5.13 (Permutation of Tensor Factors)**

For some $\sigma \in S_k$, the permutation group, define for an elementary tensor

$$P_\sigma(v_1 \otimes \ldots \otimes v_k) \coloneqq v_{\sigma(1)} \otimes v_{\sigma(2)} \otimes \ldots \otimes v_{\sigma(k)} \tag{536}$$

Note that this is only for elementary tensors, not general tensors. For general tensors, we define the following.

**Definition 5.14 (Symmetric, Alternating Tensors)**

Let $V$ be a vector space over field $\mathbb{F}$ with $\text{char}(\mathbb{F}) \neq k$. Then, for any $T \in V^{\otimes k}$, we define

1. the **symmetric component** of $T$ as

$$\text{Sym} : V^{\otimes k} \to V^{\otimes}, \quad \text{Sym}(T) \coloneqq \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} P_\sigma(T) \tag{537}$$

2. the **alternating component** of $T$ as

$$\text{Alt} : V^{\otimes k} \to V^{\otimes}, \quad \text{Alt}(T) \coloneqq \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \text{sgn}(\sigma) P_\sigma(T) \tag{538}$$

where $\text{sgn}(\sigma)$ is the signature of $\sigma$.

Now we would like to find some subspace of tensors that are either symmetric or alternating.

**Definition 5.15 (Symmetric Power)**

The **kth symmetric power of** $V$ of dimension $n$ is the subspace defined in the equivalent ways.

1. *Direct Construction.*

$$\text{Sym}^k(V) = \{T \in V^{\otimes k} \colon P_\sigma(T) = T \text{ for all } \sigma \in S_k\} \tag{539}$$

2. *Quotient Space.*

$$\mathrm{Sym}^k(V) = \frac{V^{\otimes k}}{L_{\text{sym}}}, \quad L = \mathrm{span}\{T - P_\sigma(T) \colon T \in V^{\otimes k}, \sigma \in S_k\} \tag{540}$$

$$= \mathrm{span}\{v_1 \dots v_i \otimes v_{i+1} \dots v_k - v_1 \dots v_{i+1} \otimes v_i \dots v_k\} \tag{541}$$

We define the symmetric product of elementary tensors as the quotient of the tensor products.

$$v_1 \odot \dots \odot v_n \coloneqq [v_1 \otimes \dots \otimes v_n] \tag{542}$$

which satisfies:

1. *Symmetric.* $v_1 \dots v_i \odot \dots \odot v_j \dots v_k - v_1 \dots v_j \odot \dots \odot v_i \dots v_k$ for any $1 \leq i \leq j \leq k$.
2. *Dimension.* $\dim(\mathrm{Sym}^k(V)) = \binom{n+k-1}{k}$.

*Proof.* Let $\mathrm{Sym}_1^k(V)$ be the space defined in (1) and $\mathrm{Sym}_2^k(V)$ be the one defined in (2). Assume that the underlying field has characteristic 0. Let $\mathrm{Sym} : V^{\otimes k} \to V^{\otimes k}$ be the symmetrization operator on a tensor, defined by

$$\mathrm{Sym}(T) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} P_\sigma(T). \tag{543}$$

We show some facts.

1. $L_1 = L_2$. Let us define $L_1$ and $L_2$ as the first and second spans.
   (a) $L_1 \subseteq L_2$. Given any $T$, we can write it as a linear combination of elementary tensors, so let us work with an elementary tensor $T$ directly. Since every permutation can be decomposed into adjacent transpositions, every vector of the form $T - P_\sigma(T)$ can be written as
   $$\underbrace{T - P_{\tau_1}(T)}_{\in L_2} + \underbrace{P_{\tau_1}(T) - P_{\tau_2}(P_{\tau_1}(T))}_{\in L_2} + \dots + \underbrace{P_{\tau_{m-1}\cdots\tau_1}(T) - P_{\tau_m \cdots \tau_1}(T)}_{\in L_2}, \tag{544}$$
   where $\sigma = \tau_m \cdots \tau_1$ and each $\tau_i$ is an adjacent transposition. This is a linear combination of elements in $L_2$.
   (b) $L_2 \subseteq L_1$. Every generator of $L_2$ is of the form
   $$v_1 \otimes \dots \otimes v_i \otimes v_{i+1} \otimes \dots \otimes v_k - v_1 \otimes \dots \otimes v_{i+1} \otimes v_i \otimes \dots \otimes v_k = T - P_{(i,i+1)}(T), \tag{545}$$
   where $P_{(i,i+1)}$ is a transposition, so it is in $L_1$.

   Therefore, $L_1 = L_2 = L$.
2. $\mathrm{Sym}_1^k(V) = \mathrm{Im}(\mathrm{Sym})$. We first see that for every $\tau \in S_k$,
   $$P_\tau(\mathrm{Sym}(T)) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} P_{\tau\sigma}(T) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} P_\sigma(T) = \mathrm{Sym}(T). \tag{546}$$
   Conversely, if $T$ is symmetric, then
   $$\mathrm{Sym}(T) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} T = T. \tag{547}$$
   Therefore, we can see that $T \in \mathrm{Im}(\mathrm{Sym}) \iff T$ is symmetric $\iff P_\sigma(T) = T$ for all $\sigma \in S_k \iff T \in \mathrm{Sym}_1^k(V)$.
3. $\ker(\mathrm{Sym}) = L$. We prove bidirectionally.
   (a) $L \subseteq \ker(\mathrm{Sym})$. $L$ is spanned by terms of the form $T - P_\sigma(T)$. But
   $$\mathrm{Sym}(T - P_\sigma(T)) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\gamma \in S_k} \big(P_\gamma(T) - P_{\gamma\sigma}(T)\big) = 0 \implies T - P_\sigma(T) \in \ker(\mathrm{Sym}), \tag{548}$$
   since $\gamma \mapsto \gamma\sigma$ permutes $S_k$.

(b) $\ker(\text{Sym}) \subseteq L$. Let $T \in \ker(\text{Sym})$. Then,

$$T = T - \text{Sym}(T) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \big(T - P_\sigma(T)\big). \tag{549}$$

Each summand belongs to $L$, so $T \in L$.

Therefore, by the first isomorphism theorem of vector spaces, we can see that

$$\text{Sym}_1^k(V) \simeq \frac{V^{\otimes k}}{\ker(\text{Sym})} = \frac{V^{\otimes k}}{L} = \text{Sym}_2^k(V). \tag{550}$$

Since this is a quotient space, the relation enforced by the quotient is a congruence relation. Symmetry immediately follows by our quotient definition. For the dimension, let $\{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ be a basis of $V$. Then,

$$\left\{ e_1^{\odot a_1} \odot e_2^{\odot a_2} \odot \dots \odot e_n^{\odot a_n} : a_i \geq 0, \ \sum_{i=1}^n a_i = k \right\} \tag{551}$$

is a basis of $\text{Sym}^k(V)$. Indeed, these vectors span $\text{Sym}^k(V)$ since elementary tensors span $V^{\otimes k}$, and they are linearly independent since distinct choices of $(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ correspond to disjoint sets of elementary basis tensors under symmetrization. By nonnegative stars and bars, we get the dimension

$$\dim(\text{Sym}^k(V)) = \binom{n+k-1}{k}. \tag{552}$$

We can clarify this proof by explicitly going through a construction of $\text{Sym}^2(V)$.

**Example 5.13 (Construction of $\text{Sym}^2(V)$)**

Let $L$ be the subspace of $V \otimes V$ generated by all tensors of the form

$$u \otimes v - v \otimes u, \qquad u, v \in V \tag{553}$$

For example, given $a, b \in V$ with basis $\{e_1, e_2\}$,

$$\begin{aligned} a \otimes b - b \otimes a &= (a_1 e_1 + a_2 e_2) \otimes (b_1 e_1 + b_2 e_2) - (b_1 e_1 + b_2 e_2) \otimes (a_1 e_1 + a_2 e_2) \\ &= (a_1 b_2 - b_2 a_1) e_1 \otimes e_2 + (a_2 b_1 - b_2 a_1) e_2 \otimes e_1 \end{aligned}$$

is an element of $I$. We can generalize this to see that

$$\{e_i \otimes e_j - e_j \otimes e_i\}, \ i \neq j \tag{554}$$

is the basis for $I$. Now, let us define $\text{Sym}^2 V \coloneqq \frac{V \otimes V}{L}$ where, given that $\dim V = n$,

$$\dim(\text{Sym}^2 V) = n^2 - \frac{1}{2} n(n-1) = \frac{1}{2} n(n+1) \tag{555}$$

We denote the elements of $\text{Sym}^2 V$ as $x \odot y$, which are really the equivalence classes $[x \otimes y - y \otimes x]$. Note that

$$\begin{aligned} x \odot y - y \odot x &= [x \otimes y - y \otimes x] - [y \otimes x - x \otimes y] && (556) \\ &= [x \otimes y - y \otimes x - y \otimes x + x \otimes y] && (557) \\ &= [0] = 0 && (558) \end{aligned}$$

$\implies x \odot y = y \odot x$. That is, the $\odot$ operator is symmetric, and $\text{Sym}^2 V$ has basis

$$\{e_i \odot e_j\}_{j \geq k}, \quad 1 \leq i \neq j \leq n \tag{559}$$

which implies that it is invariant under any permutation $p \in S_n$ of the $x_i$'s.

**Definition 5.16 (Alternating Power)**

The **kth alternating power of** $V$ of dimension $n$ is the subspace defined in the equivalent ways.

1. *Direct Construction.*

$$\mathrm{Sym}^k(V) = \{T \in V^{\otimes k} \colon P_\sigma(T) = \mathrm{sgn}(\sigma)T \text{ for all } \sigma \in S_k\} \tag{560}$$

2. *Quotient Space.*

$$\mathrm{Alt}^k(V) = \frac{V^{\otimes k}}{L_{\mathrm{sym}}}, \quad L = \mathrm{span}\{T - \mathrm{sgn}(\sigma)P_\sigma(T) \colon T \in V^{\otimes k}, \sigma \in S_k\} \tag{561}$$

$$= \mathrm{span}\{v_1 \dots v_i \otimes v_{i+1} \dots v_k + v_1 \dots v_{i+1} \otimes v_i \dots v_k\} \tag{562}$$

We define the **wedge product** of elementary tensors as the quotient of the tensor products.

$$v_1 \wedge \ldots \wedge v_n \coloneqq [v_1 \otimes \ldots \otimes v_n] \tag{563}$$

which satisfies:

1. *Antisymmetric.* $v_1 \dots v_i \wedge v_{i+1} \dots v_k = -v_1 \dots v_{i+1} \wedge v_i \dots v_k$. aka, if $v_i = v_j$ for some $i \neq j$, then $v_1 \dots v_i \wedge v_{i+1} \dots v_k = 0$.
2. *Dimension.* $\dim(\mathrm{Sym}^k(V)) = \binom{n}{k}$.

*Proof.* Let $\mathrm{Alt}_1^k(V)$ be the space defined in (1) and $\mathrm{Alt}_2^k(V)$ be the one defined in (2). Assume that the underlying field has characteristic 0. Let $\mathrm{Alt} : V^{\otimes k} \to V^{\otimes k}$ be the antisymmetrization operator on a tensor, defined by

$$\mathrm{Alt}(T) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \mathrm{sgn}(\sigma) P_\sigma(T). \tag{564}$$

We show some facts.

1. $L_1 = L_2$. Let us define $L_1$ and $L_2$ as the first and second spans.
   (a) $L_1 \subseteq L_2$. Given any $T$, we can write it as a linear combination of elementary tensors, so let us work with an elementary tensor $T$ directly. Since every permutation can be decomposed into adjacent transpositions, every vector of the form $T - \mathrm{sgn}(\sigma)P_\sigma(T)$ can be written as

$$\underbrace{T + P_{\tau_1}(T)}_{\in L_2} - \underbrace{\big(P_{\tau_1}(T) + P_{\tau_2}(P_{\tau_1}(T))\big)}_{\in L_2} + \dots + (-1)^{m-1} \underbrace{\big(P_{\tau_{m-1}\cdots\tau_1}(T) + P_{\tau_m\cdots\tau_1}(T)\big)}_{\in L_2}, \tag{565}$$

   where $\sigma = \tau_m \cdots \tau_1$ and each $\tau_i$ is an adjacent transposition. This is a linear combination of elements in $L_2$.
   (b) $L_2 \subseteq L_1$. Every generator of $L_2$ is of the form

$$v_1 \otimes \ldots \otimes v_i \otimes v_{i+1} \otimes \ldots \otimes v_k + v_1 \otimes \ldots \otimes v_{i+1} \otimes v_i \otimes \ldots \otimes v_k = T + P_{(i,i+1)}(T), \tag{566}$$

   where $P_{(i,i+1)}$ is a transposition, so $\mathrm{sgn}((i, i+1)) = -1$ and it is in $L_1$.
   Therefore, $L_1 = L_2 = L$.
2. $\mathrm{Alt}_1^k(V) = \mathrm{Im}(\mathrm{Alt})$. We first see that for every $\tau \in S_k$,

$$P_\tau(\mathrm{Alt}(T)) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \mathrm{sgn}(\sigma) P_{\tau\sigma}(T) \tag{567}$$

$$= \frac{\mathrm{sgn}(\tau)}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \mathrm{sgn}(\tau\sigma) P_{\tau\sigma}(T) \tag{568}$$

$$= \mathrm{sgn}(\tau)\, \mathrm{Alt}(T). \tag{569}$$

Conversely, if $T$ is alternating, then

$$\text{Alt}(T) = \frac{1}{k!}\sum_{\sigma\in S_k} \text{sgn}(\sigma)^2 T = T. \tag{570}$$

Therefore, we can see that $T \in \text{Im}(\text{Alt}) \iff T$ is alternating $\iff P_\sigma(T) = \text{sgn}(\sigma)T$ for all $\sigma \in S_k \iff T \in \text{Alt}_1^k(V)$.

3. $\ker(\text{Alt}) = L$. We prove bidirectionally.
   (a) $L \subseteq \ker(\text{Alt})$. $L$ is spanned by terms of the form $T - \text{sgn}(\sigma)P_\sigma(T)$. But

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{Alt}(T - \text{sgn}(\sigma)P_\sigma(T)) && (571)\\ &= \frac{1}{k!}\sum_{\gamma\in S_k} \big(\text{sgn}(\gamma)P_\gamma(T) - \text{sgn}(\gamma)\,\text{sgn}(\sigma)P_{\gamma\sigma}(T)\big) && (572)\\ &= 0, && (573)\end{aligned}$$

   since $\gamma \mapsto \gamma\sigma$ permutes $S_k$ and $\text{sgn}(\gamma)\,\text{sgn}(\sigma) = \text{sgn}(\gamma\sigma)$. Therefore, $T - \text{sgn}(\sigma)P_\sigma(T) \in \ker(\text{Alt})$.
   (b) $\ker(\text{Alt}) \subseteq L$. Let $T \in \ker(\text{Alt})$. Then,

$$T = T - \text{Alt}(T) = \frac{1}{k!}\sum_{\sigma\in S_k} \big(T - \text{sgn}(\sigma)P_\sigma(T)\big). \tag{574}$$

   Each summand belongs to $L$, so $T \in L$.

Therefore, by the first isomorphism theorem of vector spaces, we can see that

$$\text{Alt}_1^k(V) \simeq \frac{V^{\otimes k}}{\ker(\text{Alt})} = \frac{V^{\otimes k}}{L} = \text{Alt}_2^k(V). \tag{575}$$

Since this is a quotient space, the relation enforced by the quotient is a congruence relation. Antisymmetry immediately follows by our quotient definition. In particular, if $v_i = v_j$ for some $i \neq j$, then

$$v_1 \wedge \ldots \wedge v_k = -v_1 \wedge \ldots \wedge v_k = 0. \tag{576}$$

For the dimension, let $\{e_1, \ldots, e_n\}$ be a basis of $V$. Then,

$$\big\{e_{i_1} \wedge \ldots \wedge e_{i_k} : 1 \leq i_1 < \ldots < i_k \leq n\big\} \tag{577}$$

is a basis of $\text{Alt}^k(V)$. Indeed, these vectors span $\text{Alt}^k(V)$ since elementary tensors span $V^{\otimes k}$, and they are linearly independent since distinct choices of $(i_1, \ldots, i_k)$ correspond to disjoint sets of elementary basis tensors under antisymmetrization. By choosing $k$ distinct indices from $n$, we get the dimension

$$\dim(\text{Alt}^k(V)) = \binom{n}{k}. \tag{578}$$

**Example 5.14 (Inner Product)**

The inner product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ on $V$ is an element of $\text{Sym}^2 V$, since it is a bilinear, symmetric operation on $V$.

**Example 5.15 ($\mathrm{Sym}^2(V)$ is Symmetric Matrices)**

One realization of $\mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathbb{R}^n$ is the set of all symmetric $n \times n$ real matrices.

**Example 5.16 ($\mathrm{Alt}^2(V)$ is Antisymmetric Matrices)**

Let $I$ be a subspace of $V \otimes V$ generated by elements of the form $x \otimes x \in V \otimes V$. That is, given a basis $\{e_i\}$ of $n$-dimensional space $V$, all tensors of the form $x \otimes x \in V \otimes V$ can be written

$$x \otimes x = \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i (e_i \otimes e_i) + \sum_{i \neq j} b_{ij} (e_i \otimes e_j + e_j \otimes e_i) \tag{579}$$

which implies that the components of $e_i \otimes e_j$ and $e_j \otimes e_i$ must be the same for every element in $I$. Since we can group the components $e_i \otimes e_j$ and $e_j \otimes e_i$ together to $e_i \otimes e_j + e_j \otimes e_i$, the basis of $I$ is

$$\{e_1 \otimes e_1, \cdots, e_n \otimes e_n, e_1 \otimes e_2 + e_2 \otimes e_1, \cdots, e_{n-1} \otimes e_n + e_n \otimes e_{n-1}\} \tag{580}$$

One realization of the space $\Lambda^2 \mathbb{R}^n$ is the set of antisymmetric $n \times n$ matrices.

**Example 5.17 (Third Exterior Power)**

For $n = 3$ (and assuming that $\dim V \geq 3$), the subspace $I \subset V \otimes V \otimes V$ is the space generated by elements of the forms $\{x \otimes x \otimes y, x \otimes y \otimes x, y \otimes x \otimes x\}$. Following a similar construction, the **third exterior power of** $V$ is

$$\Lambda^3 V \coloneqq \frac{V \otimes V \otimes V}{I} \tag{581}$$

with its elements being equivalence classes of the form

$$x \wedge y \wedge z, \ x, y, z \in V \tag{582}$$

such that

$$\begin{aligned} x \wedge y \wedge z &= -x \wedge z \wedge y \\ &= -y \wedge x \wedge z \\ &= -z \wedge y \wedge x \end{aligned}$$

The basis of $\Lambda^3 V$ is

$$\{e_i \wedge e_j \wedge e_k \mid i < j < k\} \implies \dim \Lambda^3 V = \frac{1}{6} n(n-1)(n-2) \tag{583}$$

**Example 5.18 (Cross Product)**

Given 3 dimensional vector space $V$ with basis $\{e_1, e_2, e_3\}$, the wedge product of two vectors $a, b \in V$ is

$$a \wedge b = (a_1 e_1 + a_2 e_2 + a_3 e_3) \wedge (b_1 e_1 + b_2 e_2 + b_3 e_3) \tag{584}$$

$$= (a_2 b_3 - a_3 b_2) e_2 \wedge e_3 + (a_3 b_1 - a_1 b_3) e_3 \wedge e_1 + (a_1 b_2 - a_2 b_1) e_1 \wedge e_2 \tag{585}$$

which is essentially the formula for the cross product $\times$ in Euclidean space. We can therefore think of

the realization of the wedge product in 3 dimensional space $V$ as the cross product.

$$\wedge : V \times V \longrightarrow \Lambda^2 V \tag{586}$$

Note that $\Lambda^2 V \simeq V$ if $\dim V = 3$, so we can construct the more familiar $\times$ operation in $\mathbb{R}^3$.

$$\times : \mathbb{R}^3 \times \mathbb{R}^3 \longrightarrow \Lambda^2 \mathbb{R}^3 \simeq \mathbb{R}^3 \tag{587}$$

which is consistent with $\times$ taking two vectors and outputting a third vector living in $\mathbb{R}^3$ that is orthogonal to the two input vectors.

**Example 5.19 (Triple Scalar Product)**

The realization of the wedge product of 3 vectors in 3 dimensional space $V$ is the *triple scalar product*, which we will denote as $\times_3$

$$\wedge : V \times V \times V \longrightarrow \Lambda^3 V \tag{588}$$

Note that since $\Lambda^3 V \simeq V$ when $\dim V = 3$, we can write

$$\times_3 : \mathbb{R}^3 \times \mathbb{R}^3 \times \mathbb{R}^3 \longrightarrow \Lambda^3 \mathbb{R}^3 \simeq \mathbb{R} \tag{589}$$

which is consistent with $\times_3$ taking three vectors and outputting the signed volume of their parallelopiped which lies in $\mathbb{R}$.

**Definition 5.17 (Determinant)**

The **determinant** of a linear map $A : V \to V$ is the singular basis vector[a] of the 1-dimensional space $\Lambda^n(V)$.

$$e_1 \wedge e_2 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_{n-1} \wedge e_n \tag{590}$$

[a] Note that any tensor in $\Lambda^n V$ satisfies multilinearity and antisymmetricity, but only the basis vector $e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_n$ satisfies the normalizing condition $\det I = 1$. Since, given that the dual basis of $V^*$ is $\{f_j\}$, $(e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_n)(f_1, f_2, \cdots, f_n) = \prod_{i=1}^n e_i(f_i) = \prod_{i=1}^n \delta_i^i = 1$.

Note that this construction of the determinant is consistent with our previous construction of the determinant of a matrix since $e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_n$ is indeed multilinear and antisymmetric. In its purest sense,

$$e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_n : \prod_{i=1}^n V^* \longrightarrow \mathbb{F} \tag{591}$$

is a mapping that is multilinear and antisymmetric. But there is an inconsistency. The matrix determinant takes in *matrices* rather than taking in $n$-tuples of covectors. However, we can interpret the $n$ covectors in $V^* \times \cdots \times V^*$ as the column (or row) vectors of an $n \times n$ matrix. This completes the realization, and so we can conclude that the matrix determinant is just a realization of the more abstract determinant $e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_n$.

There is a simple relationship between $V \otimes V$, $\Lambda^2 V$, and $\text{Sym}^2 V$.

**Theorem 5.16 (Symmetric-Antisymmetric Decomposition)**

We can always factor a rank (2,0) tensor into its symmetric and antisymmetric parts. In fact,

$$V \otimes V \simeq \text{Sym}^2 V \oplus \Lambda^2 V \tag{592}$$

with isomorphism defined

$$v \otimes w \mapsto \Big(\frac{1}{2}(v \odot w), \frac{1}{2}(v \wedge w)\Big) \tag{593}$$

*Proof.* Given $v \otimes w \in V \otimes V$,

$$v \otimes w + w \otimes v \in \text{Sym}^2 V \text{ and } v \otimes w - w \otimes v \in \Lambda^2 V \tag{594}$$

By defining $v \odot w$ and $v \wedge w$ as the expressions above, the isomorphism is satisfied.

Therefore, when working in $V \otimes V$, we can interpret

$$v \wedge w = \frac{1}{2}(v \otimes w - w \otimes v) \tag{595}$$

$$v \odot w = \frac{1}{2}(v \otimes w + w \otimes v) \tag{596}$$

However, $V \otimes V \otimes V \not\cong \text{Sym}^3 V \oplus \Lambda^3 V$. *Schur functors* are used to fix this discrepancy.

## 5.5 Tensor Algebras

We would like to "add" differently ranked tensors together. In order to do so, we can just construct a bigger vector space as the direct sum of all of the higher order tensor product spaces.

**Definition 5.18 (Tensor Algebra)**

The **tensor algebra** of vector space $V$ over field $\mathbb{F}$ is an associative, noncommutative algebra defined

$$T(V) \coloneqq \bigoplus_{n=0}^{\infty} V^{\otimes n} = V^{\otimes 0} \oplus V^{\otimes 1} \oplus V^{\otimes 2} \oplus V^{\otimes 3} \oplus \cdots \tag{597}$$

$$= \mathbb{F} \oplus V \oplus V^{\otimes 2} \oplus V^{\otimes 3} \oplus V^{\otimes 4} \oplus \cdots \tag{598}$$

with elements being infinite-tuples

$$(a, B^{\mu}, C^{\nu\gamma}, D^{\alpha\beta\epsilon}, \cdots) \tag{599}$$

The addition operation is defined component-wise, and the multiplication operation is the tensor product

$$\otimes : T(V) \times T(V) \longrightarrow T(V) \tag{600}$$

and the identity element is

$$I = (1, 0, 0, \cdots) \tag{601}$$

*Proof.* Linearity is easily proved. In order to do this rigorously, we must define the map (which is also an isomorphism)

$$i_j : V^{\otimes j} \longrightarrow T(V),\ i_j(T^{\kappa_1, \cdots, \kappa j}) = (0, \cdots, 0, T^{\kappa_1, \cdots, \kappa j}, 0, \cdots, 0) \tag{602}$$

So, we can implicitly define the addition of arbitrary tensors $A \in V^{\otimes n}$ and $B \in V^{\otimes m}$ as

$$A + B \coloneqq i_n(A) + i_m(B) \in T(V) \tag{603}$$

along with the tensor multiplication of the form

$$A \otimes B \coloneqq i_n(A) \otimes i_m(B) \coloneqq i_{n+m}(A \otimes B) \tag{604}$$

This allows us to alternatively define the tensor product operation as

$$i_i(V^{\otimes i}) \otimes i_j(V^{\otimes j}) \coloneqq i_{i+j}(V^{\otimes (i+j)}) \tag{605}$$

**Definition 5.19 (Symmetric Algebra)**

The **symmetric algebra** of vector space $V$ of dimension $n$ is defined

$$\mathrm{Sym}(V) \coloneqq \bigoplus_{k=0}^{\infty} \mathrm{Sym}^k V \tag{606}$$

where $\mathrm{Sym}^0(V) = \mathbb{F}$. It is infinite-dimensional.

**Definition 5.20 (Exterior Algebra)**

The **symmetric algebra** of vector space $V$ of dimension $n$ is defined

$$\mathrm{Alt}(V) \coloneqq \bigoplus_{k=0}^{n} \mathrm{Alt}^k V \coloneqq \mathrm{Alt}^0 V \oplus \mathrm{Alt}^1 V \oplus \mathrm{Alt}^2 V \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathrm{Alt}^n V \tag{607}$$

where $\mathrm{Alt}^0(V) = \mathbb{F}$. It has dimension $2^n$.

# 6 Spectral Theory

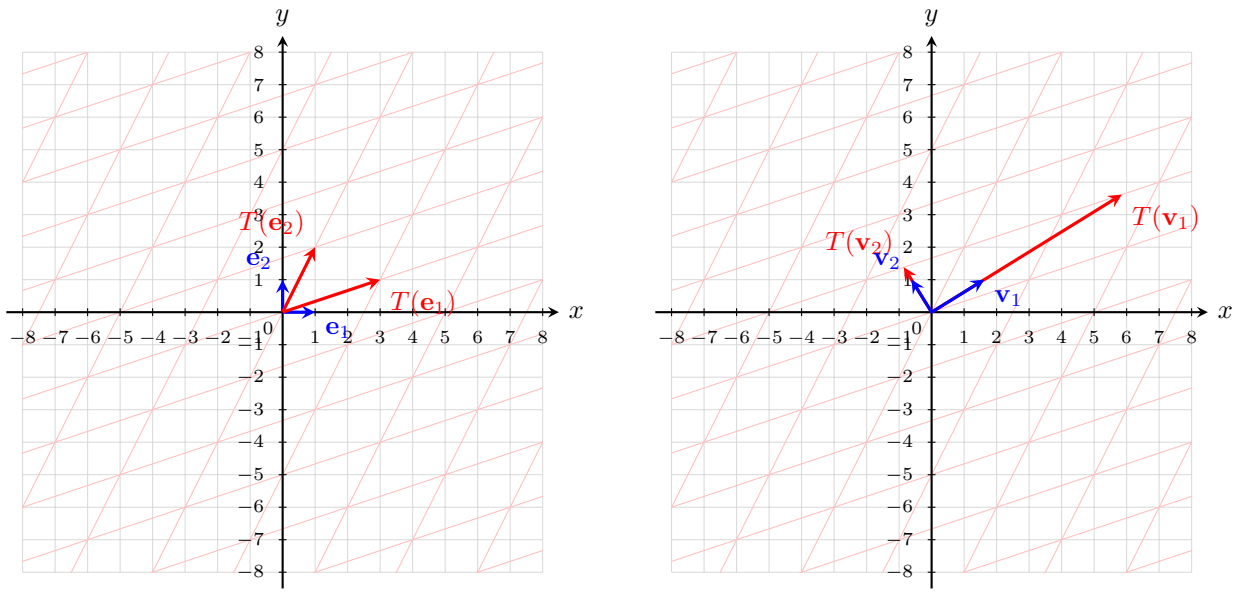
**Definition 6.1 (Eigenvalue)**

Let $A : V \longrightarrow V$ be a linear transformation over $\mathbb{F}$. If there exists a vector $v \in V$ such that

$$Av = \lambda v, \qquad \lambda \in \mathbb{F} \tag{608}$$

then $\lambda$ is called an **eigenvalue** of $A$, and $v$ is an **eigenvector** of $A$.

For a given eigenvalue $\lambda$ and its corresponding eigenvector $v$, it is clear that by linearity, every vector in $\operatorname{span} v$ is an eigenvector, too.




(a) $A$ acting on standard basis vectors $e_1, e_2$.

(b) $A$ acting on basis of eigenvectors $v_1, v_2$.

Figure 14: Given a linear transformation $A : V \longrightarrow V$, we can visualize a certain basis of $V$ such that all the linear transformation $A$ does on that basis is merely extend or contract the basis vectors.

**Definition 6.2 (Characteristic Polynomial)**

Let $V$ be a vector space. The **characteristic polynomial** of linear map $A : V \to V$—denoted $p_A(t)$—is defined

$$p_A(t) \coloneqq \det(A - tI) \tag{609}$$

From here, we will assume that our field is over $\mathbb{C}$. We use the fact that the field is over $\mathbb{C}$ because it allows us to claim that the characteristic polynomial in $\mathbb{C}[t]$ can be factored into linear components, by the fundamental theorem of algebra.

**Lemma 6.1 (Invariance of Characteristic Polynomial)**

If two matrices $A, B \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ are similar, then they have the same characteristic polynomial.

*Proof.* If $A \sim B$, then $B = SAS^{-1}$, and so

$$\begin{aligned} p_B(t) &= \det(B - tI) && (610)\\ &= \det(SAS^{-1} - tSS^{-1}) && (611)\\ &= \det(S(A - tI)S^{-1}) && (612)\\ &= \det(S)\det(A - tI)\det(S^{-1}) && (613)\\ &= \det(A - tI) = p_A(t) && (614) \end{aligned}$$

The motivation for defining such a polynomial is that it allows us to compute the eigenvalues of $A$.

**Theorem 6.2 (Roots of Characteristic Polynomial is the Specturm)**

The solutions of the characteristic equation of $A$ (i.e. the roots of $p_A(t)$) is precisely the spectrum of $A$.

*Proof.* Bidirectional.

1. ($\rightarrow$) Let there be a $t = \lambda$ such that $p_A(\lambda) = 0 \iff \det(A - \lambda I) = 0$ which is equivalent to saying that $\ker(A - \lambda I)$ is nontrivial. There must exist a $v \in \ker(A - \lambda I)$, meaning that $(A - \lambda I)v = 0 \iff Av = \lambda v$. By definition, $\lambda$ is an eigenvalue of $A$.
2. ($\leftarrow$) This reasoning can be extended in the opposite direction.

Therefore, to find the eigenvalues and eigenvectors, we do the following. First, we solve all zeros of the characteristic polynomial $p_A(t)$. Then, for each zero $\lambda$, we find the corresponding vectors than span $\ker(A - \lambda I)$.

**Example 6.1 (Distinct Eigenvalues)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \tag{615}$$

Then

$$\det(A - \lambda I) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 3 - \lambda & 1 \\ 1 & 2 - \lambda \end{pmatrix} = (3 - \lambda)(2 - \lambda) - 1 = \lambda^2 - 5\lambda + 5 \tag{616}$$

So, using the quadratic formula, the eigenvalues of $A$ are

$$\lambda = \frac{5 \pm \sqrt{5}}{2} \tag{617}$$

**Example 6.2 (Same Eigenvalues)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 5 \end{pmatrix} \tag{618}$$

Then,

$$\det(A - \lambda I) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 2 - \lambda & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 - \lambda & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 5 - \lambda \end{pmatrix} = (\lambda - 2)^2(\lambda - 5) \tag{619}$$

Now,

1. For $\lambda = 2$, we see that
$$A - 2I = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \tag{620}$$
So, solving for
$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \implies \ker(A - 2I) = \text{span}\left\{ v_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, v_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{621}$$
and our two eigenvectors are $v_1, v_2$.
2. For $\lambda = 5$, we see that
$$A - 5I = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{622}$$
So, solving for
$$\begin{pmatrix} -3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \implies \ker(A - 5I) = \text{span}\left\{ w_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{623}$$
and our eigenvector is $w_1$.

## 6.1 Eigendecomposition

So intuitively, we can see that eigenvalues "split" our vector space $V$ into collections of different eigenvectors.

**Lemma 6.3 (Eigenvectors are Linearly Independent)**

Eigenvectors of a linear transformation $A$ corresponding to different eigenvalues are linearly independent.

*Proof.* Simple.

From the two examples above, we might hypothesize that if the characteristic polynomial has factor $(t-\lambda)^k$— i.e. $\lambda$ has *multiplicity* $k$— then there might be $k$ eigenvectors associated with eigenvalue $\lambda$. However, this is not the case.

**Example 6.3 (Multiplicity 2 Eigenvalue but 1 Eigenvector)**

Let
$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{624}$$
Then, we see that $p_A(t) = (t-1)^2$, and so $\lambda = 1$ is the only eigenvalue. But checking the nullspace of $A$ gives
$$(A - I)v = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \implies \ker(A - I) = \text{span}\left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{625}$$

It turns out that our hypothesis is false. So where is the other "eigenvector" hiding? Well our eigenvector $v$ of eigenvalue $\lambda$ is killed off by applying
$$(A - \lambda I)v = 0 \tag{626}$$

We might consider a weaker notion of an eigenvector by looking for vectors $w$ that are eventually killed by applying

$$(A-\lambda I)^k w = 0 \tag{627}$$

This type of vector is called a *generalized eigenvector*. For example, if $(A-\lambda I)w \neq 0$, the next best thing is that $v = (A-\lambda I)w$ is an eigenvector of $\lambda$ itself, so applying $(A-\lambda I)$ again will make it vanish. So,

$$(A-\lambda I)w = v \implies Aw = v + \lambda w \tag{628}$$

So the action of $A$ on this generalized eigenvector $w$ is that it scales it by $\lambda$, but then it *adds* the actual eigenvector $v$ to it. Let's distinguish these two types of eigenvectors.

**Definition 6.3 (Generalized, Genuine Eigenvector)**

Let $A : V \to V$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$ be an eigenvalue of $A$.

1. A **genuine eigenvector** of $A$ is a vector $v \in V$ that satisfies $(A-\lambda I)v = 0$.[a]
2. A **rank-$k$ generalized eigenvector** $v$ satisfies $(A-\lambda I)^k v = 0$ and $(A-\lambda I)^{k-1} v \neq 0$.

[a] This is just the definition of an eigenvector.

It is nice to know how these generalized eigenvectors are structured.

**Lemma 6.4 (Generalized Eigenvector Chain)**

Let $A : V \to V$, $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$ be an eigenvalue of $A$.

1. If $w^{(k)}$ be a rank $k$-eigenvector, then $w^{(k-1)} = (A-\lambda I)w^{(k)}$ is a rank-$(k-1)$ eigenvector. Therefore, it forms a chain:
$$w^{(k)} \xrightarrow{A-\lambda I} w^{(k-1)} \xrightarrow{A-\lambda I} \dots \xrightarrow{A-\lambda I} w^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A-\lambda I} 0 \tag{629}$$
2. The action of $A$ on $w^{(k)}$ is to scale it and add the corresponding lower rank eigenvalue to it.
$$Aw^{(k)} = \lambda w^{(k)} + (A-\lambda I)w^{(k)} = \lambda w^{(k)} + w^{(k-1)} \tag{630}$$

*Proof.* If $w^{(k)}$ is a rank-$k$ eigenvector, then $(A-\lambda I)^k w^{(k)} = 0$, which implies that $w^{(k-1)} = (A-\lambda I)w^{(k)}$ is a rank-$(k-1)$ eigenvector, and $A$ acts on $w$ as

$$Aw^{(k)} = (A-\lambda I)w^{(k)} + \lambda w^{(k)} = w^{(k-1)} + \lambda w^{(k)} \tag{631}$$

Therefore, we can group all of these vectors together into distinct subspaces.

**Definition 6.4 (Eigenspace, Generalized Eigenspace, Jordan Space)**

Let $V$ be a finite-dimensional vector space and $\lambda$ be an eigenvalue of linear map $A : V \to V$.

1. The **eigenspace** of $\lambda$ is the subspace formed by the span of all eigenvectors of $\lambda$.
$$E(\lambda) \coloneqq \ker(A-\lambda I) \tag{632}$$
2. The **generalized eigenspace** of $\lambda$ is the subspace formed by the span of all generalized eigenvectors of $\lambda$.
$$G(\lambda) \coloneqq \bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} \ker(A-\lambda I)^k \tag{633}$$
This is indeed a subspace since the kernels form an increasing chain
$$E(\lambda) = \ker(A-\lambda I) \subseteq \ker(A-\lambda I)^2 \subseteq \ker(A-\lambda I)^3 \subseteq \dots \tag{634}$$
Since $V$ is fininte-dimensional, the chain eventually stabilizes.

3. The **Jordan space** of a genuine eigenvector $w_i^{(1)}$ corresponding to eigenvalue $\lambda$ is the span of all generalized eigenvectors in the Jordan chain.

$$J_i(\lambda) = J(w_i^{(1)}) = \text{span}\{w_i^{(1)}, w_i^{(2)}, \dots\} \tag{635}$$

**Definition 6.5 (Eigenbasis)**

The set of all genuine and generalized eigenvectors of a linear map $A : V \to V$ is called the **eigenbasis** of $A$.

This sounds a bit confusing, let's introduce some terminology to characterize the eigenspaces, and then we can organize the relationship in all of these spaces in the next theorem.

**Definition 6.6 (Algebraic Multiplicity)**

The **algebraic multiplicity** of an eigenvalue $\lambda$ is defined in the equivalent ways:

1. It is the dimension of its generalized eigenspace.

$$d = \dim G(\lambda) \tag{636}$$

2. It is the maximal value of $d$ such that $(t - \lambda)^d$ divides $p_A(t)$.

*Proof.* This is harder than it looks given the tools we have right now.

**Definition 6.7 (Geometric Multiplicity)**

The **geometric multiplicity** of eigenvalue $\lambda$ of a linear map $A$ is the dimension of the span of genuine eigenvectors in its eigenspace.

$$\dim \ker (A - \lambda I) \tag{637}$$

Note that since the span of genuine eigenvectors is a subspace of $E(\lambda)$, the geometric multiplicity is always less than or equal to the algebraic multiplicity.

**Theorem 6.5 (Eigendecomposition of Vector Space)**

Let $A : V \to V$ be a linear map. For each eigenvalue $\lambda$, let $w_1, \dots, w_m$ be all of its genuine eignevectors. For each genuine eigenvector $w_i = w_i^{(1)}$, there is a chain of generalized eigenvectors which forms the Jordan space $J(w_i)$.

$$E(\lambda) \subset G(\lambda) = \bigoplus_{i=1}^{m} J_i(w_i) \tag{638}$$

Furthermore, given that $A$ has eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_k$,

$$V = \bigoplus_{j=1}^{k} G(\lambda_j) = \bigoplus_{j=1}^{k} \bigoplus_{i=1}^{m_j} J_i(\lambda_j) \tag{639}$$

where $J_i(\lambda_j)$ is the Jordan space corresponding to the $i$th genuine eigenvector of the $j$th eigenvalue.

*Proof.* The definition of algebraic multiplicity implies that each eigenspace is disjoint except at 0 and that their dimensions sum to $\dim V$.

**Theorem 6.6 (Invariance of Eigenspaces Under Linear Map)**

Given a linear mapping $A : V \to V$ and eigenvalue $\lambda$,

1. $A$ maps each genuine eigenspace to itself.

$$A\big(E(\lambda)\big) \subset E(\lambda) \tag{640}$$

2. $A$ maps each Jordan space to itself.

$$A\big(J_i(\lambda)\big) \subset J_i(\lambda) \tag{641}$$

*Proof.* Listed.

1. Just pick any $\lambda$, and let $d$ be its algebraic multiplicity. Let $v \in E(\lambda)$. Then, we wish to show that $(A - \lambda I)^d Av = 0 \implies Av \in E(\lambda)$.

$$\begin{aligned}(A - \lambda I)^d Av &= (A - \lambda I)^d Av - (A - \lambda I)^d \lambda v + (A - \lambda I)^d \lambda v && (642)\\ &= (A - \lambda I)^{d+1} v + \lambda (A - \lambda I)^d v && (643)\\ &= (A - \lambda I)0 + \lambda 0 = 0 && (644)\end{aligned}$$

2.

**Corollary 6.7 (Eigendecomposition of Linear Maps)**

Let $A : V \to V$ be a linear map and $V = \bigoplus_{i,j} J_i(\lambda_j)$ be the eigendecomposition of $V$. Then, we can decompose $A$ as such, called the **eigendecomposition** of $A$.

$$A = \bigoplus_{i,j} A_{i,j}, \qquad A_{i,j} = A\big|_{J_i(\lambda_j)} : J_i(\lambda_j) \to J_i(\lambda_j) \tag{645}$$

where $A_{i,j} = A\big|_{J_i(\lambda_j)}$ is the restriction of $A$ onto the Jordan space $J_i(\lambda_j)$. Therefore, given $v = \sum_{i,j} v_{i,j} \in V$ where $v_{i,j} \in J_i(\lambda_j)$,

$$Av = A\bigg(\sum_{i,j} v_{i,j}\bigg) = \sum_{i,j} Av_{i,j} = \sum_{i,j} A_{i,j} v_{i,j} \tag{646}$$

*Proof.* Since every Jordan space is stable under $A$, we can decompose $A$ as the following.

Great, so we have now established the existence of a nicer form for a linear map.

## 6.2 Real and Complex Jordan Canonical Forms

Let's see how to find such a form in practice. The process of eigendecomposition for a linear mapping $A$ is really just a clever change of basis for the $n \times n$ matrix representation of $A$ over $\mathbb{C}$, where the new basis is now the set of genuine and generalized eigenvectors.

For now, let's just focus on 1 generalized eigenspace $G(\lambda)$. Recall that the action of $A$ on rank-$k$ generalized

eigenvector $w^{(k)}$ is something like

$$Aw^{(k)} = \lambda w^{(k)} + w^{(k-1)} \tag{647}$$

Therefore, if we choose $\{w^{(1)}, w^{(2)}, \dots, w^{(d)}\}$ as our basis of $G(\lambda)$, then our restriction map $A_\lambda : G(\lambda) \to G(\lambda)$ will simply transform each basis column vector as

$$A_\lambda \begin{pmatrix} | \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ | \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} | \\ 1 \\ \lambda \\ | \end{pmatrix} \tag{648}$$

Therefore, we would like to find a matrix that acts on the generalized eigenvectors like the following chain.

$$w^{(k)} \xrightarrow{A_\lambda} w^{(k-1)} + \lambda w^{(k)} \tag{649}$$

$$w^{(k-1)} \xrightarrow{A_\lambda} w^{(k-2)} + \lambda w^{(k-1)} \tag{650}$$

$$\dots \xrightarrow{A_\lambda} \dots \tag{651}$$

$$w^{(2)} \xrightarrow{A_\lambda} w^{(1)} + \lambda w^{(2)} \tag{652}$$

$$w^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A_\lambda} \lambda w^{(1)} \tag{653}$$

Remember that for one eigenvalue $\lambda$, there could be *multiple* genuine eigenvectors $w_1^{(1)}, \dots, w_k^{(1)}$, with each genuine eigenvector having its own chain $\{w_i^{(j)}\}_{j=1}^{k_i}$ of generalized eigenvectors. So, it motivates the following definition.

**Definition 6.8 (Complex Jordan Block for Complex Eigenvalue)**

A **complex Jordan block** associated with eigenvalue $\lambda$ is a matrix $J(\lambda) \in \mathbb{C}^{d \times d}$ of the form

$$J(\lambda) = \begin{pmatrix} \lambda & 1 & & & \\ & \lambda & 1 & & \\ & & \lambda & \ddots & \\ & & & \lambda & 1 \\ & & & & \lambda \end{pmatrix} \tag{654}$$

with $\lambda$'s in the main diagonal and 1's in the *superdiagonal*.

1. The columns containing a 0 in the superdiagonal corresponds to the image of the genuine eigenvectors: $w^{(1)} \mapsto \lambda w^{(1)}$.
2. The columns containing a 1 in the superdiagonal corresponds to the image of the generalized eigenvectors: $w^{(k)} \mapsto w^{(k-1)} + \lambda w^{(k)}$.

Let the eigenvalues of the matrix $A$ be $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \cdots, \lambda_k$, with its associated eigenspaces $E(\lambda_i)$. Let the algebraic multiplicity of eigenspace $E(\lambda_i)$ be $d_i$.

**Definition 6.9 (Jordan Canonical Form over $\mathbb{C}$)**

A matrix $J \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$ of the following form is called the **Jordan canonical form**.[a]

$$J = \begin{pmatrix} J_1(\lambda_1) & & & \\ & J_2(\lambda_2) & & \\ & & \ddots & \\ & & & J_k(\lambda_k) \end{pmatrix} \tag{655}$$

where each block $J_i \in \mathbb{R}^{d_i \times d_i}$ is a complex Jordan block representing the chain of generalized eigenvector

mappings. Note that some of the $\lambda_i$'s may be equal if we have multiple chains for the same eigenvalue.

[a] The JNF of a matrix is unique up to the permutations of its diagonal blocks.

**Algorithm 6.1 (Computing the Jordan Decomposition)**

We have everything we need to find the Jordan canonical form. The general idea is to:

1. Find all eigenvalues of $A$.
2. For each eigenvalue $\lambda$, find all of its genuine eigenvectors $w_1^{(1)}, w_2^{(1)}, \dots, w_m^{(1)}$.
3. Compute the dimension of the respective $\ker(A-\lambda I)^p$ (as in, increase $p = 1, 2, \dots$ until the dimension of the kernel equals $n$) to find the length of the chains of generalized eigenvectors for each $w_i^{(1)}$.
4. You should now be able to write the JNF $J$ as a matrix.
5. For each eigenvector $w_i^{(k)}$, solve the equation $(A-\lambda I)w_i^{(k+1)} = w_i^{(k)}$ to find the generalized eigenvector $w_i^{(k+1)}$. Keep doing this until you can't find any more generalized eigenvectors.
6. You should have a collection of all eigenvectors. Put them into a column matrix $P$. It is true that $J = P^{-1}AP$.

**Example 6.4 (JNF of a Nontrivial $3 \times 3$ Matrix)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \tag{656}$$

We will compute its Jordan canonical form. First, we compute the characteristic polynomial.

$$p_A(t) = \det(A - tI) = (t-2)^2(3-t) \tag{657}$$

Therefore, the eigenvalues are $\lambda = 2$ with algebraic multiplicity 2, and $\lambda = 3$ with algebraic multiplicity 1.

1. First, we study the eigenspace for $\lambda = 2$. We compute

$$E(2) = \ker(A - 2I) = \ker \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \text{span} \left\{ w^{(1)} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{658}$$

So $\lambda = 2$ has algebraic multiplicity 2, but geometric multiplicity 1. Therefore, we need one generalized eigenvector.
We want to find $w^{(2)}$ satisfying

$$(A-2I)w^{(2)} = w^{(1)} \iff \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{659}$$

Hence $-x + y = 1$ and $z = 0$. Taking $x = 0$, we may choose

$$w^{(2)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{660}$$

Thus we have the Jordan chain

$$w^{(2)} \xrightarrow{A-2I} w^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A-2I} 0 \tag{661}$$

2. Now we study the eigenspace for $\lambda = 3$. We compute

$$E(3) = \ker(A - 3I) = \ker \begin{pmatrix} -2 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \text{span} \left\{ u^{(1)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{662}$$

So $\lambda = 3$ has algebraic multiplicity 1 and geometric multiplicity 1. Therefore, this gives a Jordan chain of length 1:

$$u^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A-3I} 0 \tag{663}$$

Therefore, a Jordan basis is

$$\mathcal{B} = \left\{ w^{(1)}, w^{(2)}, u^{(1)} \right\} = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \implies P = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{664}$$

With respect to this basis,

$$Aw^{(1)} = 2w^{(1)} \tag{665}$$

$$Aw^{(2)} = w^{(1)} + 2w^{(2)} \tag{666}$$

$$Au^{(1)} = 3u^{(1)} \tag{667}$$

Therefore, the Jordan canonical form is

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix}}_{J} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}}_{P} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix}}_{A} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}^{-1}}_{P^{-1}} \tag{668}$$

**Example 6.5 (JNF with Two Nontrivial Jordan Chains)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 5 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & 3 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 5 \end{pmatrix} \tag{669}$$

We will compute its Jordan canonical form. First, we compute the characteristic polynomial.

$$p_A(t) = \det(A - tI) = (4 - t)^5 \tag{670}$$

Therefore, $\lambda = 4$ is the only eigenvalue, and it has algebraic multiplicity 5.
First, we compute the genuine eigenspace:

$$E(4) = \ker(A - 4I) = \ker \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \text{span} \left\{ w_1^{(1)} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad w_2^{(1)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{671}$$

So $\lambda = 4$ has geometric multiplicity 2. Therefore, there will be two Jordan chains. To determine the sizes of the chains, we compute

$$\dim \ker N = 2, \qquad \dim \ker N^2 = 4, \qquad \dim \ker N^3 = 5 \tag{672}$$

Since the algebraic multiplicity is 5, and the largest chain has length 3, the Jordan block sizes must be 3 and 2. Therefore, the Jordan canonical form must be

$$J = \begin{pmatrix} 4 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 4 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \tag{673}$$

1. First, we build the chain starting from $w_1^{(1)}$. We want to find $w_1^{(2)}$ satisfying

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}}_{A-4I} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \\ x_4 \\ x_5 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_1^{(2)}} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_1^{(1)}} \implies w_1^{(2)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{674}$$

   Next, we want to find $w_1^{(3)}$ satisfying

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}}_{A-4I} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \\ x_4 \\ x_5 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_1^{(3)}} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_1^{(2)}} \implies w_1^{(3)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{675}$$

   Thus we have the Jordan chain

$$w_1^{(3)} \xrightarrow{A-4I} w_1^{(2)} \xrightarrow{A-4I} w_1^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A-4I} 0 \tag{676}$$

2. Now we build the chain starting from $w_2^{(1)}$. We want to find $w_2^{(2)}$ satisfying

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}}_{A-4I} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \\ x_4 \\ x_5 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_2^{(2)}} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_2^{(1)}} \implies w_2^{(2)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{677}$$

   Thus we have the Jordan chain

$$w_2^{(2)} \xrightarrow{A-4I} w_2^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A-4I} 0 \tag{678}$$

Therefore, a Jordan basis is

$$\mathcal{B} = \left\{ w_1^{(1)}, w_1^{(2)}, w_1^{(3)}, w_2^{(1)}, w_2^{(2)} \right\} \implies P = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{679}$$

With respect to this basis,

$$Aw_1^{(1)} = 4w_1^{(1)} \tag{680}$$
$$Aw_1^{(2)} = w_1^{(1)} + 4w_1^{(2)} \tag{681}$$
$$Aw_1^{(3)} = w_1^{(2)} + 4w_1^{(3)} \tag{682}$$
$$Aw_2^{(1)} = 4w_2^{(1)} \tag{683}$$
$$Aw_2^{(2)} = w_2^{(1)} + 4w_2^{(2)} \tag{684}$$

Therefore, the Jordan canonical form is

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 4 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 4 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 4 \end{pmatrix}}_{J} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}^{-1}}_{P^{-1}} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 5 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & 3 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 5 \end{pmatrix}}_{A} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}}_{P} \tag{685}$$

Let's give one more example on diagonalizing a matrix but with purely complex eigenvalues.

**Example 6.6 (Real Matrix with 4 Complex Eigenvalues)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \tag{686}$$

We will compute its Jordan canonical form over $\mathbb{C}$. First, we compute the characteristic polynomial.

$$p_A(t) = \det(A - tI) = \big((2-t)^2 + 1\big)^2 = (2 + i - t)^2(2 - i - t)^2 \tag{687}$$

Therefore, the eigenvalues are $\lambda = 2 + i$ and $\lambda = 2 - i$, each with algebraic multiplicity 2.

1. First, we study the eigenspace for $\lambda = 2 + i$. We compute

$$E(2+i) = \ker(A - (2+i)I) = \text{span}\left\{ w_1^{(1)} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -i \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{688}$$

So $\lambda = 2 + i$ has algebraic multiplicity 2, but geometric multiplicity 1. Therefore, we need one generalized eigenvector.
We want to find $w_1^{(2)}$ satisfying

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} -i & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & -i & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & -i & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & -i \end{pmatrix}}_{A-(2+i)I} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \\ x_4 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_1^{(2)}} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -i \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_1^{(1)}} \implies w_1^{(2)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ -i \end{pmatrix} \tag{689}$$

Thus we have the Jordan chain

$$w_1^{(2)} \xrightarrow{A-(2+i)I} w_1^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A-(2+i)I} 0 \tag{690}$$

2. Now we study the eigenspace for $\lambda = 2 - i$. We compute

$$E(2-i) = \ker(A - (2-i)I) = \text{span}\left\{ w_2^{(1)} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ i \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\} \tag{691}$$

So $\lambda = 2 - i$ has algebraic multiplicity 2, but geometric multiplicity 1. Therefore, we need one generalized eigenvector.
We want to find $w_2^{(2)}$ satisfying

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} i & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & i & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & i & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & i \end{pmatrix}}_{A-(2-i)I} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \\ x_4 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_2^{(2)}} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ i \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}}_{w_2^{(1)}} \implies w_2^{(2)} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ i \end{pmatrix} \tag{692}$$

Thus we have the Jordan chain

$$w_2^{(2)} \xrightarrow{A-(2-i)I} w_2^{(1)} \xrightarrow{A-(2-i)I} 0 \tag{693}$$

Therefore, a Jordan basis is

$$\mathcal{B} = \left\{ w_1^{(1)}, w_1^{(2)}, w_2^{(1)}, w_2^{(2)} \right\} \implies P = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -i & 0 & i & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & -i & 0 & i \end{pmatrix} \tag{694}$$

With respect to this basis,

$$Aw_1^{(1)} = (2+i)w_1^{(1)} \tag{695}$$
$$Aw_1^{(2)} = w_1^{(1)} + (2+i)w_1^{(2)} \tag{696}$$
$$Aw_2^{(1)} = (2-i)w_2^{(1)} \tag{697}$$
$$Aw_2^{(2)} = w_2^{(1)} + (2-i)w_2^{(2)} \tag{698}$$

Therefore, the Jordan canonical form is

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 2+i & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2+i & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 2-i & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 2-i \end{pmatrix}}_{J} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -i & 0 & i & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & -i & 0 & i \end{pmatrix}^{-1}}_{P^{-1}} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}}_{A} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -i & 0 & i & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & -i & 0 & i \end{pmatrix}}_{P} \tag{699}$$

One nice thing about diagonalizing a matrix is that we can perform matrix exponentials much more efficiently.

**Example 6.7 (Fibonacci Sequence)**

It is clear that the Fibonacci sequence can be produced with matrix multiplication as such

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_{n+1} \\ a_n \end{pmatrix} = A^n \begin{pmatrix} a_1 \\ a_0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}^n \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \tag{700}$$

Given that

$$\lambda_1 = \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2},\ \lambda_2 = \frac{1-\sqrt{5}}{2} \tag{701}$$

we can diagonalize $A$ into the form

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{\lambda_1-\lambda_2} & \frac{\lambda_2}{\lambda_2-\lambda_1} \\ \frac{1}{\lambda_2-\lambda_1} & \frac{\lambda_1}{\lambda_1-\lambda_2} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \lambda_1 & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \lambda_1 & \lambda_2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \implies A^n = S^{-1} \begin{pmatrix} \lambda_1^n & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_2^n \end{pmatrix} S \tag{702}$$

which implies that after evaluating, we get

$$a_n = \frac{1}{\sqrt{5}} \left( \left( \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2} \right)^n - \left( \frac{1-\sqrt{5}}{2} \right)^n \right) \tag{703}$$

This is a surprising result since it also says that the expression above is always an integer for all natural number $n$.

Notice that the Jordan normal form must be an $n \times n$ matrices over $\mathbb{C}$, not $\mathbb{R}$. However, given a matrix $A$ over $\mathbb{R}$, we can construct a similar block diagonal form over $\mathbb{R}$.

**Definition 6.10 (Real Jordan Block for a Complex Eigenvalue)**

Let $\lambda = a + bi \in \mathbb{C}$ with $b \neq 0$. A **real Jordan block** associated to the conjugate pair $a \pm bi$ is a matrix $J(a,b) \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times d}$ of the form

$$J(a,b) = \begin{pmatrix} R(a,b) & I_2 & & & \\ & R(a,b) & I_2 & & \\ & & R(a,b) & \ddots & \\ & & & \ddots & I_2 \\ & & & & R(a,b) \end{pmatrix}, \qquad R(a,b) = \begin{pmatrix} a & -b \\ b & a \end{pmatrix} \tag{704}$$

where $R(a,b)$ appears on the block diagonal and $I_2$ appears on the block superdiagonal. This block represents a generalized eigenvector chain associated to the conjugate pair of complex eigenvalues $a \pm bi$.

*Proof.* Since $A$ is real $\implies$ $p_A(t) \in \mathbb{R}[t]$, $\mu \in \mathbb{C}$ is a root of $p_A$ implies that $\bar{\mu}$ is also a root. This means that in the case where $\mu = a \pm bi$ is a pair of complex eigenvectors with eigenvectors $z$ and $\bar{z}$. The associated $2 \times 2$ Jordan block will be of form

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & -b \\ b & a \end{pmatrix} \tag{705}$$

with the associated column vectors in $P$ being

$$v_1 = \frac{z+\bar{z}}{2},\ v_2 = \frac{i(z-\bar{z})}{2} \tag{706}$$

Notice that $z \in \mathbb{C}^n$ is a complex eigenvector belonging to complex eigenvalue $\mu$, and we make the best "approximations" of $z, \bar{z}$ and $\mu, \bar{\mu}$ with the new real vectors $v_1$ and $v_2$. Note that the Jordan block states that

$$A(v_1) = av_1 + bv_2,\ A(v_2) = -bv_1 + av_2 \tag{707}$$

which is true since

$$A(v_1) = A\Big(\frac{z+\bar{z}}{2}\Big) = \frac{1}{2}\big(A(z) + A(\bar{z})\big) \tag{708}$$
$$= \frac{1}{2}\big((a+bi)z + (a-bi)\bar{z}\big) \tag{709}$$
$$= \frac{1}{2}\big((a)(z+\bar{z}) + (bi)(z-\bar{z})\big) \tag{710}$$
$$= a\frac{z+\bar{z}}{2} + b\frac{i(z-\bar{z})}{2} = av_1 + bv_2 \tag{711}$$
$$\tag{712}$$

and

$$A(v_2) = A\Big(\frac{i(z-\bar{z})}{2}\Big) = \frac{i}{2}\big(A(z) - A(\bar{z})\big) \tag{713}$$
$$= \frac{i}{2}\big((a+bi)z - (a-bi)\bar{z}\big) \tag{714}$$
$$= \frac{i}{2}\big((a)(z-\bar{z}) + (bi)(z+\bar{z})\big) \tag{715}$$
$$= a\frac{i(z-\bar{z})}{2} - b\frac{z+\bar{z}}{2} = av_2 - bv_1 \tag{716}$$

It suffices to only modify this case for $2\times 2$ blocks because all complex eigenvalues of real matrices must come in conjugate pairs (but this is not necessarily true for complex matrices, which have characteristic polynomials in $\mathbb{C}[t]$).

**Example 6.8 (Rotation in $\mathbb{R}^2$)**

The following $2\times 2$ Jordan block of the form shown below can be turned into the complex Jordan block and vice versa.

$$\begin{pmatrix} \cos\theta & -\sin\theta \\ \sin\theta & \cos\theta \end{pmatrix} \leftrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} e^{i\theta} & 0 \\ 0 & e^{-i\theta} \end{pmatrix} \tag{717}$$

**Definition 6.11 (Real Jordan Block for a Real Eigenvalue)**

If $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, then the **real Jordan block** associated to $\lambda$ is the usual Jordan block

$$J(\lambda) = \begin{pmatrix} \lambda & 1 & & & \\ & \lambda & 1 & & \\ & & \lambda & \ddots & \\ & & & \lambda & 1 \\ & & & & \lambda \end{pmatrix}. \tag{718}$$

**Definition 6.12 (Jordan Normal Form over $\mathbb{R}$)**

Let $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$. A matrix $J_{\mathbb{R}} \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$ is called the **real Jordan normal form** of $A$ if

$$J = \begin{pmatrix} J_1 & & & \\ & J_2 & & \\ & & \ddots & \\ & & & J_k \end{pmatrix}, \tag{719}$$

where each block $J_i$ can be either a a usual Jordan block $J_i = J_i(\lambda)$ corresponding to a real eigenvalue $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, or a real Jordan block $J_i = J_i(a, b)$ corresponding to a conjugate pair of non-real eigenvalues $a \pm bi$.

**Example 6.9 (Real Jordan Normal Form of a $3 \times 3$ Matrix)**

Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{15}{28} & \frac{3}{28} - \frac{\sqrt{42}}{14} & \frac{1}{14} + \frac{3\sqrt{42}}{28} \\ \frac{3}{28} + \frac{\sqrt{42}}{14} & \frac{23}{28} & \frac{3}{14} - \frac{\sqrt{42}}{28} \\ \frac{1}{14} - \frac{3\sqrt{42}}{28} & \frac{3}{14} + \frac{\sqrt{42}}{28} & \frac{9}{14} \end{pmatrix}. \tag{720}$$

We will compute its real Jordan normal form.
First, we compute the characteristic polynomial.

$$p_A(t) = \det(A - tI) = (1-t)\left(\left(\frac{1}{2} - t\right)^2 + \frac{3}{4}\right). \tag{721}$$

Therefore, the eigenvalues are

$$\lambda_1 = 1, \qquad \lambda_2 = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}i, \qquad \lambda_3 = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}i. \tag{722}$$

1. First, we study the eigenspace for $\lambda = 1$. We compute

$$E(1) = \ker(A - I) = \text{span}\left\{u = \frac{1}{\sqrt{14}}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}\right\}. \tag{723}$$

2. Now we study the eigenspace for

$$\lambda = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}i. \tag{724}$$

Solving $(A - \lambda I)z = 0$, we get

$$E\left(\frac{1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}i\right) = \text{span}\left\{z = \frac{1}{\sqrt{10}}\begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} - i\frac{1}{\sqrt{35}}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ -5 \end{pmatrix}\right\}. \tag{725}$$

Since $A$ is real, the conjugate eigenvalue

$$\bar{\lambda} = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}i \tag{726}$$

has conjugate eigenvector $\bar{z}$. Now, from the complex eigenvector $z$, we construct two real vectors:

$$v_1 = \frac{z + \bar{z}}{2} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{10}}\begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad v_2 = \frac{i(z - \bar{z})}{2} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{35}}\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ -5 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{727}$$

which is orthonormal.

Now let

$$\mathcal{B} = \{u, v_1, v_2\}. \tag{728}$$

With respect to this basis, we compute

$$Au = u \tag{729}$$

$$Av_1 = \frac{1}{2}v_1 + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}v_2 \tag{730}$$

$$Av_2 = -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}v_1 + \frac{1}{2}v_2. \tag{731}$$

Therefore, the real Jordan normal form is

$$J_{\mathbb{R}} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \\ 0 & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & R(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}) \end{pmatrix}. \tag{732}$$

The associated real change-of-basis matrix is

$$P = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{14}} & \frac{3}{\sqrt{10}} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{35}} \\ \frac{3}{\sqrt{14}} & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{10}} & \frac{3}{\sqrt{35}} \\ \frac{2}{\sqrt{14}} & 0 & -\frac{5}{\sqrt{35}} \end{pmatrix}. \tag{733}$$

Since $\mathcal{B}$ is an orthonormal basis, $P^{-1} = P^T$. Therefore,

$$J = P^{-1}AP. \tag{734}$$

Explicitly,

$$\underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \\ 0 & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}}_{J} = \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{14}} & \frac{3}{\sqrt{10}} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{35}} \\ \frac{3}{\sqrt{14}} & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{10}} & \frac{3}{\sqrt{35}} \\ \frac{2}{\sqrt{14}} & 0 & -\frac{5}{\sqrt{35}} \end{pmatrix}^{-1}}_{P^{-1}} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} \frac{15}{28} & \frac{3}{28} - \frac{\sqrt{42}}{14} & \frac{1}{14} + \frac{3\sqrt{42}}{28} \\ \frac{3}{28} + \frac{\sqrt{42}}{14} & \frac{23}{28} & \frac{3}{14} - \frac{\sqrt{42}}{28} \\ \frac{1}{14} - \frac{3\sqrt{42}}{28} & \frac{3}{14} + \frac{\sqrt{42}}{28} & \frac{9}{14} \end{pmatrix}}_{A} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{14}} & \frac{3}{\sqrt{10}} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{35}} \\ \frac{3}{\sqrt{14}} & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{10}} & \frac{3}{\sqrt{35}} \\ \frac{2}{\sqrt{14}} & 0 & -\frac{5}{\sqrt{35}} \end{pmatrix}}_{P} \tag{735}$$

Now we interpret this real Jordan normal form. The real eigenvector of eigenvalue 1 is parallel to

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}, \tag{736}$$

so $A$ fixes this one-dimensional subspace. On the complementary two-dimensional subspace, $A$ acts as a rotation of $\frac{\pi}{3}$ radians.

$$R\left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right) = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \cos(\frac{\pi}{3}) & -\sin(\frac{\pi}{3}) \\ \sin(\frac{\pi}{3}) & \cos(\frac{\pi}{3}) \end{pmatrix} \tag{737}$$

Therefore, we conclude that $A$ is a rotation of $\frac{\pi}{3}$ radians around the axis $(1, 3, 2)^T$.

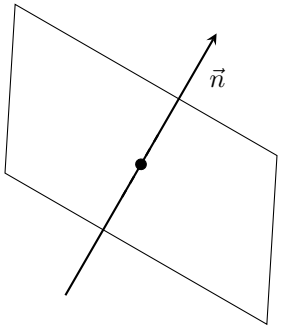



Figure 15: The linear operator that rotates around a vector $v$ by an angle $\theta$ has an eigendecomposition of the span of $v$ as shown (with eigenvalue 1) and the 2-dimensional plane (having two complex eigenvalues).

**Example 6.10 (2 Rotations in $\mathbb{R}^4$)**

Observe the following JNF, with columns (from left to right) corresponding to the transformations $h_1$ (genuine), $k_1$ (generalized), $h_2$ (genuine), and $k_2$ generalized).

$$\begin{pmatrix} e^{i\theta} & 1 & & \\ & e^{i\theta} & & \\ & & e^{-i\theta} & 1 \\ & & & e^{i-\theta} \end{pmatrix} \tag{738}$$

Using the corollary shown above, we can modify the eigenvalues and eigenvectors into real values and construct the simplest "real form" (assuming $i \neq 0, \pi$) of the matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} \cos\theta & -\sin\theta & 1 & 0 \\ \sin\theta & \cos\theta & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & \cos\theta & -\sin\theta \\ 0 & 0 & \sin\theta & \cos\theta \end{pmatrix} \tag{739}$$

where the columns (from left left to right) now correspond to transformation of real eigenvectors

$$\frac{h_1 + h_2}{2}, \frac{i(h_1 - h_2)}{2}, \frac{k_1 + k_2}{2}, \frac{i(k_1 - k_2)}{2} \tag{740}$$

Therefore, we can state that the linear transformation represented by the two matrices in their respective bases are equivalent.

**Theorem 6.8 (Similarity Conditions)**

$A, B \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ are similar if and only if their JNFs are the same.

*Proof.* We prove bidirectionally.

1. $(\rightarrow)$ $A \sim B \implies A = S^{-1}BS = S^{-1}P^{-1}JPS = (PS)^{-1}J(PS) \implies$ JNF of $A$ and $B$ are the same.
2. $(\leftarrow)$ $A$ and $B$ have same JNF $\implies A = P^{-1}JP, B = Q^{-1}JQ \implies J = QBQ^{-1} \implies A = P^{-1}QBQ^{-1}P = (Q^{-1}P)^{-1}B(Q^{-1}P) \implies A \sim B$.

**Theorem 6.9 (Diagonalizability Conditions for Multiplicities)**

A matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ is diagonalizable if and only if its algebraic multiplicities is equal to its geometric multiplicities for all eigenvalues.

*Proof.* We prove bidirectionally.
1. ($\rightarrow$). If $A$ is diagonalizable, then the JNF will be diagonal, which implies that the algebraic multiplicities are equal to the geometric multiplicities.
2. ($\leftarrow$). If the algebraic multiplicities are equal to the geometric multiplities, then the JNF will be diagonal and so $A$ is diagonalizable.

**Corollary 6.10 (Transposes are Similar)**

Let $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$. Then, $A \sim A^T$.

*Proof.* It is sufficient to prove that $A$ and $A^T$ have the same eigendecomposition. Since $(A - \lambda I)^T = A^T - \lambda I$, $\det(A - \lambda I) = 0 \iff \det(A - \lambda I)^T = \det(A^T - \lambda I) \implies A$ and $A^T$ have the same eigenvalues. Similarly, $\big((A - \lambda I)^d\big)^T = (A^T - \lambda I)^d \implies$ the eigenspaces of $A$ and $A^T$ have the same dimension.

## 6.3 Spectral Mapping Theorem

**Theorem 6.11 (Spectral Mapping Theorem)**

Let $q$ be any polynomial, $A$ a square matrix with an eigenvalue $a$. Then:
1. $q(a)$ is an eigenvalue of $q(A)$.
2. Every eigenvalue $q(A)$ is of the form $q(a)$, where $a$ is an eigenvalue of $A$.

*Proof.* Listed.
1. Let $h$ be an eigenvector of A with corresponding eigenvalue $a$.

$$\begin{aligned} Ah = ah &\implies A^2h = Aah = aAh = a^2h \\ &\implies A^nh = a^nh \\ &\implies q(A)h = q(a)h \\ &\implies q(a) \text{ is an eigenvalue of } q(A) \end{aligned}$$

2. Let $p$ be the eigenvalue of $q(A) \iff \det\big(q(A) - pI\big) = 0$. We expand:

$$q(s) - p = c\prod \big(s - r_i\big), r_i \in \mathbb{C} \tag{741}$$

Replacing the variable $s$ with $A$, we have

$$q(A) - pI = c\prod \big(A - r_iI\big) \tag{742}$$

Since $\det\big(q(A) - pI\big) = 0$, at least one $r_i$, say $r_k$ exists such that $\det\big(A - r_kI\big) = 0 \iff r_k$ is an eigenvalue of $A$. Since $q(r_j) - p = 0$, $p = q(r_j)$ is an eigenvalue of $q(A)$.

Therefore if $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$, $f$ is a polynomial, and if the chracteristic polynomial of $A$ has factorization

$$p_A(t) = \prod_{i=1}^{n} (t - \lambda_i) \tag{743}$$

then the characteristic polynomial of the matrix $f(A)$ is given by

$$p_{f(a)}(t) = \prod_{i=1}^{n} (t - f(\lambda_i)) \tag{744}$$

**Theorem 6.12 (Cayley Hamilton)**

Every matrix $A$ satisfies its own characteristic equation. That is,

$$p_A(A) = 0 \tag{745}$$

*Proof.*

## 6.4 Eigenvalue Bounds (Gershgorin)

We can actually create a bound on the spectrum of a square matrix.

**Theorem 6.13 (Gershgorin Circle Theorem)**

Let $A \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$, and let us define the **Gershgorin disk** in the equivalent ways:

1. Let $R_i$ be the sum of the absolute values of the non-diagonal entries of the $i$th row, and let $D_(a_{ii}, R_i) \subset \mathbb{C}$ be a closed disk with radius $R_i$ centered at $a_{ii}$.
2. Let $C_i$ be the sum of the absolute values of the non-diagonal entries of the $i$th column, and let $D_(a_{ii}, C_i) \subset \mathbb{C}$ be a closed disk with radius $C_i$ centered at $a_{ii}$.

Then, every eigenvalue of $A$ lies within the union of all $n$ Gershgorin Disks. That is,

$$\lambda_j(A) \in \bigcup_{i=1}^{n} D_(a_{ii}, R_i) \subset \mathbb{C}, \text{ for all } j \tag{746}$$

*Proof.* Let $\lambda$ be an eigenvalue of $A$ with its eigenvector $v = (v_j)$. Scale $v$ by multiplying it by $\pm 1 / \max\{|v_j|\}_j$ to get a vector $x$ with its maximal entry $x_i = 1$ and $|x_j| \leq 1$, $j \neq i$. Then,

$$Ax = \lambda x \implies \sum_j a_{ij} x_j = \lambda x_i = \lambda \implies \sum_{j \neq i} a_{ij} x_j + a_{ii} = \lambda \tag{747}$$

Applying the triangle inequality,

$$|\lambda - a_{ii}| = \left| \sum_{j \neq i} a_{ij} x_j \right| \leq \sum_{j \neq i} |a_{ij}||x_j| \leq \sum_{j \neq i} |a_{ij}| = R_i \tag{748}$$

For the columns, this is a direct result from the fact that $A$ is similar to $A^T$. Alternatively, we can apply the same process in the proof above to $A^T$.

If one observes that the off-diagonal entries of $A$ are small in absolute value, it can be concluded that the diagonal entries are "close" to the true eigenvalues of $A$. $A$ is diagonal if and only if the Gershgorin disks are points.

## 6.5 Schur Decomposition

**Theorem 6.14 (Schur Decomposition)**

Every $n \times n$ matrix $A$ over $\mathbb{C}$ can be decomposed into

$$A = QTQ^\dagger \tag{749}$$

where $Q \in U(n)$ and $T$ is upper triangular.

*Proof.* This is an obvious result of the Gram-Schmidt algorithm.

## 6.6 Self-Adjoint Operators

**Theorem 6.15 (Spectral Theorem of Self-Adjoint Maps)**

Let $V$ be a $n$-dimensional complex vector space. If $H : V \to V$ is a complex self-adjoint map over $\mathbb{C}$, then

1. $H$ has $n$ real eigenvalues, counting for multiplicity: $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n$.
2. The eigendecomposition of $V$ consists of $n$ pairwise orthogonal genuine eigenspaces.

$$V = \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} E(\lambda_i), \qquad E(\lambda_i) \perp E(\lambda_j) \tag{750}$$

*Proof.* By the fundamental theorem of algebra, $H$ must have at least 1 genuine eigenvalue, call it $\lambda_1$, with corresponding eigenvector $v_1$. Then,

$$\lambda_1 \langle v_1, v_1 \rangle = \langle Av_1, v_1 \rangle = \langle v_1, Av_1 \rangle = \overline{\lambda_1} \langle v_1, v_1 \rangle \tag{751}$$

and so $\lambda_1$ must be real. Now, consider the subspace $W^{(n-1)} = \text{span}\{v_1\}^\perp$. We wish to show that $W^{(n-1)}$ is invariant under $H$. Indeed, take $w \in W^{(n-1)}$. Then,

$$\langle v_1, w \rangle = 0 \implies \langle v_1, Aw \rangle = \langle Av_1, w \rangle = \lambda_1 \langle v_1, w \rangle = 0 \tag{752}$$

Therefore, the restriction of $H$ onto $W^{(n-1)}$ is also self-adjoint. Now we apply the same argument to $H|_{W^{(n-1)}}$ by taking another eigenvalue $\lambda_2$ from it, which is an eigenvalue of $H$. By induction and since $V$ is finite-dimensional, we are done.

**Corollary 6.16 (Diagonalizability of Hermitian Matrix)**

Given a real Hermitian matrix $H$, there exists a real invertible matrix $M$ such that $M^\dagger H M = D$, with $D$ diagonal and the column vectors form an orthonormal basis.

*Proof.*

So, given self-adjoint $H : X \longrightarrow X$, the whole space can be written as the direct sum of pairwise orthogonal eigenspaces.

$$X = \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n} E(\lambda_i) \tag{753}$$

**Definition 6.13 (Spectral Resolution)**

Given that $P_j$ is the orthogonal projection onto the $j$th eigenspace $E(\lambda_j)$, that is

$$P_j(x) = x_j \in E(\lambda_j), \quad (P_j \text{ also self adjoint}) \tag{754}$$

the **spectral resolution** of self-adjoint mapping $H$ is the decomposition into the form

$$H = \sum_j \lambda_j P_j \implies Hx = \left( \sum_j \lambda_j P_j \right) x = \sum_j \lambda_j x_j \tag{755}$$

The resolution of the identity is

$$I = \sum_j P_j \tag{756}$$

**Theorem 6.17 (Functional Calculus via the Spectral Resolution)**

Given the spectral resolution of self-adjoint $H$,

$$H = \sum_j \lambda_j P_j \implies H^2 = \sum_j \lambda_j^2 P_j \tag{757}$$

*Proof.*

Note that the spectral resolution of a self adjoint mapping is precisely the eigendecomposition of the mapping into its 1-dimensional eigenspaces. It is merely a simpler form of the eigendecomposition in the specific case when the linear mapping is self-adjoint.

**Theorem 6.18 (Spectral Resolution of Commuting Self-Adjoint Operators)**

Let $H, K$ be self-adjoint mappings such that $HK = KH$. Then $H$ and $K$ have the same spectral resolution, i.e. they have the same eigendecomposition.

$$H = \sum_j a_j P_j, \quad K = \sum_j b_j P_j \tag{758}$$

*Proof.* $x \in E(a) Hx = ax \implies KHx = aKx \implies HKx = aKx \implies Kx \in E(a)$. Similarly, we can do this with $K$ to find $x \in E(a) \implies Hx \in E(a)$, meaning that $K$ and $H$ have the same eigendecompositions (though their eigenvalues are not necessarily equal).

So, given an anti-self adjoint map $A$, we can apply the spectral resolution to $iA$.

**Theorem 6.19 (Spectral Resolution of Anti-Self-Adjoint Operators)**

Given anti-self adjoint $A : \mathbb{C}^n \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}^n$,

1. eigenvalues of $A$ are purely imaginary
2. we can choose an orthonormal basis of eigenvectors of $A$

*Proof.* This easily follows from the Spectral Theorem.

**Definition 6.14 (Normal Maps)**

$N : X \longrightarrow X$ is a **normal mapping** if $N^\dagger N = NN^\dagger$.

Self-adjoint, anti-self adjoint, and unitary matrices are all normal. Surprisingly, the set of normal matrices are not closed under addition nor multiplication, so they do not form a group.

**Theorem 6.20**

A map $N$ is normal if and only if it has an orthonormal basis of eigenvectors, i.e. it is unitarily diagonalizable. That is,

$$N = U^\dagger D U \tag{759}$$

*Proof.* We prove bidirectionally.

1. ($\rightarrow$) Let
$$H = \frac{1}{2}(N + N^\dagger),\ A = \frac{1}{2}(N - N^\dagger) \tag{760}$$
$N^\dagger N = NN^\dagger$ which implies $AH = HA$, where $H$ is self adjoint, $A$ is anti-self adjoint, and $N = H + A, N^\dagger = H - A$. Since $AH = HA$, they have the same spectral resolution of orthonormal eigenspaces, which also forms the same spectral resolution for $N = H + A$.
2. ($\leftarrow$) $A = U^\dagger D U \implies A^\dagger A = (U^\dagger D U)(U^\dagger \bar{D} U) = U^\dagger D \bar{D} U = AA^\dagger$.

## 6.7 Positive Definite Maps

**Definition 6.15 (Spectral Radius)**

The **spectral radius** of $A$ is defined

$$r(A) \equiv \max_i |a_i|,\ a_i \text{ are eigenvalues} \tag{761}$$

**Definition 6.16 (Positive (Semi)definite)**

A self-adjoint linear map $A : V \to V$ is **positive (semi)definite** if it satisfies any of the equivalent conditions.

1. For all $v \in V$,
$$\langle v, Av \rangle \geq 0 \tag{762}$$
2. All eigenvalues of $A$ are real and nonnegative.

**Example 6.11 (Positive Definite Maps)**

$I$ is positive definite.

**Example 6.12 (Positive Definite Matrices)**

In $\mathbb{R}^n$, $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ is positive definite if and only if

$$\langle v, Av \rangle = v^T A v \geq 0 \tag{763}$$

**Theorem 6.21 (Subspace of Positive Definite Maps)**

Positive mappings form a subspace in the space of linear mappings.

*Proof.*

**Theorem 6.22 (Congruence Preserves Positivity)**

$H$ positive and $Q$ invertible $\implies$ $Q^\dagger HQ$ positive.

**Theorem 6.23 (Unique Positive Square Root)**

Every positive mapping $M$ has a unique positive square root. That is, there exists a unique positive mapping $N$ such that

$$N^2 = M \tag{764}$$

We denote $N$ as $\sqrt{M}$.

**Definition 6.17 (Loewner Order on Positive Definite Mappings)**

Given that $M, N$ are positive definite mappings.

$$M > N \iff M - N > 0, \text{ that is, } M \text{ is positive} \tag{765}$$

**Theorem 6.24 (Order Reversal under Inversion)**

If $M, N$ are positive definite mappings

$$M > N \implies M^{-1} < N^{-1} \tag{766}$$

The following is a useful fact regarding inner products of $\mathbb{R}^n$.

**Theorem 6.25 (Inner Products on $\mathbb{R}^n$ as Positive Definite Matrices)**

The set of all inner products that can be defined on $\mathbb{R}^n$ is bijective to the set of positive-definite matrices $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$. That is, every inner product of $\mathbb{R}^n$ can be defined

$$\langle v, w \rangle \coloneqq v^T A w \tag{767}$$

Note that when $A = I_n$, the inner product is the regular dot product.

## 6.8 Singular Value Decomposition

We now proceed to another crucial decomposition, called the singular value decomposition. While the JNF allows us to choose the most convenient choice of basis for a square matrix, the Singular Value Decomposition (SVD) allows us to decompose general $m \times n$ matrices.

**Theorem 6.26 (Singular Value Decomposition)**

Let $A : V \to W$ be a linear map between inner product spaces with $\dim(V) = n$, $\dim(W) = m$. Then there exists orthonormal bases $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ of $V$ and $\{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ of $W$ such that

1. For $1 < i < p$, $Av_i = \sigma_i w_i$.
2. For $i > p$, $Av_i = \sigma_i w_i$.

where $p = \text{rank}(A)$.
In matrix form, this is called the **singular value decomposition (SVD)** of $A$.

$$M = U\Sigma V^\dagger = \begin{pmatrix} | & | & | & | \\ y_1 & y_2 & \dots & y_m \\ | & | & | & | \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \sigma_1 & & & & 0 \\ & \ddots & & & \vdots \\ & & \sigma_p & & 0 \\ & & & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & \dots & 0 & \dots & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} — & x_1 & — \\ — & x_2 & — \\ — & \vdots & — \\ — & x_n & — \end{pmatrix} \tag{768}$$

where $U \in U(m), V \in U(n)$ and $\Sigma$ has diagonal elements with nonnegative real entries.[a]

1. The columns of $U$, denoted $y_i$, are called the **left singular vectors**.
2. The columns of $V$ (i.e. the rows of $V^\dagger$), denoted $x_i$, are called the **right singular vectors**.
3. The diagonal entries of $\Sigma$ are called the **singular values**.

[a] The SVD is unique up to the order of singular values, but it is generally constructed so that $\sigma_1 \geq \sigma_2 \geq \dots \geq \sigma_p$.

*Proof.* To provide a brief, yet unrigorous, justificiation of why the SVD exists, we look at the linear mapping $M : X \longrightarrow Y$, with $\dim X = n, \dim Y = m$. If $M$ is injective ( $\iff m \geq n$), given the basis $\{e_i\}$ for $X$, we can complete the linearly independent set $\{Me_i\}_{i=1}^n$ to a basis in $Y$ and represent $M$ as the mapping

$$\Sigma_{inj} = \begin{pmatrix} & I_n & \\ & & \\ 0 & \dots & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{769}$$

If $M$ is surjective ( $\iff m \leq n$), then given basis $\{f_i\}_{i=1}^m$ of $Y$, we can choose a basis $\{e_j\}_{j=1}^n$ of $X$ such that $M(e_i) = f_i (i = 1, 2, \dots, m)$, and $M(e_i) = 0$ when $i > m$. This produces the matrix

$$\Sigma_{surj} = \begin{pmatrix} & & 0 \\ & I_m & \vdots \\ & & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{770}$$

Since any linear map can be written as the composition of a surjective map followed by an injective map, when given the right choice of basis, can be written as

$$\Sigma_{inj}\Sigma_{surj} = \begin{pmatrix} & & & \cdots & 0 \\ & I_p & & \cdots & 0 \\ & & & \cdots & \cdots \\ \cdots & \cdots & \cdots & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & & & & 0 \\ & \cdots & & & \cdots \\ & & 1 & & 0 \\ & & & \cdots & \cdots \\ 0 & \cdots & 0 & \cdots & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{771}$$

where $\text{rk}(M) = p =$ the number of 1's in $\Sigma_{inj}\Sigma_{surj}$. As for choosing the proper set basis for $X$ and $Y$, we can find these passive transformations in the unitary groups $U(n)$ and $U(m)$.

We now present a geometric description of the singular value decomposition. Think of the unit $n$-ball being rotated and flipped ($V^\dagger$ applied) under the unitary transformation. Then, it is stretched along its othogonal axes to result in an ellipsoid living in an $m$-dimensional space. The factor of stretching and compressing the

axes are precisely the singular values. Finally, this ellipsoid is rotated and flipped ($U$ applied) back to its original basis.

**Theorem 6.27 (Operator Norm as the Largest Singular Value)**

The largest singular value of $M$ equals its matrix norm, also called the operator norm. This is what the geometric picture above shows: the operator norm is the longest semi-axis of the image ellipsoid.

$$\|M\| = \sigma_1 \tag{772}$$

**Theorem 6.28 (Properties of Singular Values)**

Given linear mapping $A$ from a $n$-dimensional inner product space to $m$-dimensional inner product space,

1. $\sigma_i(A) = \sigma_i(A^T) = \sigma_i(A^\dagger) = \sigma_i(\bar{A})$
2. $\forall\, U \in U(m), V \in U(n),\ \sigma_i(A) = \sigma_i(UAV)$
3. Relation to eigenvalues
$$\sigma_i^2(A) = \lambda_i(A^\dagger A) = \lambda_i(AA^\dagger) \tag{773}$$

We now present the (not the best) process of computing SVD of small matrices by hand. Given matrix $M$, $M = U\Sigma V^\dagger \implies M^\dagger M = V\Sigma^2 V^\dagger$. The eigenvalues of $M^\dagger M$ are $\sigma_i^2$ with corresponding eigenvectors being the columns of $V$, which can all be found by putting $M^\dagger M$ into JNF. We repeat this process for $MM^\dagger = U\Sigma^2 U^\dagger$ to find the eigenvectors that make up the column vectors of $U$.

**Theorem 6.29 (Eckart-Young Low-Rank Approximation)**

Let $A : X \longrightarrow Y$, with $\dim X = n, \dim Y = m$, and let $k \leq \min\{m, n\}$, with $A = U\Sigma V^\dagger$. Then, amongst all rank $k$ $m \times n$ matrices $B$, the matrix $A^{(k)}$ minimizes

$$\|A - B\|_2,\ A^{(k)} = U\Sigma^{(k)} V^\dagger \tag{774}$$

and $\Sigma^{(k)}$ is $\Sigma$ with $\sigma_{k+1} = \sigma_{k+2} = \cdots = 0$. Therefore, to see how "close" $B$ is to $A$, we can compare the singular values of $A$ and $B$, given that they both have the same unitary matrices $U$ and $V$.

The singular value decomposition has many applications in high dimensional data analysis and data compression. For example, in a set of $m$ data points in $\mathbb{R}^n$ that each lie in the rows of matrix $A$, if the singular values of $A$ suddenly drops (e.g. $120, 118, 107, 98, 2, 1, 0.3, \cdots$) then we can determine that the points "almost" lie in a subspace in $\mathbb{R}^n$. Knowing this allows us to compress high dimensional data to $A^{(k)}$, which is a more manageable form. This is especially useful in the data compression of electronic images, where each pixel is treated as a single number to form a matrix.

It can also be used to define the "pseudo-inverse" of a matrix that may not be invertible.

**Definition 6.18 (Pseudo-Inverse)**

Given matrix $M = U\Sigma V^\dagger$ in SVD, we define the **pseudo-inverse** $M^+ = V\Sigma^+ U^\dagger$, where $\Sigma^+$ is $\Sigma$ with entries $\sigma_i^{-1}$, or 0 if $\sigma_i = 0$. For example,

$$\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \implies \Sigma^+ = \begin{pmatrix} 1/3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1/2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{775}$$

$\implies M^+M = V\Sigma^+\Sigma V^\dagger$. If $M$ is square and all $\sigma_i \neq 0$, then $M^\dagger M = VV^\dagger \implies M^\dagger M = I \implies M^+ = M^{-1}$.

By computing the SVD of $M$, where $\sigma_p \neq 0, p = \operatorname{rk} M = \operatorname{rk} \Sigma$, we can automatically compute the 4 fundamental spaces.

$$M = U\Sigma V^\dagger = \left(\begin{array}{ccc|c} & & & \\ & U & & U' \\ & & & \end{array}\right) \left(\begin{array}{cccc|c} \sigma_1 & & & & 0 \\ & \sigma_2 & & & 0 \\ & & \cdots & & \cdots \\ & & & \sigma_p & 0 \\ \hline 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \end{array}\right) \left(\begin{array}{ccc} & & \\ & V^\dagger & \\ & & \\ \hline & & \\ & V^{\dagger\prime} & \\ & & \end{array}\right) \tag{776}$$

1. $\operatorname{Im} M = C(U)$
2. $\ker M = R(V^{\dagger\prime}) = C(V')$
3. $\ker M^\dagger = C(U')$
4. $\operatorname{Im} M^\dagger = C(V) = R(V^\dagger)$

One of the main differences between the JNF and SVD of a matrix $A$ lies in how they are affected by perturbations in the elements of $A$. For example, take the small change

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \longrightarrow A' = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1.00001 \end{pmatrix} \tag{777}$$

The SVD of $A'$ will "change" continuously for changes in the elements of $A$, but the JNF of $A$ is completely different from the JNF of $A'$. More specifically, the JNF of $A$ is $A$ itself, but the JNF os $A'$ is now diagonalizable, meaning that the 2-dimensional eigenspace $E(1)$ "breaks up" into two 1-dimensional eigenspaces from small perturbations.

**Definition 6.19 (Frobenius Norm)**

The **Frobenius norm** of a $m \times n$ matrix $A$ is defined

$$\|A\|_F \equiv \sqrt{\operatorname{Tr}(A^\dagger A)} = \sqrt{\operatorname{Tr} \Sigma^2} = \left( \sum_{i,j} a_{ij}^2 \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \tag{778}$$

By Singular Value Decomposition, we can reduce its calculations to

$$\|A\|_F = \sqrt{\sum_i \sigma_i^2} \tag{779}$$

where $\sigma_i$'s are the singular values. Clearly,

$$\|A\|_2 \leq \|M\|_F \tag{780}$$

In quantum mechanics, the Frobenius norm is also called the **Hilbert Schmidt norm** in the context of infinite dimensional Hilbert spaces.

## 6.9 Polar Decomposition

**Theorem 6.30 (Polar Decomposition)**

Every complex $n \times n$ matrix $A$ can be factored into the form

$$A = UP \tag{781}$$

where $U \in U(n)$ and $P$ is a positive semidefinite self-adjoint matrix. If $A$ is a real matrix, then $U \in O(n)$.

*Proof.* We take the SVD to get

$$A = W\Sigma V^\dagger \tag{782}$$

and we can assign

$$U = WV^\dagger,\ P = V\Sigma V^\dagger \tag{783}$$

Since $V, W$ are unitary, this confirms that $P$ is positive definite and self-adjoint along with $U$ being unitary. Thus, the existence of the SVD implies the existence of the polar decomposition.

## 6.10 Exercises

**Exercise 6.1 (Maximum Rank of 2-Nilpotent Matrix)**

Let $A$ be a $n \times n$ real matrix such that $A^2 = 0$. What is the maximum possible rank of $A$?

*Solution.* Take the Jordan decomposition of $A$. All eigenvalues of $A$ must be 0 since if it were not, then $A^2 v = \lambda^2 v \neq 0$. It suffices to focus on 1 Jordan block, which must be of the form

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & \dots & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & \dots & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \ddots & 0 & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \tag{784}$$

Let $w^{(k)}$ be the $k$th generalized eigenvector. Then, $Aw^{(k)} = w^{(k-1)} + 0w^{(k)} = w^{(k-1)}$, so the Jordan chain for this block must be

$$w^{(k)} \mapsto w^{(k-1)} \mapsto \dots \mapsto w^{(1)} \tag{785}$$

Since $w^{(k)}$ must vanish after 2 steps, $k$ can be at most 2. Therefore, each Jordan block must be either $1 \times 1$ (of rank 0) or $2 \times 2$ (of rank 1), so the total rank must be $\lfloor n/2 \rfloor$.

*Solution.* Let $A$ be rank $r$, and take the truncated SVD of $A = U\Sigma V^T$, where $U \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times r}$, $\Sigma \in \mathbb{R}^{r \times r}$ is full rank, and $V \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times r}$. We claim that $C(U) \perp C(V)$ since

$$0 = A^2 \implies 0 = U^T A^2 V^T = \Sigma V^T U \Sigma \implies V^T U = 0 \implies U^T V = 0 \tag{786}$$

where the second implication happens because $\Sigma$ is full rank. Note that $U, V$ both consist of orthonormal columns, so their ranks are both $r$.

1. Since $C(U) \oplus C(V) \subset \mathbb{R}^n$, we can see that

$$2r = r + r = \dim(C(U)) + \dim(C(V)) = \dim(C(U) \oplus C(V)) \leq \dim(\mathbb{R}^n) = n \tag{787}$$

we have an upper bound.

2. Alternatively, we rank nullity on $V^T$. Remember that the rank of $V$ and $V^T$ are the same, and since $V^T U = 0 \implies C(U) \subset N(V^T) \implies \dim(C(U)) \leq \dim(N(V^T))$. So,

$$n = \underbrace{\dim(C(V^T))}_{=r} + \underbrace{\dim(N(V^T))}_{\geq r} \geq 2r \tag{788}$$

# 7 Normed Vector Spaces

Given a vector space $V$, we can induce different structures on it to allow us to conduct different measurements on it. For example, the endowment of the basis on $V$ allows us to represent vector as an $n$-tuple of scalars, and from topology, we can also define an arbitrary topology or metric on a vector space as well.

**Definition 7.1 (Norm)**

A **norm** on a vector space $V$ over field $\mathbb{C}$ is a mapping

$$\rho : V \longrightarrow \mathbb{R} \tag{789}$$

satisfying three properties

1. $\rho(x) \geq 0$, with $\rho(x) = 0 \iff x = 0$
2. For $a \in \mathbb{C}$, $\rho(ax) = |a|\rho(x)$
3. $\rho(x + y) \leq \rho(x) + \rho(y)$

A norm allows us to define some notion of a magnitude or length on each vector in $V$. A vector space $V$ with a norm is called a **normed space**, denoted $(V, \rho)$.

**Example 7.1 (Absolute Value)**

The absolute value function $|\cdot| : \mathbb{C} \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}_+$ is an example of a norm on the 1 dimensional space $\mathbb{C}$.

**Example 7.2 (Euclidean Norm, $L_2$-Norm)**

The Euclidean norm of a vector $x \equiv (x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n)^T \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is defined

$$\|x\|_2 \equiv \left( \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2 \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \tag{790}$$

This is the most commonly used norm in $\mathbb{R}^n$.

**Example 7.3 (Taxicab Norm, Manhattan Norm)**

The Taxicab norm of $x \equiv (x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n)^T \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is defined

$$\|x\|_1 \equiv \sum_{i=1}^{n} |x_i| \tag{791}$$

**Example 7.4 (Infinity Norm, $L_\infty$-Norm)**

The Infinity norm of vector $x \equiv (x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n)^T \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is defined

$$\|x\|_\infty \equiv \max \{|x_1|, |x_2|, \cdots, |x_n|\} \tag{792}$$

**Example 7.5 (p-norm, $L_p$-Norm)**

Let $p \geq 1$ be a real number. The p-norm of a vector

$$x \equiv (x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n)^T \in \mathbb{R}^n \tag{793}$$

is defined

$$\|x\|_p \equiv \left( \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^p \right)^{\frac{1}{p}} \tag{794}$$

For $0 < p < 1$, this function could be of some use, but it is not considered a norm since it violates the triangle inequality. When $p = 1$ and $p = 2$, the norm is the Taxicab norm and Euclidean norm, respectively, and

$$\lim_{p \to \infty} \| \cdot \|_p = \| \cdot \|_\infty \tag{795}$$

**Theorem 7.1 (Norm Induces Metric)**

Every norm induces a metric in the following way

$$d(x, y) \equiv \rho(x - y) \tag{796}$$

However, a metric does not necessarily induce a norm because the definition

$$\rho(x) \equiv d(x, 0) \tag{797}$$

is not guaranteed to have all properties of the norm.

## 7.1 Dual Spaces

## 7.2 Norms of Linear Mappings

Since the algebra of linear operators is itself a vector space, we can also define structures on it, too. We focus on matrix norms.

**Definition 7.2 (Operator Norm)**

Let $A : X \longrightarrow U$ be linear. Then, we define

$$\|A\| = \sup_{\|x\|=1} \|Ax\| \tag{798}$$

Note that $\|Ax\|$ is measure with respect to the norm of $U$ and $\|x\|$ the norm of $X$.

There is a very nice visualization of this.

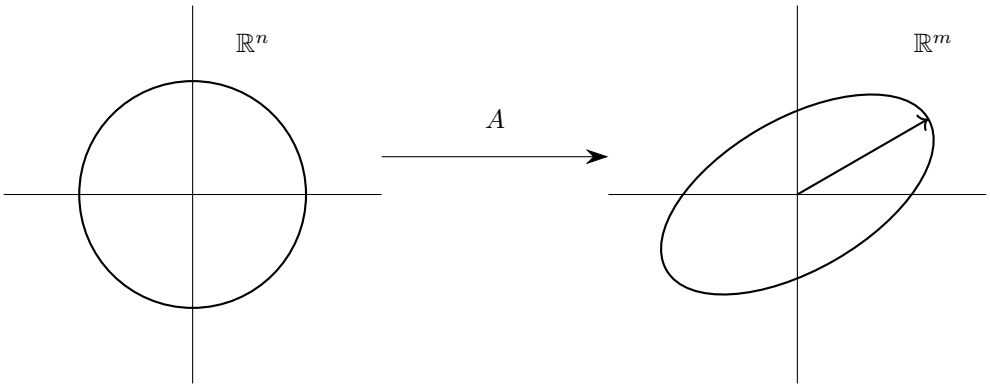



Figure 16: The norm of $A$ is the length of the major axis of the ellipsoid. Given that $\dim X = n$, imagine the $n$-dimensional unit ball in $X$ being transformed under $A$. The image of the ball should be an ellipsoid (of dimension $\leq m$) in $U$.

**Theorem 7.2 (Submultiplicativity of the Operator Norm)**

$$\|Az\| \leq \|A\|\|z\| \text{ for all } z \in X \tag{799}$$
$$\|A\| = \sup_{\|x\|,\|v\|=1} (Ax, v) \tag{800}$$

*Proof.*

$$\|Az\| \leq \sup \|Az\| = \sup \left\| A\frac{z}{\|z\|} \right\| = \|A\|\|z\|$$
$$\|u\| \equiv \max_{\|v\|=1} (u, v) \implies \|Ax\| \equiv \max_{\|v\|=1} (Ax, v) \implies \|A\| \equiv \sup_{\|x\|,\|v\|=1} (Ax, v)$$

**Theorem 7.3 (Properties of Matrix Norm)**

Let there exist any $k \in \mathbb{F}$, with any $A, B : X \longrightarrow U$, $C : U \longrightarrow V$. Then,
1. $\|kA\| = |k|\|A\|$
2. $\|A + B\| \leq \|A\| + \|B\|$
3. $\|CA\| \leq \|C\|\|A\|$
4. $\|A\| = \|A^\dagger\|$

**Theorem 7.4 (Spectral Radius Bounds the Operator Norm)**

A simple lower and upper bound of $\|A\|$ can be defined

$$r(A) \leq \|A\| \leq \left( \sum_{i,j} a_{ij}^2 \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \tag{801}$$

Matrix norms have extremely useful applications in determining the existence of inverses.

**Theorem 7.5 (Invertibility Is an Open Condition)**

Let $A$ be invertible and

$$\|A - B\| < \frac{1}{\|A^{-1}\|} \tag{802}$$

in the sense that $B$ is "close" to $A$. Then $B$ is invertible.

# 8 Solving Systems of Linear Equations

**Definition 8.1 (Linear System of Equations)**

Fix a field $\mathbb{F}$. A **linear equation** with variables $x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n$ is in the form

$$a_1x_1 + a_2x_2 + a_3x_3 + \cdots + a_nx_n = b \tag{803}$$

where the **coefficients** $a_i$ and the **free term** $b$ belong to $\mathbb{F}$. If $b = 0$, then (3) is called a **homogeneous equation** and if $b \neq 0$, then it is called a **inhomogeneous equation**.

A system of $m$ linear equations with $n$ variables has the following general form

$$\begin{aligned} a_{11}x_1 + a_{12}x_2 + \cdots + a_{1n}x_n &= b_1 \\ a_{21}x_1 + a_{22}x_2 + \cdots + a_{2n}x_n &= b_2 \\ \cdots &= \cdots \\ a_{m1}x_1 + a_{m2}x_2 + \cdots + a_{mn}x_n &= b_m \end{aligned}$$

By matrix multiplication, this system is equal to the matrix equation $Ax = b$.

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & \dots & a_{1n} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & \dots & a_{2n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{m1} & a_{m2} & \dots & a_{mn} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ \vdots \\ b_m \end{pmatrix} \tag{804}$$

That is, given a linear transformation $A : \mathbb{F}^n \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}^m$ and a vector $b \in \mathbb{F}^m$, we must find the preimage of $b$ under $A$. Clearly, $x$ is a solution of this matrix equation if and only if it is a solution of the system of equations.

We can interpret this matrix equation in two ways. First, we introduce the *hyperplane interpertation*. The solution to each linear equation of $n$ variables represents an affine hyperplane in $\mathbb{F}^n$. Therefore, the solutions to the system of $m$ linear equations is simply the intersection of the $m$ affine hyperplanes of dimension $n-1$ within $\mathbb{R}^n$. That is, $x$ is a solution of $Ax = b$ if and only if

$$x \in \bigcap_{i=1}^{m} \left\{ (x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n) \mid \sum_{j=1}^{n} a_{ij}x_j = b_i \right\} \tag{805}$$

The *column space interpretation* presents $Ax = b$ in this equivalent form.

$$x_1 \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} \\ a_{21} \\ \vdots \\ a_{m1} \end{pmatrix} + x_2 \begin{pmatrix} a_{12} \\ a_{22} \\ \vdots \\ a_{m2} \end{pmatrix} + \ldots + x_n \begin{pmatrix} a_{1n} \\ a_{2n} \\ \vdots \\ a_{mn} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ \vdots \\ b_m \end{pmatrix} \tag{806}$$

That is, the solutions $x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_n$ are precisely the coefficients of the linear combination of the column vectors of $A$ that add up to vector $b$. Equivalently, it is the realization of vector $b$ with respect to the coordinate system of the column vectors of $A$. Note that the column space need not be a basis of $\mathbb{F}^m$. It does not need to be linearly independent nor does it need to span $\mathbb{F}^n$.

**Definition 8.2 (Coefficient Matrix)**

The matrix $A$ under the system is called the **coefficient matrix** and the matrix

$$\tilde{A} \equiv \begin{pmatrix} | & | & \cdots & | & | \\ a_1 & a_2 & \cdots & a_n & b \\ | & | & \cdots & | & | \end{pmatrix} \equiv \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & \dots & a_{1n} & b_1 \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & \dots & a_{2n} & b_2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ a_{m1} & a_{m2} & \dots & a_{mn} & b_m \end{pmatrix} \tag{807}$$

is called the **extended matrix**.

Clearly, these two definitions are equivalent since every elementary transformation of a system has a corresponding row transformation in its extended matrix. Under the hyperplane interpretation, it is a bit harder to visualize, but it is sufficient to say that each elementary operation either "stretches/compresses" (iii) a hyperplane or it "rotates" (i) the hyperplane around the axis where the solution exists. Either way, the intersection between the hyperplane and the set of solutions do not change.

**Definition 8.3 (Solved System)**

A system of linear equations is said to be **solved** if its extended matrix is in reduced row echelon form.

**Theorem 8.1 (Elementary Operations Preserve the Solution Set)**

Elementary operations on either a system of linear equations or its extended matrix does not change its solutions.

*Proof.* It is easy to see this is true when performing the computations with the three transformations. We can prove this more abstractly (tbd): Given the system $Ax = b$ with $x \in \mathbb{F}^n, b \in \mathbb{F}^m$. We see that $A \in \text{Mat}(m \times n, \mathbb{F}) \implies \tilde{A} \in \text{Mat}(m \times (n+1), \mathbb{F})$. Each elementary row transformation on $\tilde{A}$, denote it $E$, is a bijective mapping. Let us define the mapping

$$\text{sol} : \text{Mat}\big(m \times (n+1), \mathbb{F}\big) \longrightarrow 2^{\mathbb{F}^n},\ \text{sol}\begin{pmatrix} A & b \end{pmatrix} \equiv \{x \in \mathbb{F}^n \mid Ax = b\} \tag{808}$$

where $2^{\mathbb{F}^n}$ is the set of all subsets of $\mathbb{F}^n$. By matrix multiplication, we see that

$$E\begin{pmatrix} A & b \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} EA & Eb \end{pmatrix} \tag{809}$$

Since $E$ is bijective, it is invertible. So,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{sol}\big(E\begin{pmatrix} A & b \end{pmatrix}\big) &= \text{sol}\begin{pmatrix} EA & Eb \end{pmatrix} && (810)\\ &= \{x \mid EAx = Eb\} && (811)\\ &= \{x \mid Ax = b\} && (812)\\ &= \text{sol}\begin{pmatrix} A & b \end{pmatrix} && (813) \end{aligned}$$

Note the importance of this theorem. This result is the foundation behind the applications of Jordan Elimination.

**Definition 8.4 (Classification of Linear Systems by Solution Count)**

A linear system has either no solutions, in which case it is called **inconsistent**, exactly one solution, or multiple solutions (infinitely many if $\operatorname{char}\mathbb{F} = 0$). Separately from the solution count, the system is called **overdetermined** if it has more equations than unknowns ($m > n$) and **underdetermined** if it has fewer ($m < n$); neither shape condition by itself determines how many solutions there are, since an overdetermined system may well be consistent. What is true is a statement about the generic case: with probability 1, given a random $m \times n$ matrix $A$ with random $m$-dimensional vector $b$, the system $Ax = b$ has

1. 0 solutions if $m > n$, since there are more equations than variables
2. 1 solution if $m = n$ with the same number of equations and variables
3. Infinite solutions if $m < n$ since there are more variables than equations

Because of theorem 3.3, we can determine whether a system has 0, 1, or multiple solutions by looking at the reduced row echelon form, written rref, which is the form named in the definition of a *solved* system above. Inconsistency is read off the extended matrix $\tilde{A}$, since it is the constant column that exposes it; the remaining two criteria assume the system is already known to be consistent and then examine the coefficient matrix $A$ to count the solutions. The case for 0 solutions is easy.

**Theorem 8.2 (Criterion for an Inconsistent System)**

The system $Ax = b$ has 0 solutions if and only if $\operatorname{rref}(\tilde{A})$ contains a row in the form

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & c \end{pmatrix}, \; c \neq 0 \tag{814}$$

*Proof.* The existence of this row is equivalent to the linear equation

$$0x_1 + 0x_2 + \cdots + 0x_n = c, \; c \neq 0 \tag{815}$$

which is absurd and cannot have any solution. Under the hyperplane interpretation, we can visualize all the hyperplanes failing to have a common point.

**Corollary 8.3 (Overdetermined Systems with Independent Rows)**

Given $m \times n$ matrix $A$, if $m > n$ and the row vectors of $A$ are all linearly independent, then the system $Ax = b$ has 0 solutions.

**Theorem 8.4 (Criterion for a Unique Solution)**

The system $Ax = b$ has exactly 1 solution if and only if it is consistent and every column of $\operatorname{rref}(A)$ contains a pivot, i.e. there are no free variables. Equivalently, the system is consistent and $\operatorname{rank}(A) = n$.

*Proof.* If the system is consistent with solution $a$, then by the characterization of the general solution below its solution set is $a + \operatorname{Null}(A)$. So it has exactly one solution precisely when $\operatorname{Null}(A) = \{0\}$. A column of $\operatorname{rref}(A)$ without a pivot is exactly a free variable, and each free variable contributes a basis vector to $\operatorname{Null}(A)$, so $\operatorname{Null}(A) = \{0\}$ if and only if every one of the $n$ columns carries a pivot, which is to say $\operatorname{rank}(A) = n$.
Note that $\operatorname{rref}(A)$ being *diagonal* is neither necessary nor sufficient here: it is not necessary because $A$ need not be square, and the $m > n$ case has $\operatorname{rref}(A) = \begin{pmatrix} I_n \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, which is not a square diagonal matrix;

and on its own it says nothing about consistency, which has to be read off $\tilde{A}$.

**Theorem 8.5 (Free Variables and Multiple Solutions)**

A consistent system $Ax = b$ has multiple solutions if and only if $\text{rref}(A)$ has at least one free variable, i.e. $\text{rank}(A) < n$.

*Proof.* As above the solution set is $a + \text{Null}\,(A)$, so there is more than one solution if and only if $\text{Null}\,(A) \neq \{0\}$, which happens exactly when some column of $\text{rref}(A)$ carries no pivot. The consistency hypothesis cannot be dropped: an inconsistent system has no solutions no matter how many free variables $A$ has.

**Theorem 8.6 (Form of the General Solution)**

A vector is a solution to the system of equation $Ax = b$ if and only if it is of the form

$$a + \text{Null}\,(A) \tag{816}$$

where $a$ is one solution.

**Example 8.1 (Solving a System by Row Reduction)**

Given a system of linear equations

$$\begin{aligned} x + 3y - 2z &= 5 \\ 3x + 5y + 6z &= 7 \\ 2x + 4y + 3z &= 8 \end{aligned}$$

We put it into extended matrix form $A$ and perform Gauss Elimination to get $\text{rref}(A)$.

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 3 & -2 & 5 \\ 3 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 2 & 4 & 3 & 8 \end{pmatrix} \to \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 3 & -2 & 5 \\ 0 & 1 & -3 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \to \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & -15 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 8 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \tag{817}$$

So, $\text{rref}(A)$ has the solution $(-15, 8, 2)$ and it is unique because there are no free variables.

This leads to the following theorem.

**Theorem 8.7 (Matrix Form of a Linear System)**

The set of $n$ linear equations with $n$ variables can be expressed in the form of $Ax = b$, where $A$ is an $n \times n$ matrix.

$$Ax = b \text{ has a unique solution } \iff A \text{ is nonsingular } \iff \text{rk}\,(A) = n \tag{818}$$

*Proof.* $A$ is nonsingular is equivalent to saying that $\text{rref}(A) = I_n$, where $I_n$ is the $n \times n$ identity matrix. This clearly means that $\text{rref}(\tilde{A})$ will always reveal unique solutions.

## 8.1 Numerical Methods

In this section, we will concern ourselves with a system of equations with only *one solution*, represented by the matrix equation

$$Ax = b \tag{819}$$

where $A$ is an invertible square matrix, $b$ some given vector, and $x$ the vector of unknowns to be determined.

An algorithm for solving the system takes as inputs the matrix $A$ and vector $b$ and outputs some approximation to the solution $x$. However, with billions of arithmetic operations on top of each other, the errors can accumulate. Algorithms for which this does not happen are said to be **arithmetically stable**.

The use of finite digit arithmetic places an absolute limitation on the accuracy with which the solution can be determined. To demonstrate this, let us imagine a change $\delta b$ being made in the vector $b$, which causes a corresponding change in $x$, denoted $\delta x$.

$$A(x + \delta x) = b + \delta b \implies A\delta x = \delta b \tag{820}$$

To compare the changes in $x$ with the changes in $b$, we define the following variable.

**Definition 8.5 (Relative Change in $x$ against Relative Change in $b$)**

The **relative change in x with the relative change in** $b$ is the quantity

$$\frac{|\delta x|}{|x|} \Big/ \frac{|\delta b|}{|b|} \tag{821}$$

where the norm is convenient for the problem (usually a numerical approximation of the Euclidean norm for floating point numbers). We will assume the use of the Euclidean norm from now on. We can rewrite the value as the expression below with the following upper bound, denoted by $\kappa(A)$, called the **condition number**.

$$\frac{|b|}{|x|}\frac{|\delta x|}{|\delta b|} = \frac{|Ax|}{|x|}\frac{|A^{-1}\delta b|}{|\delta b|} \leq |A||A^{-1}| \equiv \kappa(A) \tag{822}$$

where $|A|$ is the matrix norm of $A$.

A high value of this relative change would mean that small perturbations in $b$ would cause large changes in $x$.

Note that $\kappa(A) \geq 1$. Notice also that the higher the condition number $\kappa(A)$, the harder it is to solve the equation $Ax = b$, and $\kappa(A) = \infty$ when $A$ is not invertible. For a $k$-digit floating point arithmetic, the relative error in $b$ can be as large as $10^{-k}$, meaning that the relative error in $x$ can be as large as $10^{-k}\kappa(A)$.

Let $\beta$ be the largest absolute value of the eigenvalues of $A$ and $\alpha$ as the smallest absolute value of the eigenvalues of $A$. Then

$$\beta \leq |A|, \frac{1}{\alpha} \leq |A^{-1}| \implies \frac{|\beta|}{|\alpha|} \leq \kappa(A) \tag{823}$$

An algorithm that generates an exact solution after a finite number of arithmetic steps is called a *direct method* (e.g. Gauss Elimination). An algorithm that generates successive approximations that converge onto the solution is called an *iterative method*.

The methods mentioned in this section will be iterative.

**Definition 8.6 (Error at the $n$th Stage)**

Let $\{x_n\}$ be the sequence of approximations generated by such an algorithm. The deviation of $x_n$ from

the true value $x$ is caelled the **error at the $n$th stage**, denoted by $e_n$.

$$e_n \equiv x_n - x \tag{824}$$

The amount by which the $n$th approximation fails to satisfy the equation $Ax = b$ is called the $n$th residual, denoted by $r_n$.

$$r_n \equiv Ax_n - b \tag{825}$$

Error and residual are related by the equation.

$$r_n = Ae_n \tag{826}$$

Note that since we do not know $x$, the error cannot be calculated, but the residuals can be. We further restrict our scope to solving linear systems in which $A$ is real, positive, and self-adjoint. Clearly, we already know that $|A| = \beta$, and since $A$ is positive, we can conclude that

$$|A^{-1}| = \frac{1}{\alpha} \tag{827}$$

which implies that

$$\kappa(A) = \frac{\beta}{\alpha} \tag{828}$$

### 8.1.1 Method of Steepest Descent

**Theorem 8.8 (Linear Systems as a Variational Problem)**

Assume that $n \times n$ matrix $A$ is self-adjoint. The solution of $Ax = b$ minimizes the functional

$$E(y) \equiv \frac{1}{2}(y, Ay) - (y, b) \tag{829}$$

where $(\cdot, \cdot)$ is the Euclidean dot product. That is, the solution $x$ is

$$x = \min\big\{E(y)\big\} = \min\Big\{\frac{1}{2}(y, Ay) - (y, b)\Big\} \tag{830}$$

*Proof.* Add to $E(y)$ a constant, that is a term independent of $y$ to define a new function $F$.

$$F(y) \equiv E(y) + \frac{1}{2}(x, b) \tag{831}$$

Then, by self adjointness of $A$, we can express $F(y)$ as

$$\begin{aligned} F(y) &= \frac{1}{2}(y, Ay) - (y, b) + \frac{1}{2}(x, b) && (832)\\ &= \frac{1}{2}(y, Ay) - \frac{1}{2}(y, Ax) + \frac{1}{2}(Ax, x) - \frac{1}{2}(Ay, x) && (833)\\ &= \frac{1}{2}\big(y, A(y - x)\big) + \frac{1}{2}\big(A(x - y), x\big) && (834)\\ &= \frac{1}{2}\big(y - x, A(y - x)\big) && (835) \end{aligned}$$

Since $F(x) = 0$ and $F(x) \geq 0$ (since it is an inner product with repsect to $y - x$), $F(y)$, and also $E(y)$, takes a minimum at $y = x$.

Now to actually compute the value of $x$, we us the method of steepest descent. Note that $E : \mathbb{R}^m \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}$, so we can utilize ordinary calculus on it. The gradient of $E$ can be computed by the formula

$$\operatorname{grad} E(y) = Ay - b \tag{836}$$

So, if our $n$th approximation is $x_n$, then the $(n+1)$st approximation, $x_{n+1}$, is calculated as

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - s(Ax_n - b) \tag{837}$$

where $s$ is the step length in the direction $-\operatorname{grad} E$. By calculating the residual $r_n = Ax_n - b$, we can rewrite the above to

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - sr_n \tag{838}$$

Rather than keeping $s$ constant, we can actually determine an optimal value of $s$ at the $n$th step, denoted $s_n$, which minimizes $E(x_{n+1})$. This quadratic minimum problem is easily solved, since

$$E(x_{n+1}) = \frac{1}{2}\big(x_n - sr_n, A(x_n - sr_n)\big) - \big(x_n - sr_n, b\big) \tag{839}$$

$$= E(x_n) - s(r_n, r_n) + \frac{1}{2}s^2(r_n A r_n) \tag{840}$$

By taking the derivative and computing the value of $s$ where $E(x_{n+1}) = 0$, we see that the minimum is reached when

$$s = s_n \equiv \frac{(r_n, r_n)}{(r_n, Ar_n)} \tag{841}$$

**Theorem 8.9 (Convergence of Steepest Descent)**

The sequence of approximations $\{x_n\}$, with $s$ optimized to be $s_n$, converges to the solution of $Ax = b$.

The error bound for this algorithm is

$$\|e_n\|^2 \leq \frac{2}{\alpha}\left(1 - \frac{1}{\kappa(A)}\right)^n F(x_0) \tag{842}$$

which shows that the error $e_n$ tends to 0 in $\mathbb{R}^m$. However, this algorithm has a very slow rate of convergence for large $\kappa(A)$.

### 8.1.2 Method of Chebyshev Polynomials

The disadvantage of the method of steepest descent mentioned in the end of the last subsection renders it quite outdated and obsolete. this next method has a much better error bound that can handle large values of $\kappa$ more efficiently. However, we will need a positive lower bound $m$ for the smallest eigenvalue of $a$ and an upper bound $m$ for the largest eigenvalue. That is,

$$m \leq \alpha, \beta \leq m \tag{843}$$

and all the eigenvalues of $a$ lie in the interval $[m, m]$. It follows that

$$\kappa = \frac{\beta}{\alpha} < \frac{m}{m} \tag{844}$$

We generate the same sequence of approximations $\{x_n\}$ by the same recursion formula

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - s(ax_n - b) \iff x_{n+1} = (i - s_n a)x_n + s_n b \tag{845}$$

Since the solution of $x$ satisfies the formula; that is, since $x = (i - s_n a)x + s_n b$, we subtract this equation from the top to get

$$e_{n+1} = (i - s_n a)e_n \tag{846}$$

Doing this recursively, we can deduce an explicit formula

$$e_n = p_n(a)e_0 = \prod_{n=1}^{n}(1 - s_n a) \tag{847}$$

This allows us to estimate the size of $e_n$.

$$\|e_n\| \leq \|p_n(a)\|\|e_0\| \tag{848}$$

The norm of a self adjoint matrix $a$ is the largest $|a|$, where $a$ is the eigenvalue, and the spectral mapping theorem states that the eigenvalues $p$ of $p_n(a)$ are of the form $p = p_n(a)$, where $a$ is an eigenvalue of $a$. this means that

$$\|a\| \leq \max_{m \leq a \leq m} |a| \implies \|p_n(a)\| \leq \max_{m \leq a \leq m} |p_n(a)| \tag{849}$$

So, we are left with the bound

$$\|e_n\| \leq \|e_0\| \max_{m \leq a \leq m} |p_n(a)| \tag{850}$$

To get the best estimate of $e_n$, we have to choose the $s_1, s_2, \cdots, s_n$ so that the polynomial $p_n$ has a small maximum on the interval $[m, m]$. note that the polynomial $p_n$ satisfies the normalizing condition

$$p_n(0) = 1 \tag{851}$$

Oo find such a polynomial, we must first define chebyshev polynomials.

**Definition 8.7 ($n$th Chebyshev Polynomial)**

The $n$**th chebyshev polynomial** $t_n$ is defined for $-1 \leq u \leq 1$ by

$$t_n(u) = \cos(n\theta), \quad u = \cos(\theta) \tag{852}$$

**Theorem 8.10 (Chebyshev Minimax Property)**

Among all polynomials $p_n$ of degree $n$ that satisfy $p_n(0) = 1$, the one that has the smallest maximum on $[m, m]$ is the *rescaled chebyshev polynomial* that rescales values from $[-1, 1]$ to the interval $[m, m]$ while preserving the condition that $p_n(0) = 1$. this polynomial is expressed as

$$p_n(a) \equiv t_n\left(\frac{m + m - 2a}{m - m}\right) \Big/ t_n\left(\frac{m + m}{m - m}\right) \tag{853}$$

Now, assuming that $m/m \approx \kappa$,

$$t_n\left(\frac{m + m}{m - m}\right) = t_n\left(\frac{\frac{m}{m} + 1}{\frac{m}{m} - 1}\right) \approx t_n\left(\frac{\kappa + 1}{\kappa - 1}\right) \tag{854}$$

since $|t_n(u)| \leq 1$ for $|u| \leq 1$, this also implies that

$$t_n\left(\frac{m + m - 2a}{m - m}\right) \leq 1 \tag{855}$$

Combining this together, we get

$$\|e_n\| \leq \|e_0\| \max_{m \leq a \leq m} |p_n(a)| = \|e_0\| \Big/ t_n\left(\frac{\kappa+1}{\kappa-1}\right) \tag{856}$$

It is a fact that higher order chebyshev polynomials tend to infinity faster once the value reaches out of $[-1, 1]$, meaning that as $n \to \infty$, $t_n\big((\kappa+1)/(\kappa-1)\big)$ will also tend to infinity (note that $(\kappa+1)/(\kappa-1)$ is a constant, implying that $e_n$ tends to 0 as $n$ tends to infinity. the error bound for $e_n$ is given by the following

$$\|e_n\| \leq 2\left(1 + \frac{2}{\sqrt{\kappa}}\right)^{-n} \|e_0\| \approx 2\left(1 - \frac{2}{\sqrt{\kappa}}\right)^{n} \|e_0\| \tag{857}$$

Once again, this confirms that $e_n \to 0$ as $n \to \infty$. furthermore, when $\kappa$ is large, the error bound works with $\sqrt{\kappa}$, which is must smaller than $\kappa$ itself. so, $e_n$ converges much faster through this algorithm than through the method of steepest descent.